Next Stop: question review pack

Purpose: check that the questions are fair, clear, correctly keyed and pitched at the stated level. All material is original, written to match the structure of Pearson Edexcel Functional Skills English Level 1 and 2 (it is not Pearson text).

How to review: for each question, check (1) the answer key is right, (2) only one option is defensible, (3) the wording is clear for a 17-year-old, (4) the level (L1 or L2) is right, (5) the explanation is accurate. Reply with the question id and the problem.

READING: Panda Week (r-pandas, both, topic: Pandas)

Text A: Panda Week is coming (Web page, Hollins Park Wildlife Centre website)

This summer, Hollins Park Wildlife Centre is holding its first ever Panda Week. For nine days, our two giant pandas, Juniper and Tao, will be the stars of the park. We think they are the most charming animals you will ever meet.

About giant pandas

Giant pandas live in mountain forests in south-west China. They are covered in thick black and white fur, and they spend much of the day eating bamboo, which makes up almost all of their diet. Bamboo gives very little energy, so a panda has to eat a great deal of it.

What's on every day

Time	Activity	Where
10:30	Feeding talk with a keeper	Bamboo Walk
12:00	Panda craft table (ages 4 to 10)	Visitor Hub
14:00	"Ask the keeper" question time	Bamboo Walk
15:30	Feeding talk with a keeper	Bamboo Walk

All Panda Week activities are included in the normal entry price.

Tickets

- Adult: £14.50
- Child (3 to 15): £9.00
- Under 3: free
- Family (2 adults and 2 children): £42.00

Save 10% when you book online at least one day before your visit.

Please remember

- Pandas like a quiet space. Please keep your voice low on the Bamboo Walk.
- Flash photography is not allowed near the panda enclosure.
- The Bamboo Walk has steps. A step-free route is signposted from the Visitor Hub.

Text B: We went to Panda Week. Was it worth it? (Blog post, The Weekend Wanderer blog)

Last Saturday, my partner, our two children and I spent the day at Hollins Park for Panda Week. I'll be honest: I wasn't sure a whole week about two animals would be worth the drive. I was wrong.

We arrived just before the 10:30 feeding talk, and it was the best part of the day. The keeper explained that bamboo gives pandas very little energy, so they have to eat a lot of it. My eight-year-old hasn't stopped talking about it since.

By the afternoon, things were less exciting. Tao was nowhere to be seen, and Juniper slept in the corner of the enclosure for the whole of the 14:00 question time. The Bamboo Walk was also very crowded, and we struggled to hear the keeper over the noise.

Booking online the day before saved us a few pounds on our family ticket, which helped, because the café prices were shocking: nearly £4 for a small juice.

My advice? Go early and take a packed lunch. The morning was magical. The afternoon was mostly a sleeping ball of fur.

Questions

r-pandas/q1 (Text A, L1/L2, choice)

What is the main purpose of the web page?

A. To persuade people to adopt a giant panda

B. To tell people about Panda Week and encourage them to visit

C. To explain how to look after a giant panda at home

D. To complain about ticket prices

Answer: B. To tell people about Panda Week and encourage them to visit

Why: The page gives the times, activities and ticket prices for Panda Week, and calls the pandas "the stars of the park". It is informing people and encouraging them to come.

r-pandas/q2 (Text A, L1, choice)

What time is the second feeding talk?

A. 10:30

B. 12:00

C. 14:00

D. 15:30

Answer: D. 15:30

Why: The table lists two feeding talks: one at 10:30 and one at 15:30. The second one is at 15:30.

r-pandas/q3 (Text A, L1/L2, tfns)

Bamboo gives giant pandas a lot of energy.

Answer: false

Why: The page says: "Bamboo gives very little energy, so a panda has to eat a great deal of it."

r-pandas/q4 (Text A, L1, tfns)

You have to pay extra to use the craft table.

Answer: false

Why: The page says: "All Panda Week activities are included in the normal entry price."

r-pandas/q5 (Text A, L1, tfns)

The wildlife centre has a café.

Answer: notstated

Why: The web page does not mention a café at all, so we cannot tell from this text.

r-pandas/q6 (Text A, L1, factopinion)

"We think they are the most charming animals you will ever meet."

Answer: opinion

Why: "We think" and "most charming" show this is what the writers believe. Someone else could disagree.

r-pandas/q7 (Text A, L2, factopinion)

"Giant pandas live in mountain forests in south-west China."

Answer: fact

Why: This can be checked in books or by studying where pandas live in the wild. It is information, not someone's view.

r-pandas/q8 (Text A, L1, choice)

What does the page ask visitors to do on the Bamboo Walk?

A. Bring bamboo to feed the pandas

B. Use a flash so the pandas can be seen

C. Keep their voices low

D. Use the steps instead of the step-free route

Answer: C. Keep their voices low

Why: Under "Please remember", the page says pandas like a quiet space and asks visitors to "keep your voice low on the Bamboo Walk".

r-pandas/q9 (Text B, L2, choice)

How does the writer of the blog feel about Panda Week overall?

A. Completely disappointed

B. Angry about the crowds

C. Not interested in the pandas

D. Mostly positive, with some criticisms

Answer: D. Mostly positive, with some criticisms

Why: The writer says "I was wrong" to doubt it and calls the morning "magical", but also criticises the crowds, the sleepy afternoon and the café prices.

r-pandas/q10 (Text B, L2, tfns)

The writer's family paid the full price for their tickets.

Answer: false

Why: The writer says booking online the day before "saved us a few pounds on our family ticket", so they did not pay full price.

r-pandas/q11 (Text A, L1/L2, open)

The web page uses headings and a table. Choose one of these features and explain how it helps the reader.

Answer: The table puts the times, activities and places in rows, so a reader can quickly find out when and where the feeding talks are without reading every sentence.

Why: I named one feature (a heading or the table). / I said what it does for the reader (for example, makes information quick to find). / I linked it to something on this page.

r-pandas/q12 (Text both, L2, open)

The web page presents Panda Week as a great day out. How far does the blog post agree? Use evidence from both texts.

> Answer: The blog partly agrees. Like the web page, which calls the pandas "the stars of the park", the blogger enjoyed the 10:30 feeding talk and calls the morning "magical". However, the blog adds things the web page leaves out: the Bamboo Walk was crowded, Juniper slept through the 14:00 question time and the café was expensive. So the blog agrees it is worth going, but suggests going early and taking a packed lunch.
>
> Why: I gave a clear overall view (for example, "partly agrees"). / I used evidence from the web page. / I used evidence from the blog post. / I showed at least one way they agree and one way they differ.

READING: Desert and coast (r-israel, both, topic: Israel)

Text A: Five days in Israel: desert and coast (Web page, Sunpath Small-Group Tours website)

Join a small group of no more than 12 travellers for five relaxed days exploring the coast and the desert of Israel. You'll stay in friendly guesthouses, eat fresh local food and travel in a comfortable air-conditioned minibus.

Your trip, day by day

Day	Where	Highlights
1	Tel Aviv	Meet your guide. Evening walk along the seafront.
2	Tel Aviv	Food tour of Carmel Market. Free afternoon at the beach.
3	Mitzpe Ramon	Drive south into the Negev desert. Sunset walk at the edge of the Ramon Crater.
4	Mitzpe Ramon	Jeep trip into the crater. Evening stargazing with a local expert (optional, £25).
5	Dead Sea	Morning float in the Dead Sea. Transfer to the airport.

Why travel with us?

- Every guide has lived in Israel for at least ten years.
- Our groups are small, so you never feel like one of a crowd.
- We think the desert at night is the most beautiful sight in the world.

Good to know

- Price: £1,150 per person, sharing a room. Flights are not included.
- Single room: add £180.
- The desert can be very hot in the day and cold at night. Bring layers.
- You will need comfortable shoes for walking on rough ground.

Text B: A month of eating (and waiting for buses) in Israel (Blog post, Slow Road travel blog)

Everyone told me the food would be good. Nobody told me it would ruin every other breakfast for me. Shakshuka, eggs cooked in a rich tomato and pepper sauce, is now my idea of the perfect start to the day.

Lunch was usually falafel stuffed into a warm pitta with salad and tahini, bought from a small stall. The best one I had was in a side street near the market in Tel Aviv, where the owner refused to let me leave without trying his hummus too.

Getting around was easier than I expected. The train along the coast is quick and clean, and buses reach most towns. One warning, though: from Friday afternoon until Saturday evening, many buses and trains stop

running for Shabbat, the weekly day of rest. I learned this the hard way, and spent a very long Friday evening at a bus stop that no bus was ever going to visit.

If I went back, I'd skip the organised tours and travel on my own. You see more, you spend less, and you eat better.

Questions

r-israel/q1 (Text A, L1/L2, choice)

Who is the web page mainly written for?

A. People who live in the Negev desert

B. Guides looking for a job

C. Airlines selling flights

D. People thinking of booking a holiday

Answer: D. People thinking of booking a holiday

Why: The page describes a trip, gives the price and says "Join a small group". It is aimed at people who might book.

r-israel/q2 (Text A, L1/L2, choice)

On which day can the group go stargazing?

A. Day 2

B. Day 3

C. Day 4

D. Day 5

Answer: C. Day 4

Why: The table shows "Evening stargazing with a local expert" on Day 4, in Mitzpe Ramon.

r-israel/q3 (Text A, L1/L2, tfns)

The price includes flights.

Answer: false

Why: Under "Good to know", the page says: "Flights are not included."

r-israel/q4 (Text A, L1, tfns)

There are never more than 12 travellers in a group.

Answer: true

Why: The first paragraph says the group has "no more than 12 travellers".

r-israel/q5 (Text A, L1, tfns)

The minibus has free Wi-Fi.

Answer: notstated

Why: The page says the minibus is comfortable and air-conditioned, but it says nothing about Wi-Fi.

r-israel/q6 (Text A, L1/L2, factopinion)

"We think the desert at night is the most beautiful sight in the world."

Answer: opinion

Why: "We think" and "most beautiful" show this is a personal view. It cannot be proved.

r-israel/q7 (Text A, L1, choice)

Why does the page tell travellers to bring layers?

A. The desert can be very hot in the day and cold at night.

B. The minibus air-conditioning is too strong.

C. The guesthouses have no heating.

D. It rains every day on the coast.

Answer: A. The desert can be very hot in the day and cold at night.

Why: The page says: "The desert can be very hot in the day and cold at night. Bring layers."

r-israel/q8 (Text A, L1, open)

Give two things a traveller should pack for this trip. Use information from the page.

Answer: 1. Warm layers, because the desert can be cold at night. 2. Comfortable shoes, for walking on rough ground.

Why: I gave two different things. / Both come from the page, not from my own ideas. / I kept it short and clear.

r-israel/q9 (Text B, L2, choice)

Why did the blogger spend a long time at a bus stop?

A. The bus was late because of traffic.

B. Many buses do not run from Friday afternoon until Saturday evening.

C. They were waiting for a train instead.

D. The bus stop had been moved.

Answer: B. Many buses do not run from Friday afternoon until Saturday evening.

Why: The blogger explains that many buses and trains stop running for Shabbat, from Friday afternoon until Saturday evening, and they were waiting on a Friday evening.

r-israel/q10 (Text B, L2, tfns)

The blogger found the coast train slow.

Answer: false

Why: The blogger says: "The train along the coast is quick and clean."

r-israel/q11 (Text both, L2, open)

The two texts give different views about organised tours. Explain the difference, using evidence from both texts.

Answer: The web page presents an organised tour as the best way to travel: groups are small, so "you never feel like one of a crowd", and every guide has lived in Israel for at least ten years. The blogger disagrees, saying they would "skip the organised tours" next time, because travelling alone means "you see more, you spend less, and you eat better". The web page is trying to sell a tour, while the blogger is sharing a personal experience.

Why: I explained the web page's view. / I explained the blogger's view. / I used a short quote or detail from each text. / I pointed out why their views might differ (for example, one is selling a tour).

READING: Your bus is changing (r-transport, both, topic: Public transport)

Text A: Your bus is changing (Council leaflet, Vale of Fenn Council)

From 6 April, the number 14 bus between Kettlewick and Fennbridge will follow a new route. We have made these changes after a public consultation last autumn, when more than 600 people told us what they need from

their local buses.

What is changing?

- The 14 will no longer go along Mill Lane. Instead, it will stop at the new Kettlewick Health Centre.
- A new 14A service will run on Sundays only, every two hours.
- The first bus on weekdays will leave Kettlewick 20 minutes earlier, at 06:10.
- The bus stops on Mill Lane will be removed. The nearest stop will be on Station Road, about 300 metres away.

New weekday timetable: Kettlewick to Fennbridge

Kettlewick, Market Square	Health Centre	Station Road	Fennbridge Bus Station
06:10	06:16	06:22	06:40
07:10	07:16	07:22	07:40
08:10	08:18	08:26	08:50
09:10	09:16	09:22	09:40

Buses then run every hour, at 10 minutes past the hour, until 18:10. Journeys between 08:00 and 09:00 take longer because of school traffic.

Tickets

Single and return prices are not changing. The Vale Day Ticket (£5.20) can be used on all our routes, including the new 14A.

Have your say

We will review the new route after six months. Tell us what you think by emailing buses@valeoffenn.example or by picking up a feedback card on any bus.

Text B: Don't leave Mill Lane behind (Letter to a local newspaper, The Vale Gazette, letters page)

Dear Editor,

I am writing about the council's decision to take the 14 bus away from Mill Lane. The council says the nearest stop will be "about 300 metres away". That may sound like nothing, but Station Road is at the top of a steep hill, and many people on Mill Lane are in their eighties.

The council also says that more than 600 people took part in its consultation. I have spoken to my neighbours, and not one of them knew it was happening. It was only advertised online, which is no use to people who do not use the internet.

I will admit that a stop at the new health centre is a good idea. My own doctor has moved there, and at the moment I need two buses to reach it. But surely the bus could do both?

I would ask the council to keep at least one stop on Mill Lane, even if the bus only goes that way a few times a day.

Yours faithfully,

A Mill Lane resident

Questions

r-transport/q1 (Text A, L1/L2, choice)

What is the main purpose of the leaflet?

A. To tell passengers about changes to the 14 bus

B. To persuade people to buy a car

C. To advertise the new health centre

D. To ask people to take part in a consultation

Answer: A. To tell passengers about changes to the 14 bus

Why: The heading is "Your bus is changing", and most of the leaflet explains the new route, timetable and stops for the 14.

r-transport/q2 (Text A, L1/L2, choice)

You start at Kettlewick Market Square on a weekday. You need to be at Fennbridge Bus Station by 07:45. What is the latest bus you can catch?

A. 06:10

B. 07:10

C. 08:10

D. 09:10

Answer: B. 07:10

Why: The 07:10 from Market Square reaches Fennbridge Bus Station at 07:40, which is before 07:45. The next bus, at 08:10, arrives at 08:50, which is too late.

r-transport/q3 (Text A, L1/L2, tfns)

The 14 will still stop on Mill Lane.

Answer: false

Why: The leaflet says: "The 14 will no longer go along Mill Lane" and "The bus stops on Mill Lane will be removed."

r-transport/q4 (Text A, L1, tfns)

The 14A runs on Sundays only.

Answer: true

Why: The leaflet says: "A new 14A service will run on Sundays only, every two hours."

r-transport/q5 (Text A, L1, tfns)

Single ticket prices are going up.

Answer: false

Why: Under "Tickets", the leaflet says: "Single and return prices are not changing."

r-transport/q6 (Text A, L1/L2, choice)

Why does the 08:10 journey take longer than the others?

A. It goes a different way.

B. It stops at more bus stops.

C. There is school traffic between 08:00 and 09:00.

D. The driver changes at the Health Centre.

Answer: C. There is school traffic between 08:00 and 09:00.

Why: The leaflet says: "Journeys between 08:00 and 09:00 take longer because of school traffic."

r-transport/q7 (Text A, L1, tfns)

The new route costs the council less money to run.

Answer: notstated

Why: The leaflet does not say anything about how much the route costs the council.

r-transport/q8 (Text A, L1, open)

Someone used to catch the 14 on Mill Lane. Explain what they will need to do from 6 April.

Answer: They will need to walk to the bus stop on Station Road, which is about 300 metres away, because the Mill Lane stops are being removed.

Why: I said where they should go now (Station Road). / I included a detail from the leaflet, such as the distance. / I said why (the Mill Lane stops are being removed).

r-transport/q9 (Text B, L2, choice)

What is the main point of the letter?

A. The new health centre should not have been built.

B. Bus tickets in the Vale are too expensive.

C. Removing the Mill Lane stops will be hard for some residents.

D. The council should stop running the 14 bus.

Answer: C. Removing the Mill Lane stops will be hard for some residents.

Why: The writer explains that Station Road is up a steep hill and many Mill Lane residents are elderly, then asks the council to keep at least one Mill Lane stop.

r-transport/q10 (Text B, L2, tfns)

The writer thinks a stop at the health centre is a bad idea.

Answer: false

Why: The writer says: "I will admit that a stop at the new health centre is a good idea."

r-transport/q11 (Text B, L2, tfns)

The writer took part in the council's consultation.

Answer: notstated

Why: The writer says their neighbours did not know about the consultation, but never says whether they took part themselves.

r-transport/q12 (Text both, L2, open)

Compare how the two texts present the change to the 14 bus. Use evidence from both texts.

Answer: The leaflet presents the change in a positive, factual way. It uses bullet points and a timetable, and describes the new stop as only "about 300 metres away". It also stresses that more than 600 people took part in the consultation. The letter takes the same facts and shows a different side: the walk is up "a steep hill" for people "in their eighties", and the consultation was "only advertised online". Both texts agree the health centre stop is useful, but the letter asks for a stop on Mill Lane as well.

Why: I explained how the leaflet presents the change. / I explained how the letter presents it. / I used evidence from both texts. / I mentioned at least one similarity or difference in how they say it (tone, layout or word choice).

READING: Village or town? (r-geography, both, topic: UK geography)

Text A: Hawsden or Brayminster? A guide for people moving to the area (Information guide, Brayminster District Council Housing Team)

Every year, hundreds of families move into Brayminster District. Many of them face the same question: should we live in the market town of Brayminster, or in one of the villages around it, such as Hawsden? This guide sets out the facts to help you decide.

| | Hawsden (village) | Brayminster (town) |

|---|---|---|

| Population | About 900 | About 24,000 |

| Shops | One village shop and post office | Two supermarkets and a high street |

| Schools | One primary school | Three primary schools and one secondary school |

| Doctor | A surgery open two mornings a week | A health centre open six days a week |

| Bus | Every two hours, Monday to Saturday | Every 15 minutes |

| Train station | None. The nearest is in Brayminster, 6 miles away. | Yes, with trains to the city |

Housing

Hawsden has mostly older detached and semi-detached houses, many with large gardens. Very few homes come up for sale or rent, so you may have to wait. Brayminster has a wider mix, including flats, terraced houses and a new estate of 300 homes on the edge of town.

Things to think about

> If you do not drive, village life can be harder, because buses are less frequent.
>
> Village life can be quieter, and many people say they feel part of a close community.
>
> In our view, Brayminster offers the best of both worlds: town services, with the countryside on your doorstep.

Text B: Six months in a village: what nobody tells you (Blog post, Country Notes blog)

When we moved from a flat in the city to a cottage in Hawsden, I pictured long walks, fresh air and friendly neighbours. I got all three. I also got a two-hour wait for the bus, a phone signal that disappears if you stand in the wrong room, and a village shop that closes at five.

Don't get me wrong. I love it here. In our first week, three neighbours knocked on the door with cake, and the woman next door now feeds our cat when we're away. In the city, I never even learned my neighbours' names.

But if you're thinking of moving, be realistic. We had to buy a second car, because my partner works shifts and the last bus back from Brayminster leaves at 18:30. That cost alone has wiped out most of the money we saved on our mortgage.

Would I move back? Not a chance. But I'd tell anyone thinking about it to visit on a wet Tuesday in November, not a sunny Saturday in June.

Questions

r-geography/q1 (Text A, L1/L2, choice)

What is the main purpose of the guide?

A. To sell houses on the new estate

B. To persuade people to move away from Brayminster District

C. To complain about the bus service

D. To help people decide whether to live in a village or the town

> Answer: D. To help people decide whether to live in a village or the town
>
> Why: The guide says it "sets out the facts to help you decide" between Brayminster and a village such as Hawsden.

r-geography/q2 (Text A, L1/L2, choice)

How often does the bus run in Hawsden?

A. Every 15 minutes

B. Every hour

C. Every two hours, Monday to Saturday

D. On Sundays only

Answer: C. Every two hours, Monday to Saturday

Why: The table shows the Hawsden bus runs "Every two hours, Monday to Saturday". Every 15 minutes is the Brayminster bus.

r-geography/q3 (Text A, L1/L2, tfns)

Hawsden has a secondary school.

Answer: false

Why: The table shows Hawsden has "One primary school". The only secondary school listed is in Brayminster.

r-geography/q4 (Text A, L1, tfns)

Brayminster has a train station.

Answer: true

Why: The table says Brayminster has a train station, "with trains to the city".

r-geography/q5 (Text A, L1, tfns)

The village shop in Hawsden sells newspapers.

Answer: notstated

Why: The guide says there is a village shop and post office, but it does not say what the shop sells.

r-geography/q6 (Text A, L1/L2, factopinion)

"In our view, Brayminster offers the best of both worlds."

Answer: opinion

Why: "In our view" tells you this is what the writers think. Someone else might prefer the village.

r-geography/q7 (Text A, L1, factopinion)

"Hawsden has one primary school."

Answer: fact

Why: This can be checked. It is information, not a view.

r-geography/q8 (Text A, L1, open)

Give two reasons why someone who does not drive might choose to live in Brayminster.

Answer: 1. The bus runs every 15 minutes, so it is easy to get around. 2. There is a train station with trains to the city.

Why: I gave two different reasons. / Both reasons come from the guide. / Both reasons are linked to not having a car (transport or having things nearby).

r-geography/q9 (Text B, L2, choice)

What does the blogger mean by "visit on a wet Tuesday in November, not a sunny Saturday in June"?

A. Look at the village on an ordinary, less pleasant day before you decide.

B. The village is closed at weekends.

C. It rains more in villages than in towns.

D. Houses are cheaper to buy in November.

Answer: A. Look at the village on an ordinary, less pleasant day before you decide.

Why: A sunny Saturday shows a village at its best. The blogger is advising people to see what everyday life is really like before moving.

r-geography/q10 (Text B, L2, tfns)

The blogger regrets moving to Hawsden.

Answer: false

Why: The blogger says "I love it here" and, asked if they would move back, says "Not a chance."

r-geography/q11 (Text B, L2, tfns)

The blogger's family saved money on their mortgage by moving.

Answer: true

Why: The blogger mentions "the money we saved on our mortgage", although the cost of a second car has used up most of it.

r-geography/q12 (Text both, L2, open)

Both texts talk about transport in Hawsden. Compare what they say and how they say it.

Answer: Both texts agree that transport is a problem in Hawsden. The guide states it in a calm, factual way: the bus runs "every two hours" and "village life can be harder" if you do not drive. The blog shows what that means in real life: a "two-hour wait for the bus", a last bus at 18:30, and having to buy a second car. The guide uses a table and general advice, while the blog uses personal experience and a slightly humorous tone.

Why: I said what both texts agree on. / I used evidence from the guide. / I used evidence from the blog. / I commented on how they say it (for example, factual table versus personal story).

READING: A new home for the pandas (rl-pandas, L1, topic: Pandas)

Text A: Panda House opening day (Web page, Marlow Wildlife Park website)

Marlow Wildlife Park is proud to open its new Panda House on Saturday 14 June. Come and meet Lan and Bo, our two giant pandas.

On the day you can:

watch the pandas eat their breakfast at 10:00

ask a keeper your questions at 11:30

have your face painted in the Bamboo Café

pick up a free panda trail map at the gate

Entry is free for everyone on opening day. Please arrive early, because the Panda House can only hold 200 people at a time.

Text B: Behind the scenes at the Panda House (Magazine article, Marlow Wildlife Park members' magazine)

It took 14 months to build the new Panda House at Marlow Wildlife Park, and almost every detail was planned with the pandas in mind. Head keeper Priya Nair showed us around before the doors opened to the public.

A home that feels like a forest

Each panda has its own indoor room, which is kept cool all year, and a large outdoor garden. Giant pandas come from the mountain forests of south-west China, so the garden has hills to climb, trees for shade and a small stream. "Pandas are happiest when there is plenty to climb and somewhere shady to rest," says Priya.

Bamboo, bamboo and more bamboo

Bamboo makes up almost all of a giant panda's diet, but it gives very little energy, so pandas spend much of the day eating. The park grows some of its own bamboo. The rest arrives fresh by lorry every week from a specialist grower (you can see the grower's farm on the map on page 4). Keepers check every delivery by hand and throw away any stalks that look dry.

A keeper's day

Keepers start at 7:00 am by checking that both pandas are well. Next they clean the rooms and prepare the first feed. A team of six keepers will look after Lan and Bo, and a vet visits every month to check that they are healthy. They also hide small treats around the garden so that the pandas have to search for them. This is called enrichment, and it stops the pandas from getting bored.

Visitors may find the pandas asleep. "Please don't be disappointed," Priya adds. "A sleeping panda is a healthy, relaxed panda."

The Panda House is, without doubt, the best thing to happen to Marlow in years. Entry is free on opening day, but the park expects it to be very busy.

Text C: Our first visit to the Panda House (Blog post, The Day Out Diary blog)

We went on opening day with my sister's kids, who are six and nine, and to be honest I'm still recovering! It was the busiest day I have seen at Marlow for ages.

The good bits

The Panda House is gorgeous. The garden looks just like a real forest, and Bo was brilliant. He sat on a rock eating bamboo for ages. The kids loved watching him. The keeper talk at 11:30 was great as well. She told us that Lan and Bo spend most of the day eating, and my nine-year-old asked three questions in a row!

The not-so-good bits

We queued for nearly an hour, and by the time we got inside Lan was fast asleep in the corner. The Bamboo Café was packed, and I paid £4 for a tiny cup of tea. I was gutted!

My tips if you're going

- Get there early, before the gates open if you can.
- Bring a packed lunch, because the café queue is huge.
- Check the feeding times on the website first, so you don't miss Bo at breakfast.
- Wear comfy shoes. You will walk loads.

Would I go again? Definitely, but on a quiet weekday!

Questions

rl-pandas/q1a (Text A, L1, open, 1 marks)

Using Text A, give one thing visitors can do on opening day.

> Answer: Any one of: watch the pandas eat breakfast; ask a keeper questions; have their face painted; pick up a free trail map.
>
> Why: I gave one thing that visitors can do. / It comes from the list in Text A.

rl-pandas/q1b (Text A, L1, choice, 1 marks)

Which feature of Text A helped you find this information?

A. Bullet points

B. A text box

C. A menu

D. Bold headings

Answer: A. Bullet points

Why: The things visitors can do are set out in a bulleted list, which makes each one easy to spot.

rl-pandas/q2a (Text A, L1, open, 1 marks)

Text A says: "Marlow Wildlife Park is proud to open its new Panda House." Give one word or phrase to replace "proud" that keeps the meaning the same.

Answer: Pleased, happy, delighted, glad.

Why: My word means about the same as "proud". / It still makes sense in the sentence.

rl-pandas/q2b (Text A, L1, open, 1 marks)

Text A says: "the Panda House can only hold 200 people at a time." Give one word or phrase to replace "hold" that keeps the meaning the same.

Answer: Fit, take, have room for, contain.

Why: My word means about the same as "hold". / It still makes sense in the sentence.

rl-pandas/q3 (Text A, L1, choice, 1 marks)

What is the main purpose of Text A?

A. To sell panda souvenirs

B. To invite people to an event

C. To explain how pandas are looked after

D. To warn visitors about queues

Answer: B. To invite people to an event

Why: The text announces the opening day and tells people what they can do there. It is inviting people to come.

rl-pandas/q4 (Text B, L1, open, 3 marks)

Using Text B, give three ways the Panda House has been designed to suit giant pandas.

Answer: Any three of: an indoor room kept cool all year; a large outdoor garden; hills to climb; trees for shade; a small stream.

Why: I gave three different ways. / All three come from the section "A home that feels like a forest". / I did not repeat the same idea in different words.

rl-pandas/q5 (Text B, L1, open, 2 marks)

Explain why giant pandas spend much of the day eating.

Answer: Bamboo makes up almost all of their diet (1), but it gives very little energy, so they have to eat a lot of it (1).

Why: I said what pandas mostly eat. / I said that bamboo gives very little energy.

rl-pandas/q6 (Text B, L1, choice, 1 marks)

The writer puts the words "Pandas are happiest when there is plenty to climb and somewhere shady to rest" inside inverted commas. Why?

A. To show they are the exact words Priya said

B. To show the words are a mistake

C. To show the words are a title

D. To show the words are hard to understand

Answer: A. To show they are the exact words Priya said

Why: Inverted commas around a sentence show that someone said those exact words. Here, it is Priya Nair.

rl-pandas/q7 (Text B, L1, open, 2 marks)

What do keepers do to give the pandas enrichment, and why?

Answer: They hide small treats around the garden so the pandas have to search for them (1). This stops the pandas getting bored (1).

Why: I said what keepers do. / I said why they do it.

rl-pandas/q8 (Text B, L1, multi, 2 marks)

Which TWO of these statements are facts?

A. Giant pandas come from the mountain forests of south-west China.

B. The Panda House is the best thing to happen to Marlow in years.

C. A sleeping panda is a healthy, relaxed panda.

D. It took 14 months to build the new Panda House.

Answer: A. Giant pandas come from the mountain forests of south-west China.; D. It took 14 months to build the new Panda House.

Why: A fact can be checked. Where pandas come from and how long the building took are facts. "The best thing to happen" and "a healthy, relaxed panda" are views, so they are opinions.

rl-pandas/q9 (Text B, L1, open, 2 marks)

Give two specialist words or phrases from Text B that are connected to looking after animals.

Answer: Any two of: head keeper, keepers, diet, feed, enrichment.

Why: I gave two words or phrases. / I copied them from Text B. / Both are to do with looking after animals.

rl-pandas/q10 (Text C, L1, open, 2 marks)

Give two things the writer of Text C did not like about the visit.

Answer: Any two of: the queue of nearly an hour; Lan was asleep when they got in; the café was packed; paying £4 for a tiny cup of tea.

Why: I gave two different things. / Both are things the writer did not like. / Both come from "The not-so-good bits".

rl-pandas/q11 (Text C, L1, choice, 1 marks)

Which sentence best sums up the writer's view of the visit?

A. It was a waste of time.

B. It was good, but could have been better.

C. It was too expensive to enjoy.

D. It was only good for children.

Answer: B. It was good, but could have been better.

Why: The writer loved the garden and Bo, but complained about the queue and the café. They would go again, but on a quiet day.

rl-pandas/q12 (Text C, L1, open, 3 marks)

Using Text C, give three pieces of advice for people planning to visit.

Answer: Any three of: get there early; bring a packed lunch; check the feeding times on the website; wear comfy shoes; go on a quiet weekday.

Why: I gave three different pieces of advice. / All three come from the text. / Each one tells the reader what to do.

rl-pandas/q13 (Text C, L1, open, 2 marks)

Give two examples of informal language from Text C.

Answer: Any two of: "to be honest", "recovering", "gorgeous", "kids", "gutted", "loads", "comfy", "for ages".

Why: I copied two words or phrases exactly. / They are chatty, everyday words, not formal ones.

rl-pandas/q14 (Text C, L1, open, 2 marks)

Who is Text C written for? Give one clue from the text that tells you.

Answer: People thinking about visiting the Panda House, such as families (1). Clue, for example: the tips are written to the reader ("if you're going", "Get there early") (1).

Why: I said who the text is for. / I gave a clue copied from the text.

rl-pandas/q15 (Text B,C, L1, open, 3 marks)

Text B and Text C both mention the pandas sleeping. Compare what each text says about this.

Answer: Text B says visitors may find the pandas asleep and that this is fine, because "a sleeping panda is a healthy, relaxed panda" (1). Text C was disappointed that Lan was "fast asleep in the corner" when they got inside (1). They agree that pandas can be asleep when you visit, but Text B sees it as a good sign and Text C sees it as a let-down (1).

Why: I said what Text B says about pandas sleeping. / I said what Text C says about it. / I said how the two are the same or different.

READING: Helping the pandas (rl-pandas-2, L1, topic: Pandas)

Text A: Adopt a panda (Leaflet, Ferndale Zoo)

Help to look after the giant pandas at Ferndale Zoo by becoming a panda adopter. Ferndale Zoo is home to two giant pandas, who arrived last year. They love to eat, play and sleep in the sun.

Your adoption pack: a certificate, a photo of your panda, a cuddly toy and a free family ticket.

Adopting costs just £4 a month. Your money pays for the pandas' bamboo, health checks and toys. You can sign up at the zoo shop or online, and it only takes five minutes.

Text B: How are giant pandas helped in the wild? (Magazine article, Wild Places magazine)

Giant pandas live in only a few mountain areas of China, and they depend on bamboo forests for food and shelter. Years ago, many of these forests were cleared to make room for farms and new buildings. As the forests shrank, the pandas lost their homes.

Protected reserves

To help the pandas, China has set up protected nature reserves, where trees cannot be cut down. There are now dozens of reserves across the mountains, and together they protect large areas of forest. Rangers walk through the forests every week to check on the wildlife. They look for paw prints and droppings, and they also place cameras that take photographs when an animal walks past.

Joining the forests together

Many pandas now live in small patches of forest that are cut off from each other. The corridors – strips of forest that join one area to another – allow pandas to move safely between patches, so that they can find food

and meet mates. Planting new bamboo along the corridors takes years, but the forest is slowly joining up again. "Without the corridors, the pandas would be trapped," says ranger Li Na.

How can zoos help?

Zoos cannot return pandas to the wild by themselves, but they can still make a difference. Money raised by zoos and their visitors helps to pay for the reserves and the rangers. Zoos also run breeding programmes, so that scientists can learn how to care for baby pandas. Visitors can also help by adopting a panda, which pays for food and care.

A success story

Conservation work takes many years, and it is not easy. Even so, the work to save the giant panda is the most inspiring conservation story of recent times. Nothing is more important than protecting the forests where these animals live.

Text C: Our class adopted a panda. Will you? (School newsletter article, Ferndale High School newsletter)

Last term, Year 10 voted to adopt a giant panda. Why? In geography we learned that pandas are losing their forest homes, and we wanted to do something about it.

Imagine a world without pandas. Some people ask why we should care about animals so far away. We believe that every living thing matters, and pandas are a symbol of hope for nature all over the world. Would you want a world without them? Of course not! Every pound we raise helps to pay for bamboo, health checks and toys, so it really does make a difference.

We have already raised £86 from our cake sale, but we need your help to reach £200 by the end of term. Our teacher, Mr Dale, thinks we can do it, and we are determined to prove him right. It will be fun, and you will be helping a great cause.

Here is how you can help:

- Donate any amount at the school office.
- Join our sponsored silent hour on Friday.
- Bake something for our second cake sale.

Just £2 buys a day's bamboo for one panda, so please give whatever you can. Together, we can help to protect these amazing animals!

Questions

rl-pandas-2/q1a (Text A, L1, open, 1 marks)

Using Text A, give one thing that comes in the adoption pack.

Answer: Any one of: a certificate; a photo of your panda; a cuddly toy; a free family ticket.

Why: I gave one thing. / It comes from the box in Text A.

rl-pandas-2/q1b (Text A, L1, choice, 1 marks)

Which feature of Text A helped you find this information?

A. A speech bubble

B. A text box

C. A numbered list

D. A menu

Answer: B. A text box

Why: The adoption pack is shown inside a box, which makes it stand out from the rest of the text.

rl-pandas-2/q2a (Text A, L1, open, 1 marks)

Text A says: "Help to look after the giant pandas." Give one word or phrase to replace "look after" that keeps the meaning the same.

Answer: Care for, take care of, protect, feed and care for.

Why: My word or phrase means about the same as "look after". / It still makes sense in the sentence.

rl-pandas-2/q2b (Text A, L1, open, 1 marks)

Text A says: "You can sign up at the zoo shop." Give one word or phrase to replace "sign up" that keeps the meaning the same.

Answer: Join, register, enrol, put your name down.

Why: My word or phrase means about the same as "sign up". / It still makes sense in the sentence.

rl-pandas-2/q3 (Text A, L1, choice, 1 marks)

What is the main purpose of Text A?

A. To explain how baby pandas are born

B. To report news about a panda

C. To encourage people to adopt a panda

D. To advertise cheap zoo tickets

Answer: C. To encourage people to adopt a panda

Why: The leaflet explains what you get and what it costs. It is trying to persuade people to adopt a panda.

rl-pandas-2/q4 (Text B, L1, open, 3 marks)

Using Text B, give three ways that people are helping giant pandas.

Answer: Any three of: protected nature reserves; rangers checking the forests; cameras that photograph animals; corridors joining forest patches; zoos raising money; breeding programmes.

Why: I gave three different ways. / All three come from Text B. / Each one is something people do to help pandas.

rl-pandas-2/q5 (Text B, L1, open, 2 marks)

Explain why giant pandas lost their homes.

Answer: Many forests were cleared (1) to make room for farms and new buildings (1).

Why: I said that forests were cleared. / I said why they were cleared.

rl-pandas-2/q6 (Text B, L1, choice, 1 marks)

The writer uses dashes in: "The corridors – strips of forest that join one area to another – allow pandas to move safely." Why?

A. To show someone is speaking

B. To give extra information about the corridors

C. To show a list

D. To show the end of a sentence

Answer: B. To give extra information about the corridors

Why: Dashes can be used in pairs to add extra detail. Here they explain what the corridors are.

rl-pandas-2/q7 (Text B, L1, open, 2 marks)

Why are the forest corridors useful for pandas?

Answer: They let pandas move safely between patches of forest (1), so they can find food and meet mates (1).

Why: I said what the corridors let pandas do. / I said why this helps them.

rl-pandas-2/q8 (Text B, L1, multi, 2 marks)

Which TWO of these statements are facts?

A. Protected nature reserves have been set up for pandas.

B. The work to save the giant panda is the most inspiring conservation story of recent times.

C. Nothing is more important than protecting the forests where pandas live.

D. Many pandas live in small patches of forest.

Answer: A. Protected nature reserves have been set up for pandas.; D. Many pandas live in small patches of forest.

Why: Facts can be checked. Reserves existing and pandas living in small patches of forest are facts. "The most inspiring" and "nothing is more important" are views, so they are opinions.

rl-pandas-2/q9 (Text B, L1, open, 2 marks)

Give two specialist words or phrases from Text B that are connected to protecting wildlife.

Answer: Any two of: nature reserves; rangers; conservation; breeding programmes; corridors; wildlife.

Why: I gave two words or phrases. / I copied them from Text B. / Both are to do with protecting wildlife.

rl-pandas-2/q10 (Text C, L1, open, 2 marks)

Give two reasons why Year 10 decided to adopt a panda.

Answer: They learned in geography that pandas are losing their forest homes (1), and they wanted to do something about it (1).

Why: I gave two reasons. / Both come from the first paragraph of Text C.

rl-pandas-2/q11 (Text C, L1, choice, 1 marks)

What is the main purpose of Text C?

A. To persuade readers to give money

B. To explain how pandas are born

C. To warn readers about a danger

D. To describe a trip to the zoo

Answer: A. To persuade readers to give money

Why: The writers ask readers to donate and to join in, so they are trying to persuade.

rl-pandas-2/q12 (Text C, L1, open, 3 marks)

Using Text C, give three ways that readers can help.

Answer: Any three of: donate at the school office; join the sponsored silent hour; bake for the second cake sale; give whatever they can.

Why: I gave three different ways. / All three come from Text C.

rl-pandas-2/q13 (Text C, L1, open, 2 marks)

Give two examples of persuasive language from Text C.

Answer: Any two of: "Imagine a world without pandas."; "Would you want a world without them?"; "Of course not!"; "it really does make a difference"; "please give whatever you can"; "Together, we can..."; "these amazing animals".

Why: I copied two words or phrases exactly. / Both try to make the reader want to help.

rl-pandas-2/q14 (Text C, L1, open, 2 marks)

Who is Text C written for? Give one clue from the text that tells you.

Answer: Pupils, parents and staff at the school (1). Clue, for example: it asks people to donate at the school office or join the sponsored silent hour (1).

Why: I said who the text is for. / I gave a clue from the text.

rl-pandas-2/q15 (Text B,C, L1, open, 3 marks)

Text B and Text C both talk about helping pandas. Compare how each text says people can help.

Answer: Text B describes the work done by rangers and reserves in China, and says zoos help by raising money and running breeding programmes (1). Text C asks readers to give money directly by donating, joining a sponsored silent hour or baking for a cake sale (1). Both texts say money matters, but Text B explains what is done in the forests and Text C asks the reader to take part (1).

Why: I said what Text B says about how people help. / I said what Text C says about it. / I said how the two are the same or different.

READING: Working with wildlife (rl2-pandas, L2, topic: Pandas)

Text A: Starting out in animal care (Web page, Fenland College careers service) [paragraphs numbered]

[1] Do you dream of a career that involves working with animals? The wildlife and animal care sector is far bigger than most people realise, with roles for keepers, vets' assistants, conservation officers and educators. Some of the best people in the field started with no experience at all, so please do not rule yourself out.

[2] The first step is to find out which job might suit you. Visit a local zoo, farm or rescue centre, and ask the staff what an ordinary day involves. Most workers are happy to have a quick chat, and what you learn will be more useful than any brochure.

[3] You are not on your own. Careers advisers can explain the qualifications that each role requires, and your family and friends may know someone in the industry who would be glad to offer advice. Many colleges also run free taster days, which are well worth attending.

[4] Employers value practical experience above almost everything else, so volunteer as early as you can. Even a few hours a week at an animal charity shows commitment, and the skills you pick up, such as patience and teamwork, will stay with you. If you are unsure about a placement, give it a go.

[5] When you start applying, read each advert carefully and tailor your CV to it. Keep your application short, check it for mistakes and always include a covering letter. Do not be put off by rejection, because many successful keepers applied several times before they were offered a post.

[6] Finally, prepare for interviews. Research the organisation, think of examples that prove you are reliable and practise answering questions aloud. Arrive early, dress smartly and, above all, show that you genuinely care about animals. If you do all that, you're good to go.

Text B: Why conservation needs young people (Magazine article, Green Futures magazine)

Behind every successful conservation project is a team of skilled people, yet the sector is struggling to find them. The shortage is not new, but it is growing. A survey of 1,200 wildlife employers found that almost three quarters had been unable to fill at least one vacancy last year, and nearly half said that applicants simply lacked practical experience.

The consequences are serious. Giant pandas, for example, depend on a network of keepers, researchers and forest rangers who monitor their health, track their numbers and protect the bamboo forests they live in. When

posts stay empty, vital work is delayed, and projects that took years to build can quickly lose momentum.

Young people face real obstacles. Many entry-level jobs are seasonal and poorly paid, and competition for places on the best courses is fierce. Others are put off because they believe that you need a degree before you can even volunteer, which is not true. Some also worry that conservation is "a vocation rather than a career", a path that demands long hours and offers little security.

Employers are keen to change that picture. Conservation is, after all, "the long game", and a single breeding programme can take a decade to show results. That is why organisations are offering more apprenticeships, short courses and paid trainee posts than ever before, and why many now accept volunteering as proof of ability.

Advice from the Wildlife Skills Council: Thinking of a career in conservation? Start by volunteering locally. Ask about an apprenticeship rather than assuming you need a degree. Join a short course to build your confidence. And remember: you do not have to choose a path straight away.

The Council has also launched a mentoring scheme that pairs students with experienced keepers for a year, giving them hands-on training and a reference they can use when they apply for their first post.

In my view, working with wildlife is the most rewarding job anyone can do, and it deserves far more attention from schools and colleges. If you care about the natural world, there has never been a better time to get involved.

Text C: Speech to the college careers evening (Transcript of a speech, Careers evening at Fenland College)

Thank you for inviting me to speak this evening. I have been a keeper for nineteen years, and I can honestly say that I have never had a boring day. Look around this room: some of you could be doing my job in ten years' time.

I did not start at the top. At seventeen I was a volunteer, cleaning enclosures and carrying buckets of food. I was cold, tired and often muddy, but I was hooked. That first year taught me how little I knew, and I am still learning something new every single day.

So what does it take? First, you need passion. Without it, you will not survive the early starts and the long winters. Second, you need experience, and the only way to get it is by getting your hands dirty. Third, you need resilience, because things do not always go to plan. Animals are unpredictable, and so is life. I know that sounds like a lot, but nobody here learned it all at once.

Is it hard work? Of course it is. You will work again and again and again to improve your skills, and you will be asked to do a million different things before lunch. But where else could you start the day weighing a giant panda cub and finish it planning a conservation project overseas?

The results speak for themselves. Over the past decade, our breeding programme has helped to protect a dozen species, and the number of children visiting our education centre has doubled. None of that would have happened without a team of dedicated people.

People often ask me what jobs exist. Apart from keepers like me, we employ nutritionists, vet nurses, education officers and a volunteer coordinator, who has the hardest job of all: keeping people like me in order.

Last month, a student who started with us as a volunteer was offered a full-time post. She was nervous, as we all are, but she kept turning up and she kept learning. That is all it takes to begin.

You will find the work exhausting, exhilarating and utterly worthwhile. Not every day will be easy, but every day will matter. So jump in with both feet, apply for the placements and show them what you can do. Thank you.

Questions

rl2-pandas/q1 (Text A, L2, open, 2 marks)

Your friend wants to find out what working with animals is really like. Using Text A, identify two ways of finding out.

Answer: Any two of: visit a local zoo, farm or rescue centre and ask the staff what a normal day involves (1); speak to someone you know who works in the industry (1); go to a free taster day at a college (1).

Why: I gave two different ways. / Both come from Text A. / Each is a way of finding out what the job is like.

rl2-pandas/q2 (Text A, L2, choice, 1 marks)

Which word best describes the tone of Text A?

A. Sarcastic

B. Threatening

C. Encouraging

D. Nostalgic

Answer: C. Encouraging

Why: The writer keeps reassuring the reader ("do not rule yourself out", "you are not on your own"). That is encouraging.

rl2-pandas/q3 (Text A, L2, multi, 2 marks)

Which TWO of these quotations from Text A are examples of formal language?

A. "The wildlife and animal care sector is far bigger than most people realise"

B. "happy to have a quick chat"

C. "give it a go"

D. "Employers value practical experience above almost everything else"

E. "you're good to go"

Answer: A. "The wildlife and animal care sector is far bigger than most people realise"; D. "Employers value practical experience above almost everything else"

Why: Formal language sounds serious and careful, with no slang or shortened words. "Chat", "give it a go" and "you're good to go" are casual, everyday phrases, so they are informal.

rl2-pandas/q4 (Text A, L2, match, 2 marks)

You have been asked to add subheadings to each paragraph in Text A. Choose the paragraph number that best matches each subheading. Three have been done for you.

Subheadings: Interview tips; Find out first; Applying; Why animal care?; Gain experience; Who can help (paragraphs 1 to 6)

Answer: Interview tips → paragraph 6 (given); Find out first → paragraph 2; Applying → paragraph 5; Why animal care? → paragraph 1 (given); Gain experience → paragraph 4; Who can help → paragraph 3 (given)

Why: Each subheading sums up one paragraph: paragraph 2 is about finding out what jobs involve, paragraph 4 about gaining experience, and paragraph 5 about applying.

rl2-pandas/q5 (Text B, L2, open, 2 marks)

What does each of these quotations from Text B suggest about conservation work? "a vocation rather than a career" and "the long game"

Answer: "A vocation rather than a career" suggests it is something people do out of deep commitment or passion, not just for the pay (1). "The long game" suggests that results take many years, so people need

patience (1).

Why: I explained the first quotation in my own words. / I explained the second quotation in my own words. / I did not just copy the quotations.

rl2-pandas/q6 (Text B, L2, choice, 1 marks)

Text B includes both facts and opinions. Which one of these statements is an opinion?

A. Almost three quarters of wildlife employers could not fill a vacancy last year.

B. Giant pandas depend on keepers, researchers and rangers.

C. Working with wildlife is the most rewarding job anyone can do.

D. The Wildlife Skills Council has launched a mentoring scheme.

Answer: C. Working with wildlife is the most rewarding job anyone can do.

Why: The first, second and fourth statements can be checked. "The most rewarding job anyone can do" is a personal view, so it is an opinion.

rl2-pandas/q7a (Text B, L2, open, 1 marks)

Who provides advice for young people in Text B?

Answer: The Wildlife Skills Council.

Why: I named the organisation. / It comes from the box in Text B.

rl2-pandas/q7b (Text B, L2, choice, 1 marks)

Which organisational feature is used to present this advice?

A. A text box

B. A numbered list

C. Subheadings

D. A table

Answer: A. A text box

Why: The advice is set apart in a box, so readers can find it quickly.

rl2-pandas/q8a (Text B, L2, open, 2 marks)

Using Text B, identify two problems that young people face when trying to enter conservation.

Answer: Any two of: many entry-level jobs are seasonal and poorly paid (1); competition for the best courses is fierce (1); they believe they need a degree even to volunteer (1); they worry it demands long hours and offers little security (1).

Why: I gave two different problems. / Both are problems for young people, not employers.

rl2-pandas/q8b (Text B, L2, open, 2 marks)

Using Text B, identify two suggestions to help young people get started in conservation.

Answer: Any two of: volunteer locally (1); ask about an apprenticeship (1); join a short course (1); take part in the mentoring scheme (1); take paid trainee posts (1).

Why: I gave two different suggestions. / Both come from Text B.

rl2-pandas/q9 (Text C, L2, open, 2 marks)

Using Text C, give two quotations that suggest there is a lot to learn if you want to work in conservation.

Answer: Any two of: "That first year taught me how little I knew" (1); "I am still learning something new every single day" (1); "you need experience, and the only way to get it is by getting your hands dirty" (1); "you will work again and again and again to improve your skills" (1).

Why: I copied two quotations. / Each one suggests there is a lot to learn. / I did not just paraphrase.

rl2-pandas/q10 (Text C, L2, open, 4 marks)

Using Text C, identify two language features used to inspire the audience to consider a career in conservation. Give an example to support each answer.

Answer: Any two features, each with a linked example: direct address (1), e.g. "Thank you for inviting me" or "Look around this room" (1); first person or personal experience (1), e.g. "I did not start at the top" (1); rule of three (1), e.g. "exhausting, exhilarating and utterly worthwhile" or "First... Second... Third..." (1); rhetorical question (1), e.g. "Is it hard work?" (1); hyperbole (1), e.g. "a million different things before lunch" (1); repetition (1), e.g. "again and again and again" (1); statistics or figures (1), e.g. "nineteen years" or "has doubled" (1); positive language (1), e.g. "worthwhile" (1).

Why: I named one language feature. / I gave an example that matches it. / I named a second, different feature. / I gave an example that matches the second one.

rl2-pandas/q11 (Text C, L2, choice, 1 marks)

Which one of these quotations from Text C shows that the speaker has a positive view of working in conservation?

A. "I was cold, tired and often muddy"

B. "Animals are unpredictable, and so is life"

C. "I can honestly say that I have never had a boring day"

D. "things do not always go to plan"

Answer: C. "I can honestly say that I have never had a boring day"

Why: The first, second and fourth quotations describe difficulties. "Never had a boring day" shows the speaker enjoys the work.

rl2-pandas/q12a (Text A,C, L2, open, 1 marks)

You may use a dictionary. Text A says: "shows commitment". Give one word or phrase to replace "commitment" that keeps the meaning the same.

Answer: Dedication, determination, loyalty, devotion, dependability.

Why: My word means about the same as "commitment". / It still makes sense in the sentence.

rl2-pandas/q12b (Text A,C, L2, open, 1 marks)

Text C says: "you need resilience". Give one word or phrase to replace "resilience" that keeps the meaning the same.

Answer: Toughness, strength, perseverance, the ability to cope or recover after problems.

Why: My word or phrase means about the same as "resilience". / It still makes sense in the sentence.

rl2-pandas/q13 (Text A,C, L2, open, 6 marks)

Compare similar ideas from Text A and Text C about how people can prepare for a career in animal care. In your answer you should: give two similarities from these texts; give one quotation from Text A and one quotation from Text C to support each similarity.

Answer: Any two similarities, each with a supporting quotation from each text. Passion or caring about animals (1): A "show that you genuinely care about animals" (1), C "you need passion" (1). Practical experience (1): A "Employers value practical experience above almost everything else" (1), C "you need experience, and the only way to get it is by getting your hands dirty" (1). Not giving up after setbacks (1): A "Do not be put off by rejection" (1), C "you need resilience, because things do not always go to plan" (1).

Why: I gave a first similarity. / I gave a quotation from Text A for it. / I gave a quotation from Text C for it. / I gave a second, different similarity. / I gave a quotation from Text A for it. / I gave a quotation from Text C for it.

rl2-pandas/q14 (Text A,B, L2, choice, 1 marks)

Which one of these statements about the language used in Text A and Text B is correct?

A. Both use statistics to support their points.

B. Both use direct address to speak to the reader.

C. Both use humour to appeal to the reader.

D. Both use personal stories from the writer's own life.

> Answer: B. Both use direct address to speak to the reader.
>
> Why: Both talk to the reader as "you" (for example "You are not on your own" and "Thinking of a career in conservation?"). Only Text B uses statistics, and neither is humorous or tells a personal story.

rl2-pandas/q15 (Text A,B,C, L2, open, 3 marks)

Your friend wants information about different jobs in animal care and conservation. Identify one job role from each of the three texts.

> Answer: Text A: keepers, vets' assistants, conservation officers or educators (1). Text B: researchers or forest rangers (1) (keepers is also in Text B). Text C: nutritionists, vet nurses, education officers or a volunteer coordinator (1).
>
> Why: I gave one job from Text A. / I gave one job from Text B. / I gave one job from Text C.

READING: Floating in the Dead Sea (rl-israel, L1, topic: Israel)

Text A: Dead Sea day trip (Web page, Wanderwise Tours website)

Float in the famous Dead Sea on a relaxed day out from Tel Aviv. Our friendly guide will tell you all about the area on the journey.

What is included

A minibus, towels, a picnic lunch and entry to the beach.

Times

We leave at 8:00 am and return at 5:00 pm. Please be at the meeting point ten minutes early.

What to bring

Sun cream, a hat and sandals that you can wear in the water.

Price

Adults £45. Children under 14 £30.

Text B: Floating in the Dead Sea: what to expect (Magazine article, Wanderwise Tours travel magazine)

The Dead Sea is one of the most unusual places in the world. It sits more than 400 metres below sea level, which makes it the lowest place on land on Earth, and its water is so salty that it holds your body up. Even people who cannot swim can lie back and float.

How to get the most from your visit

Local guide Noa Levi has taken hundreds of visitors to the Dead Sea, and she has some simple advice. "Walk in slowly, sit down in the water and then lean back," she says. "Never put your head under, and keep splashing to a minimum. Salt water in the eyes really stings."

Salt water also stings tiny cuts, so avoid shaving on the morning of your visit. Most people stay in the water for a short time (about 15 minutes is enough), because the salt can dry out your skin. Afterwards, rinse off in

the fresh water showers on the beach, which also has changing rooms nearby.

Mud and minerals

Many visitors cover themselves in the dark mud from the shore. The mud is full of minerals, and it makes your skin feel wonderfully soft. Let it dry for a few minutes in the sun, then wash it off in the sea. Do not forget to take a camera, but keep it somewhere dry!

Sun and water

It can be extremely hot by the Dead Sea, even in the early morning. Wear a hat, put on plenty of sun cream and drink lots of fresh water. Wear sandals, too, because the stones on the shore can be sharp. Children should always stay close to an adult in the water.

Floating there is the most relaxing thing you can do on holiday, and it is an experience you will never forget.

Text C: Re: Is the Dead Sea day trip worth it? (Forum post, Travel Talk forum, thread: "Is the Dead Sea day trip worth it?")

Hi! I went last spring with two friends and I'd say yes, it's worth it, but go early. The guide on our minibus was lovely and told us loads about the desert on the way, which made the long journey go quickly.

Floating was the weirdest and funniest thing I've ever done. You just lie back and the water holds you up, no effort at all! We took loads of photos of each other reading the paper, which I know everyone does.

The not-so-great bits: the beach was packed by 11 o'clock and it was boiling. I splashed water in my eye and it stung like mad, so listen when they tell you not to put your head under. The salt also dries on your skin and feels sticky, so use the showers. The picnic lunch was a bit boring too: just a cheese sandwich and an apple. Overall though, I'd go again in a heartbeat.

My tips:

- Go as early as you can.
- Take a bottle of fresh water to drink and to rinse your face.
- Wear sandals, because the stones are sharp.
- Don't forget sun cream.

Hope that helps. Has anyone else been?

Questions

rl-israel/q1a (Text A, L1, open, 1 marks)

Using Text A, give one thing that is included in the day trip.

Answer: Any one of: a minibus; towels; a picnic lunch; entry to the beach.

Why: I gave one thing. / It comes from the section "What is included".

rl-israel/q1b (Text A, L1, choice, 1 marks)

Which feature of Text A helped you find this information?

A. Subheadings

B. Bullet points

C. A numbered list

D. A speech bubble

Answer: A. Subheadings

Why: Each part of the page has its own subheading, such as "What is included", so you can go straight to the one you need.

rl-israel/q2a (Text A, L1, open, 1 marks)

Text A says: "We leave at 8:00 am and return at 5:00 pm." Give one word or phrase to replace "return" that keeps the meaning the same.

Answer: Come back, get back, arrive back, go back.

Why: My word or phrase means about the same as "return". / It still makes sense in the sentence.

rl-israel/q2b (Text A, L1, open, 1 marks)

Text A says: "entry to the beach". Give one word or phrase to replace "entry" that keeps the meaning the same.

Answer: Admission, access, a ticket, getting in.

Why: My word or phrase means about the same as "entry". / It still makes sense in the sentence.

rl-israel/q3 (Text A, L1, choice, 1 marks)

What is the main purpose of Text A?

A. To give information about a day trip

B. To warn people about the heat

C. To explain why the Dead Sea is salty

D. To ask people for feedback

Answer: A. To give information about a day trip

Why: The text sets out what is included, the times, what to bring and the price, so it is giving information about the trip.

rl-israel/q4 (Text B, L1, open, 3 marks)

Using Text B, give three pieces of advice for people visiting the Dead Sea.

Answer: Any three of: walk in slowly and lean back; never put your head under the water; keep splashing to a minimum; avoid shaving that morning; stay in for a short time; rinse off afterwards; wear a hat, sun cream and sandals; drink lots of fresh water.

Why: I gave three different pieces of advice. / All three come from Text B. / Each one tells the reader what to do or not to do.

rl-israel/q5 (Text B, L1, open, 2 marks)

Explain why people who cannot swim can still float in the Dead Sea.

Answer: The water is very salty (1), so it holds the body up (1).

Why: I said the water is very salty. / I said that this holds the body up.

rl-israel/q6 (Text B, L1, choice, 1 marks)

The writer puts "about 15 minutes is enough" inside brackets. Why?

A. To give extra information

B. To show someone is speaking

C. To show a question

D. To show a list

Answer: A. To give extra information

Why: Brackets add extra detail that is useful but not essential to the sentence. Here they tell the reader how long "a short time" is.

rl-israel/q7 (Text B, L1, open, 2 marks)

Why does Noa Levi say visitors should avoid shaving on the morning of their visit?

Answer: Salt water stings tiny cuts (1), and shaving can leave tiny cuts on the skin (1).

Why: I said what the salt water does. / I linked it to tiny cuts from shaving.

rl-israel/q8 (Text B, L1, multi, 2 marks)

Which TWO of these statements are facts?

A. Floating there is the most relaxing thing you can do on holiday.

B. The Dead Sea sits more than 400 metres below sea level.

C. The mud makes your skin feel wonderfully soft.

D. The water is so salty that it holds your body up.

Answer: B. The Dead Sea sits more than 400 metres below sea level.; D. The water is so salty that it holds your body up.

Why: Facts can be checked. How far below sea level the Dead Sea sits, and the fact that very salty water holds you up, are facts. "Most relaxing" and "wonderfully soft" are views, so they are opinions.

rl-israel/q9 (Text B, L1, open, 2 marks)

Give two specialist words or phrases from Text B that are connected to nature or geography.

Answer: Any two of: below sea level; salty; minerals; mud; shore; the lowest place on land.

Why: I gave two words or phrases. / I copied them from Text B. / Both are to do with nature or geography.

rl-israel/q10 (Text C, L1, open, 2 marks)

Give two things the writer of Text C did not like about the day.

Answer: Any two of: the beach was packed by 11 o'clock; it was boiling hot; water stung the writer's eye; the salt felt sticky on the skin; the picnic lunch was boring.

Why: I gave two different things. / Both come from "The not-so-great bits".

rl-israel/q11 (Text C, L1, choice, 1 marks)

What does the writer think of the day trip overall?

A. It is not worth the money.

B. It is worth it, but go early.

C. It is only suitable for children.

D. It is too dangerous.

Answer: B. It is worth it, but go early.

Why: The writer says "yes, it's worth it, but go early".

rl-israel/q12 (Text C, L1, open, 3 marks)

Using Text C, give three pieces of advice for people planning a trip to the Dead Sea.

Answer: Any three of: go as early as you can; take a bottle of fresh water; wear sandals; take sun cream; do not put your head under the water.

Why: I gave three different pieces of advice. / All three come from Text C.

rl-israel/q13 (Text C, L1, open, 2 marks)

Give two examples of informal language from Text C.

Answer: Any two of: "weirdest", "loads", "boiling", "stung like mad", "Hi!", "I know everyone does".

Why: I copied two words or phrases exactly. / They are chatty, everyday words, not formal ones.

rl-israel/q14 (Text C, L1, open, 2 marks)

Who is Text C written for? Give one clue from the text that tells you.

Answer: People thinking about taking the day trip (1). Clue, for example: the tips ("Go as early as you can") or the question at the end (1).

Why: I said who the text is for. / I gave a clue from the text.

rl-israel/q15 (Text B,C, L1, open, 3 marks)

Compare what Text B and Text C say about getting salt water in your eyes.

Answer: Text B warns visitors never to put their head under and to keep splashing to a minimum, because salt water in the eyes "really stings" (1). Text C's writer splashed water in their eye and says it "stung like mad" (1). So both say it hurts, but Text B gives the warning and Text C shows what happens when it goes wrong (1).

Why: I said what Text B says about salt water in the eyes. / I said what Text C says about it. / I said how the two are the same or different.

READING: Markets and food (rl-israel-2, L1, topic: Israel)

Text A: Easy shakshuka (Recipe web page, Everyday Kitchen website)

Shakshuka is a tasty breakfast dish from Israel. It is made with eggs cooked in a spicy tomato sauce.

You will need: 4 eggs, 1 onion, 2 red peppers, 1 tin of tomatoes and 1 teaspoon of cumin.

Cook the chopped onion and peppers for ten minutes. Add the tomatoes and cumin, then cook for five more minutes. Next, crack the eggs into the sauce and cook until they are firm. Serve with fresh bread. It takes about thirty minutes to make, and it serves four people.

Text B: Eating your way around the markets of Israel (Magazine article, Table & Trail food magazine)

If you want to understand a country, visit its food markets. In Israel, the biggest markets, such as the Carmel Market in Tel Aviv and the Mahane Yehuda Market in Jerusalem, are noisy, colourful places where stallholders shout out their prices and the smell of fresh bread fills the air. Markets are also where local people do their everyday shopping, not just tourists. Allow at least two hours to explore.

What can you eat?

Almost every market has a stall selling falafel, which are crispy balls made from chickpeas, usually served in warm pitta bread with salad. You will also find hummus, a smooth dip made from chickpeas, tahini (a paste made from sesame seeds) and lemon. Many cafés serve small dishes called "mezze", which are shared by everyone at the table. Fresh pitta is baked in the market every hour, so it is often still warm when you buy it.

More than food

Look out for the spice stalls, which sell bags of colourful spices piled high in sacks. There are also stalls selling fresh fruit and vegetables, olives, cheese, dried fruit and nuts. Many vendors are happy to let customers taste before they buy. Some markets also have musicians, so you can enjoy a tune while you shop.

When should you go?

Friday is the busiest day. Many shops close for Shabbat, the day of rest, which begins on Friday evening, so people shop for the weekend before it starts. Food writer Yael Cohen advises going in the morning: "The crowds are smaller and the fruit and vegetables are at their freshest."

Whatever time you go, bring cash and wear comfortable shoes. The falafel at the Carmel Market is the best in the world, and you will fall in love with the food.

Text C: Review: Tel Aviv market food tour (Online review, Taste Tours review page)

Rating: 4 out of 5 stars

We booked this three-hour food tour on our second day in Tel Aviv, and it was a delicious way to see the city. Our guide, Dani, was friendly and funny, and he knew everyone at the market.

The best part was the tasting stops. We tried warm falafel, creamy hummus and sweet, sticky pastries, and every single dish was fantastic. Dani also took us to a spice stall, where we learned how to tell fresh spices from old ones. He also told us the story behind each dish, and he gave us a map so we could find our favourite stalls again the next day. The tour started on time and finished exactly when promised.

However, the tour was too crowded. There were 25 people in our group, so it was hard to hear Dani over the noise of the market. It was also very hot, and we only stopped for water once.

Top tips:

Come hungry, because there is a lot to eat.

Wear a hat and bring a bottle of water.

Book the morning tour to avoid the crowds.

I would definitely recommend this tour, but only if the group were smaller!

Questions

rl-israel-2/q1a (Text A, L1, open, 1 marks)

Using Text A, give one thing you need to make shakshuka.

Answer: Any one of: 4 eggs; 1 onion; 2 red peppers; 1 tin of tomatoes; 1 teaspoon of cumin.

Why: I gave one thing. / It comes from the "You will need" list in Text A.

rl-israel-2/q1b (Text A, L1, choice, 1 marks)

Which feature of Text A helped you find the things you need?

A. Bold words

B. A menu

C. A speech bubble

D. A text box

Answer: A. Bold words

Why: The amounts are printed in bold, so they stand out from the rest of the sentence.

rl-israel-2/q2a (Text A, L1, open, 1 marks)

Text A says: "Shakshuka is a tasty breakfast dish." Give one word or phrase to replace "tasty" that keeps the meaning the same.

Answer: Delicious, yummy, flavoursome, appetising.

Why: My word means about the same as "tasty". / It still makes sense in the sentence.

rl-israel-2/q2b (Text A, L1, open, 1 marks)

Text A says: "Next, crack the eggs into the sauce." Give one word or phrase to replace "crack" that keeps the meaning the same.

Answer: Break, split open, break open.

Why: My word or phrase means about the same as "crack". / It still makes sense in the sentence.

rl-israel-2/q3 (Text A, L1, choice, 1 marks)

What is the main purpose of Text A?

A. To describe a trip to Israel

B. To explain how to make a dish

C. To advertise a restaurant

D. To compare breakfast around the world

Answer: B. To explain how to make a dish

Why: The text lists what you need, then gives steps in order. It is telling the reader how to make shakshuka.

rl-israel-2/q4 (Text B, L1, open, 3 marks)

Using Text B, give three things you can buy at a market in Israel.

Answer: Any three of: falafel; hummus; pitta bread; spices; fresh fruit and vegetables; olives; cheese; dried fruit; nuts; fresh bread.

Why: I gave three different things. / All three come from Text B. / Each one is something you can buy.

rl-israel-2/q5 (Text B, L1, open, 2 marks)

Explain why Friday is the busiest day at the markets.

Answer: Many shops close for Shabbat, the day of rest, which begins on Friday evening (1), so people shop for the weekend before it starts (1).

Why: I said that shops close for Shabbat. / I said that people shop before it starts.

rl-israel-2/q6 (Text B, L1, choice, 1 marks)

The writer puts the word "mezze" inside inverted commas. Why?

A. To show it is a special word that is then explained

B. To show someone is speaking

C. To show it is a mistake

D. To show it is a place

Answer: A. To show it is a special word that is then explained

Why: Inverted commas can mark a special or unfamiliar word. Here the writer goes on to explain what "mezze" are.

rl-israel-2/q7 (Text B, L1, open, 2 marks)

Why does Yael Cohen advise visitors to go in the morning?

Answer: The crowds are smaller (1), and the fruit and vegetables are at their freshest (1).

Why: I said that the crowds are smaller. / I said that the produce is fresher.

rl-israel-2/q8 (Text B, L1, multi, 2 marks)

Which TWO of these statements are facts?

A. The falafel at the Carmel Market is the best in the world.

B. Falafel are made from chickpeas.

C. You will fall in love with the food.

D. The Carmel Market is in Tel Aviv.

Answer: B. Falafel are made from chickpeas.; D. The Carmel Market is in Tel Aviv.

Why: Facts can be checked. What falafel are made from and where the Carmel Market is are facts. "The best in the world" and "you will fall in love" are views, so they are opinions.

rl-israel-2/q9 (Text B, L1, open, 2 marks)

Give two specialist words or phrases from Text B that are connected to food.

Answer: Any two of: falafel; hummus; tahini; mezze; spices; stallholders; produce; vendors; chickpeas.

Why: I gave two words or phrases. / I copied them from Text B. / Both are to do with food.

rl-israel-2/q10 (Text C, L1, open, 2 marks)

Give two things the writer of Text C did not like about the tour.

Answer: Any two of: the group was too crowded (25 people); it was hard to hear the guide; it was very hot; they only stopped for water once.

Why: I gave two different things. / Both come from the fourth paragraph.

rl-israel-2/q11 (Text C, L1, choice, 1 marks)

What does the writer think of the tour overall?

A. It was terrible.

B. It was good, but the group was too big.

C. It was too expensive.

D. It was too short.

Answer: B. It was good, but the group was too big.

Why: The writer gave four out of five stars, praised the food and the guide, but said the group was too crowded.

rl-israel-2/q12 (Text C, L1, open, 3 marks)

Using Text C, give three pieces of advice for people booking the tour.

Answer: Any three of: come hungry; wear a hat; bring a bottle of water; book the morning tour.

Why: I gave three different pieces of advice. / All three come from the list in Text C.

rl-israel-2/q13 (Text C, L1, open, 2 marks)

Give two examples of words or phrases from Text C that show the writer's opinion.

Answer: Any two of: "delicious"; "friendly and funny"; "fantastic"; "too crowded"; "definitely recommend"; "creamy"; "sweet, sticky".

Why: I copied two words or phrases exactly. / Both show what the writer thinks or feels.

rl-israel-2/q14 (Text C, L1, open, 2 marks)

Who is Text C written for? Give one clue from the text that tells you.

Answer: People who are thinking of booking the tour (1). Clue, for example: it gives "Top tips" and says "Book the morning tour" (1).

Why: I said who the text is for. / I gave a clue from the text.

rl-israel-2/q15 (Text B,C, L1, open, 3 marks)

Compare what Text B and Text C say about crowds at the markets.

Answer: Text B says Friday is the busiest day and that crowds are smaller in the morning, which is also when fruit and vegetables are freshest (1). Text C says the tour was too crowded and recommends booking the morning tour to avoid the crowds (1). Both texts say mornings are the best time to avoid crowds, but Text C is about a tour group and Text B is about the markets themselves (1).

Why: I said what Text B says about crowds. / I said what Text C says about them. / I said how the two are the same or different.

READING: Slow travel in Israel (rl2-israel, L2, topic: Israel)

Text A: Planning an independent trip (Web page, Wayfarer Travel Guides) [paragraphs numbered]

[1] Travelling independently means choosing your own route, your own pace and your own surprises. Israel is small enough to cross in a day, yet varied enough to fill several weeks, with beaches, deserts, mountains and ancient cities all within a few hours of each other.

[2] Getting around is easier than many visitors expect. Trains run along the coast and between the larger cities, and buses reach most towns and villages. Shared taxis, which follow set routes and leave when full, are a cheap way to cover short distances. It is worth buying a rechargeable travel card as soon as you arrive.

[3] There is a place to stay for every budget. Hostels are popular with younger travellers, while family-run guesthouses offer a warm welcome and a home-cooked breakfast. Some kibbutz guesthouses, set among orchards and fields, are surprisingly affordable. Book your first night in advance, then see where the road takes you.

[4] Food is half the adventure. Markets are the best place to start: you can sample fresh bread, olives and spices before you buy, and a plate of hummus with warm pitta rarely costs much. Do not be shy about asking what is in a dish, and always give the local shakshuka a go.

[5] Be prepared for the weather. Summers are very hot, so carry water, wear a hat and plan long walks for early morning. Winters are mild but can be wet, especially in the north, so pack a light waterproof as well.

[6] Finally, respect local customs. Many businesses close from Friday afternoon until Saturday evening for Shabbat, so shop for supplies early, and dress modestly when you visit places of worship. A friendly greeting in Hebrew costs nothing, and you will be amazed at how far it goes.

Text B: The rise of slow travel (Magazine article, Slow Journeys magazine)

More travellers are rejecting the whirlwind tour in favour of a gentler pace. A survey of 2,000 holidaymakers by the Slow Journeys Panel found that 62 per cent now prefer to stay in fewer places for longer, and more than half said they wanted a trip that left a lighter footprint on the places they visited. Travel companies are taking notice, and more itineraries now include free days and local homestays.

Slow travel is not simply about moving less. It is about spending time in markets, cafés and small villages, which offer "a window into everyday life" that no guidebook can match. In Israel, where a morning's drive can take you from a Mediterranean beach to a desert canyon, that approach can transform a trip, because there is always something new within reach.

Walkers are leading the way. Long-distance trails attract growing numbers each year, and many follow routes "off the beaten track", passing through farmland, forests and quiet communities that few tourists ever see. Cyclists and campers are following close behind, pitching their tents beside streams and hilltop viewpoints.

Of course, there are difficulties. Taking more time costs more money, and some travellers find language barriers daunting. Others struggle to plan a flexible route, particularly in summer, when daytime temperatures can make walking uncomfortable. A few simply worry that they will miss the famous sights, and return home feeling that they have not done enough.

Advice from the Travel Better Network: Learn a few words of the local language. Book your first night, but leave the rest open. Use public transport whenever you can. And remember: slow travel is about quality, not quantity.

The Network also runs a free phrase-sharing website, where experienced travellers post tips on everything from bargaining in markets to finding the best walking routes. It has attracted thousands of members in its first year.

In my opinion, slow travel is the best way to see any country, and every traveller should try it at least once. If you have ever returned from a holiday feeling more tired than when you left, this may be the answer.

Text C: Talk given at a travel fair (Transcript of a talk, Wanderlust Travel Fair)

Good afternoon, everyone, and thank you for coming. I have been travelling around Israel for eleven years, and I still find something new on every trip. Today I want to convince you to put down the itinerary, pick up a rucksack and go.

My first visit was a disaster, and I loved every minute of it. I missed my train, lost my map and ended up in a village I had never heard of. An old man invited me for coffee, and three hours later I knew his whole family story. That is when I realised that the best moments are never on the schedule.

So what do you really need? First, you need curiosity. Ask questions, taste everything and talk to strangers. Second, you need flexibility, because buses are late and plans change. Third, you need patience, because the best stories take time to unfold.

Will it always be comfortable? Honestly, no. You will be hot, hungry and lost at least once. But where else could you float in the Dead Sea at breakfast, eat the best hummus of your life at lunch, and watch the sun set over the desert before dinner?

The numbers back me up. Last year, more than forty thousand people took part in our walking festival, and nine out of ten said they would come back. That is not bad for an event that began with twelve friends and a single map.

People often ask where to stay. My answer is simple: wherever you are welcome. I have slept in hostels, in a tent under the stars, in a kibbutz guesthouse among the orange groves and, once, on a friend's sofa in Haifa. Every one of those places taught me something.

I have also learned to be spontaneous. If someone says, "Come with us," say yes. If the path looks interesting, take it. If the market smells wonderful, follow your nose. Nobody ever regretted saying yes to a good adventure, and I have never met a traveller who wished they had planned more.

You will find it exhausting, funny, humbling and unforgettable. Not every day will go to plan, but every day will be yours. So take a deep breath, buy the ticket and go. Thank you.

Questions

rl2-israel/q1 (Text A, L2, open, 2 marks)

Your friend wants advice on getting around. Using Text A, identify two types of transport.

Answer: Any two of: trains (1); buses (1); shared taxis (1).

Why: I gave two different types of transport. / Both come from Text A.

rl2-israel/q2 (Text A, L2, choice, 1 marks)

Which word best describes the style of Text A?

A. Poetic

B. Practical

C. Sarcastic

D. Mournful

Answer: B. Practical

Why: The writer gives clear, useful tips about transport, accommodation, food and weather in a friendly way. That is practical.

rl2-israel/q3 (Text A, L2, multi, 2 marks)

Which TWO of these quotations from Text A are examples of informal language?

A. "Hostels are popular with younger travellers"

B. "a cheap way to cover short distances"

C. "see where the road takes you"

D. "always give the local shakshuka a go"

E. "Many businesses close from Friday afternoon"

Answer: C. "see where the road takes you"; D. "always give the local shakshuka a go"

Why: Informal language is relaxed and chatty, using everyday expressions. "See where the road takes you" and "give the local shakshuka a go" are casual, everyday phrases. The other quotations sound more factual and neutral.

rl2-israel/q4 (Text A, L2, match, 2 marks)

You have been asked to add subheadings to each paragraph in Text A. Choose the paragraph number that best matches each subheading. Three have been done for you.

Subheadings: Local customs; Weather and packing; Why go it alone?; Food and markets; Where to stay; Getting around (paragraphs 1 to 6)

Answer: Local customs → paragraph 6 (given); Weather and packing → paragraph 5; Why go it alone? → paragraph 1 (given); Food and markets → paragraph 4; Where to stay → paragraph 3 (given); Getting around → paragraph 2

Why: Each subheading sums up one paragraph: paragraph 2 is about transport, paragraph 4 about food and paragraph 5 about the weather.

rl2-israel/q5 (Text B, L2, open, 2 marks)

What does each of these quotations from Text B suggest about slow travel? "a window into everyday life" and "off the beaten track"

Answer: "A window into everyday life" suggests that slow travel shows you how local people really live (1). "Off the beaten track" suggests going to quiet places that most tourists never visit (1).

Why: I explained the first quotation in my own words. / I explained the second quotation in my own words. / I did not just copy the quotations.

rl2-israel/q6 (Text B, L2, choice, 1 marks)

Text B includes both facts and opinions. Which one of these statements is an opinion?

A. 62 per cent of the holidaymakers surveyed prefer to stay in fewer places for longer.

B. Long-distance trails attract growing numbers each year.

C. The Travel Better Network runs a free phrase-sharing website.

D. Slow travel is the best way to see any country.

Answer: D. Slow travel is the best way to see any country.

Why: The first three statements report things that can be checked. "The best way to see any country" is a personal view, so it is an opinion.

rl2-israel/q7a (Text B, L2, open, 1 marks)

Who provides advice for travellers in Text B?

Answer: The Travel Better Network.

Why: I named the organisation. / It comes from the box in Text B.

rl2-israel/q7b (Text B, L2, choice, 1 marks)

Which organisational feature is used to present this advice?

A. Subheadings

B. A text box

C. A bulleted list

D. A table

Answer: B. A text box

Why: The advice is set in a box, which makes it stand out from the rest of the article.

rl2-israel/q8a (Text B, L2, open, 2 marks)

Using Text B, identify two problems that slow travellers may face.

Answer: Any two of: taking more time costs more money (1); language barriers can be daunting (1); it can be hard to plan a flexible route (1); daytime heat in summer makes walking uncomfortable (1); some worry they will miss the famous sights (1).

Why: I gave two different problems. / Both come from Text B.

rl2-israel/q8b (Text B, L2, open, 2 marks)

Using Text B, identify two suggestions to help people travel slowly.

Answer: Any two of: learn a few words of the local language (1); book the first night but leave the rest open (1); use public transport (1); use the free phrase-sharing website (1).

Why: I gave two different suggestions. / Both come from Text B.

rl2-israel/q9 (Text C, L2, open, 2 marks)

Using Text C, give two quotations that suggest you should not plan every detail of a trip.

Answer: Any two of: "the best moments are never on the schedule" (1); "buses are late and plans change" (1); "put down the itinerary" (1); "I have never met a traveller who wished they had planned more" (1); "If the path looks interesting, take it" (1).

Why: I copied two quotations. / Each one suggests not planning everything. / I did not just paraphrase.

rl2-israel/q10 (Text C, L2, open, 4 marks)

Using Text C, identify two language features used to persuade the audience to travel in this way. Give an example to support each answer.

Answer: Any two features, each with a linked example: direct address (1), e.g. "thank you for coming" or "put down the itinerary" (1); personal experience or first person (1), e.g. "My first visit was a disaster" (1); rule of three (1), e.g. "curiosity... flexibility... patience" or "exhausting, funny, humbling and unforgettable" (1); rhetorical question (1), e.g. "Will it always be comfortable?" (1); hyperbole (1), e.g. "the best hummus of your life" (1); statistics (1), e.g. "more than forty thousand people" (1); positive language (1), e.g. "unforgettable" (1).

Why: I named one language feature. / I gave an example that matches it. / I named a second, different feature. / I gave an example that matches the second one.

rl2-israel/q11 (Text C, L2, choice, 1 marks)

Which one of these quotations from Text C shows that the speaker has a positive view of travelling around Israel?

A. "buses are late and plans change"

B. "I still find something new on every trip"

C. "You will be hot, hungry and lost at least once"

D. "I missed my train, lost my map"

Answer: B. "I still find something new on every trip"

Why: The other quotations describe things that go wrong. "Something new on every trip" shows the speaker is still excited after eleven years.

rl2-israel/q12a (Text A,C, L2, open, 1 marks)

You may use a dictionary. Text A says: "surprisingly affordable". Give one word or phrase to replace "affordable" that keeps the meaning the same.

Answer: Cheap, inexpensive, reasonably priced, low-cost, within budget.

Why: My word means about the same as "affordable". / It still makes sense in the sentence.

rl2-israel/q12b (Text A,C, L2, open, 1 marks)

Text C says: "I have also learned to be spontaneous". Give one word or phrase to replace "spontaneous" that keeps the meaning the same.

Answer: Unplanned, impulsive, flexible, carefree, willing to act on the spur of the moment.

Why: My word or phrase means about the same as "spontaneous". / It still makes sense in the sentence.

rl2-israel/q13 (Text A,C, L2, open, 6 marks)

Compare similar ideas from Text A and Text C about how travellers can get the most from a trip. In your answer you should: give two similarities from these texts; give one quotation from Text A and one quotation from Text C to support each similarity.

Answer: Any two similarities, each with a supporting quotation from each text. Trying local food (1): A "always give the local shakshuka a go" (1), C "taste everything" (1). Being friendly to local people (1): A "A friendly greeting in Hebrew costs nothing" (1), C "talk to strangers" (1). Staying flexible about plans (1): A "see where the road takes you" (1), C "plans change" (1).

Why: I gave a first similarity. / I gave a quotation from Text A for it. / I gave a quotation from Text C for it. / I gave a second, different similarity. / I gave a quotation from Text A for it. / I gave a quotation from Text C for it.

rl2-israel/q14 (Text A,B, L2, choice, 1 marks)

Which one of these statements about the language used in Text A and Text B is correct?

A. Both use statistics to support their points.

B. Both use humour to appeal to the reader.

C. Both speak directly to the reader.

D. Both use rhetorical questions.

Answer: C. Both speak directly to the reader.

Why: Both talk to the reader as "you" (for example "you can sample fresh bread" and "If you have ever returned from a holiday"). Only Text B gives statistics, and neither is humorous or asks rhetorical questions.

rl2-israel/q15 (Text A,B,C, L2, open, 3 marks)

Your friend wants information about different places to stay. Identify one place to stay from each of the three texts.

Answer: Text A: hostels, family-run guesthouses or kibbutz guesthouses (1). Text B: camping, or pitching a tent (1). Text C: hostels, a tent, a kibbutz guesthouse or a friend's sofa (1).

Why: I gave one place to stay from Text A. / I gave one place to stay from Text B. / I gave one place to stay from Text C.

READING: Park and Ride (rl-transport, L1, topic: Public transport)

Text A: Fennline Trains (Web page, Fennline Trains website)

Home | Tickets | Timetables | Railcards | Contact us

Welcome to Fennline Trains. We run fast, friendly services between Fennbridge, Kettlewick and Ashby Cross every day of the week. Tickets can be bought online, at the station or on board.

Travelling with a bike? Bikes travel free on all our trains, except between 7:00 am and 9:30 am on weekdays, when the trains are at their busiest.

Need some help with your journey? Please speak to a member of staff at any station. They will be glad to help.

Text B: Park and Ride: is it worth it? (Newspaper article, The Vale Gazette)

Kettlewick's new Park and Ride opened in March, and thousands of drivers have already tried it. Local people have given it a warm welcome. The idea is simple. Drivers leave their cars at the edge of town and take a bus into the centre, which takes about ten minutes.

How it works

The car park has 600 spaces and parking costs £3 for the whole day. A bus leaves every eight minutes from 6:30 am until 7:00 pm. Parking also covers your bus fare, so there is nothing more to pay. The car park is lit at night so that drivers feel safe, and staff are on duty all day to help.

Who is it for?

Commuters and shoppers are the biggest users, and shoppers like it too. "I used to spend half an hour driving round looking for a space," says Imran Shah, who works in a bank in the town centre. "Now I park, read my book on the bus, and I'm at my desk before nine."

What does it cost?

Parking in the town centre can cost up to £9 for a day, so the Park and Ride is much cheaper. Regular users can save even more with a season ticket (a ticket that lets you travel as often as you like for a month or a year). The council says the scheme will pay for itself within five years.

Is it perfect?

Not quite. Some passengers complain that the buses are full during the morning peak, when many people are travelling to work or school. A council spokesperson said that extra buses will be added if they are needed.

Even so, it is the best idea the council has had for years. If you drive into town every day, you should try it.

Text C: Subject: Park and Ride report! (Email, Email between friends)

Hi Jess,

Guess what? I tried the new Park and Ride in Kettlewick on Saturday and it was loads better than I expected. Parking was only £3, which is a bargain compared with the £9 I paid in town last month. The bus turned up after about two minutes and the driver was really friendly.

The downside? We went at 8:15 and the bus was rammed, so I had to stand all the way into town (it only took ten minutes, thankfully). The ride itself was lovely. There was Wi-Fi on the bus, so I caught up on my messages, and the seats were really comfy. Also, the last bus back is at 7:00 pm, which is far too early if you fancy a night out!

My tips if you go:

- Get there before eight, so you can get a seat.
- Keep your ticket safe, because you need it for the bus home.
- Check the last bus time before you leave the car park.
- Take a coat. The bus stop is miles from the entrance!

Honestly, I'd choose it over driving every time. Let me know if you try it. Can't wait to hear what you think!

Maya

Questions

rl-transport/q1a (Text A, L1, open, 1 marks)

Using Text A, say which part of the website you would click on to find out train times.

Answer: Timetables.

Why: I named the part of the website. / It comes from the top of Text A.

rl-transport/q1b (Text A, L1, choice, 1 marks)

Which feature of Text A helped you find this information?

A. A menu bar

B. Bullet points

C. A text box

D. A speech bubble

Answer: A. A menu bar

Why: The line at the top, "Home | Tickets | Timetables...", is a menu. It shows where to click to find each part of the website.

rl-transport/q2a (Text A, L1, open, 1 marks)

Text A says: "We run fast, friendly services." Give one word or phrase to replace "fast" that keeps the meaning the same.

Answer: Quick, speedy, rapid.

Why: My word means about the same as "fast". / It still makes sense in the sentence.

rl-transport/q2b (Text A, L1, open, 1 marks)

Text A says: "except between 7:00 am and 9:30 am". Give one word or phrase to replace "except" that keeps the meaning the same.

Answer: Apart from, other than, but not, excluding.

Why: My word or phrase means about the same as "except". / It still makes sense in the sentence.

rl-transport/q3 (Text A, L1, choice, 1 marks)

What is the main purpose of Text A?

A. To advertise a train company's services

B. To complain about train delays

C. To explain how to build a bike shed

D. To tell people about a Park and Ride

Answer: A. To advertise a train company's services

Why: The page welcomes visitors, describes the train services and offers help. It is advertising Fennline Trains.

rl-transport/q4 (Text B, L1, open, 3 marks)

Using Text B, give three benefits of using the Park and Ride.

Answer: Any three of: cheaper than parking in town (£3 compared with up to £9); parking covers the bus fare; a bus every eight minutes; no need to search for a space; time to read on the bus; a season ticket can save more.

Why: I gave three different benefits. / All three come from Text B. / Each one is a good thing about the Park and Ride.

rl-transport/q5 (Text B, L1, open, 2 marks)

Explain why a driver might choose the Park and Ride rather than parking in the town centre.

Answer: It costs much less (£3 for the day compared with up to £9) (1), and drivers do not waste time driving round looking for a space (1).

Why: I gave one reason about cost. / I gave one reason about time or finding a space.

rl-transport/q6 (Text B, L1, choice, 1 marks)

The writer puts words inside brackets after "season ticket". Why?

A. To explain what a season ticket is

B. To show someone is speaking

C. To show it is a question

D. To show it is the name of a company

Answer: A. To explain what a season ticket is

Why: Brackets add extra information. Here they explain a term that some readers may not know.

rl-transport/q7 (Text B, L1, open, 2 marks)

Why do some passengers complain about the buses in the morning?

Answer: The buses are full (1) during the morning peak, when many people are travelling to work or school (1).

Why: I said that the buses are full. / I said when this happens.

rl-transport/q8 (Text B, L1, multi, 2 marks)

Which TWO of these statements are facts?

A. Parking at the Park and Ride costs £3 for the whole day.

B. It is the best idea the council has had for years.

C. The car park has 600 spaces.

D. The buses are far too crowded.

Answer: A. Parking at the Park and Ride costs £3 for the whole day.; C. The car park has 600 spaces.

Why: Facts can be checked, such as the price and the number of spaces. "The best idea" and "far too crowded" are views, so they are opinions.

rl-transport/q9 (Text B, L1, open, 2 marks)

Give two specialist words or phrases from Text B that are connected to travel.

Answer: Any two of: commuters; fare; season ticket; peak; Park and Ride.

Why: I gave two words or phrases. / I copied them from Text B. / Both are to do with travel.

rl-transport/q10 (Text C, L1, open, 2 marks)

Give two things the writer of Text C did not like about the Park and Ride.

Answer: Any two of: the bus was full at 8:15, so she had to stand; the last bus back is at 7:00 pm, which is too early for a night out; the bus stop is a long way from the entrance.

Why: I gave two different things. / Both are things the writer did not like.

rl-transport/q11 (Text C, L1, choice, 1 marks)

Which sentence best sums up the writer's view?

A. She will never use it again.

B. It was better than she expected, with a few problems.

C. It was too expensive.

D. The bus driver was rude.

Answer: B. It was better than she expected, with a few problems.

Why: The writer says it was "loads better than I expected", but then lists two downsides.

rl-transport/q12 (Text C, L1, open, 3 marks)

Using Text C, give three pieces of advice for people who want to try the Park and Ride.

Answer: Any three of: get there before eight; keep your ticket safe; check the last bus time; take a coat.

Why: I gave three different pieces of advice. / All three come from Text C.

rl-transport/q13 (Text C, L1, open, 2 marks)

Give two examples of informal language from Text C.

Answer: Any two of: "Hi Jess", "Guess what?", "loads better", "bargain", "rammed", "miles from", "fancy a night out", "Can't wait".

Why: I copied two words or phrases exactly. / They are chatty, everyday words, not formal ones.

rl-transport/q14 (Text C, L1, open, 2 marks)

Who is Text C written for? Give one clue from the text that tells you.

Answer: A friend called Jess (1). Clue, for example: it starts "Hi Jess", or it asks "Let me know if you try it" (1).

Why: I said who the text is for. / I gave a clue from the text.

rl-transport/q15 (Text B,C, L1, open, 3 marks)

Compare what Text B and Text C say about the buses at busy times.

Answer: Text B says some passengers complain that buses are full in the morning peak, and the council will add extra buses if needed (1). Text C says the bus was "rammed" at 8:15 so the writer had to stand (1). So the texts agree that morning buses can be full, but Text B reports the council's plan to fix it and Text C gives a personal experience (1).

Why: I said what Text B says about busy buses. / I said what Text C says about it. / I said how the two are the same or different.

READING: Hire a bike (rl-transport-2, L1, topic: Public transport)

Text A: Fennbridge Bikes: hire a bike for £1 (Web page, Fennbridge Bikes website)

Pick up a bike at any of our 20 docking stations and return it to any other station. The first 30 minutes cost just £1. Bikes are available every day from 6 am to 10 pm.

I cycle to work now and I save £30 a month on bus fares! - Sam, a Fennbridge Bikes user

Download our free app to find your nearest bike. You can also see how many bikes are waiting at each station.

Text B: Fennbridge Bikes: six months on (Council report, Vale of Fenn Council)

Introduction

Fennbridge Bikes began six months ago with 200 bikes and 20 docking stations. This report looks at how the scheme has been used and suggests ways to improve it. The scheme is run by Vale of Fenn Council and is paid for partly by a grant.

How many people have used it?

Since the launch, there have been over 14,000 hires. Saturday is the busiest day, and the most popular journey is from the railway station to Market Square. Most users are commuters and students, and hires are highest in the summer, when the weather is dry and the evenings are light. The council leader said, "The scheme has been a huge success."

Costs and savings

The first 30 minutes of every hire cost £1, which is cheaper than the bus fare for the same journey. Bike hire also cuts traffic, which helps to keep the air cleaner. Users who cycle to work every day could save up to £30 a month. Running the scheme costs the council about £2,000 a month, which is covered by hire fees and a grant.

Problems

Not everything has gone well. The docking station at the railway station is often full in the evening, so cyclists have to ride to another station to return their bikes. Some bikes have also been damaged, and these must be repaired before they can be used again. Staff visit each docking station every day to move bikes from full stations to empty ones. A small number of users' comments say that there are not enough stations in the east of the town.

Recommendations

The council should add a second docking station near the railway station, buy 50 more bikes and open three new stations in the east of the town. These changes are the best way to improve the scheme.

Text C: Re: Anyone tried the bikes? (Forum post, Fennbridge Talk forum, thread: "Anyone tried the bikes?")

Hey everyone! I've been using the bikes for about two months now and honestly I love them.

I live near the market and I work at the hospital, so it takes me ten minutes to get there instead of half an hour on the bus. I also like that you can go through the park, where cars aren't allowed. Honestly, I haven't used my bus pass since, and it's saving me loads of money too. The app is brilliant too. It shows you exactly how many bikes are free at each station.

But there are a few problems. Last Friday I got to the station at about 6 pm and the dock was totally full. I had to cycle round for ages to find a free space, and I nearly missed my train! Also, a couple of the bikes I picked up had wonky brakes, which is scary.

My tips:

- Check the app before you set off, so you know where there are free spaces.
- Test the brakes before you ride away.
- Take the bike back within 30 minutes if you can, because it costs more after that.

Has anyone else had trouble finding a space at the station?

Questions

rl-transport-2/q1a (Text A, L1, open, 1 marks)

Using Text A, give one reason why Sam likes using the bikes.

Answer: Any one of: cycling to work; saving £30 a month on bus fares.

Why: I gave one reason. / It comes from what Sam says in Text A.

rl-transport-2/q1b (Text A, L1, choice, 1 marks)

Which feature of Text A shows what a user thinks?

A. A speech bubble

B. A numbered list

C. A menu

D. Bold headings

Answer: A. A speech bubble

Why: Sam's words are shown in a speech bubble, which shows that they are what a real user says.

rl-transport-2/q2a (Text A, L1, open, 1 marks)

Text A says: "Pick up a bike at any of our 20 docking stations." Give one word or phrase to replace "pick up" that keeps the meaning the same.

Answer: Collect, take, get, borrow.

Why: My word or phrase means about the same as "pick up". / It still makes sense in the sentence.

rl-transport-2/q2b (Text A, L1, open, 1 marks)

Text A says: "Download our free app to find your nearest bike." Give one word or phrase to replace "nearest" that keeps the meaning the same.

Answer: Closest, most local, next to you.

Why: My word or phrase means about the same as "nearest". / It still makes sense in the sentence.

rl-transport-2/q3 (Text A, L1, choice, 1 marks)

What is the main purpose of Text A?

A. To warn people about problems with bikes

B. To advertise a bike hire scheme

C. To explain how to repair a bike

D. To report on a council meeting

Answer: B. To advertise a bike hire scheme

Why: The page explains how the scheme works and what it costs, and includes a user's positive comment. It is advertising the scheme.

rl-transport-2/q4 (Text B, L1, open, 3 marks)

Using Text B, give three facts about how the scheme has been used.

Answer: Any three of: over 14,000 hires; Saturday is the busiest day; the most popular journey is from the railway station to Market Square; most users are commuters and students; the scheme began with 200 bikes and 20 docking stations.

Why: I gave three different facts. / All three come from Text B. / Each one is about how the scheme is used.

rl-transport-2/q5 (Text B, L1, open, 2 marks)

Explain why cyclists sometimes have to ride to a different station in the evening.

Answer: The docking station at the railway station is often full in the evening (1), so cyclists cannot return their bikes there (1).

Why: I said that the station is full. / I said what cyclists then have to do.

rl-transport-2/q6 (Text B, L1, choice, 1 marks)

The report says: "A small number of users' comments say that there are not enough stations in the east of the town." What does the apostrophe in "users'" show?

A. That the comments belong to the users

B. That some letters are missing

C. That someone is speaking

D. That it is the end of a sentence

Answer: A. That the comments belong to the users

Why: An apostrophe after the s in a plural word shows that something belongs to more than one person. Here, the comments belong to the users.

rl-transport-2/q7 (Text B, L1, open, 2 marks)

Give two problems with the scheme that are mentioned in Text B.

Answer: Any two of: the docking station at the railway station is often full in the evening; some bikes have been damaged; there are not enough stations in the east of the town.

Why: I gave two different problems. / Both come from the section "Problems".

rl-transport-2/q8 (Text B, L1, multi, 2 marks)

Which TWO of these statements are facts?

A. The scheme has been a huge success.

B. There have been over 14,000 hires.

C. These changes are the best way to improve the scheme.

D. Fennbridge Bikes began with 200 bikes.

Answer: B. There have been over 14,000 hires.; D. Fennbridge Bikes began with 200 bikes.

Why: Facts can be checked. The number of hires and the number of bikes at the start are facts. "A huge success" and "the best way" are views, so they are opinions.

rl-transport-2/q9 (Text B, L1, open, 2 marks)

Give two specialist words or phrases from Text B that are connected to travel.

Answer: Any two of: docking stations; hires; commuters; bus fare; journey; scheme.

Why: I gave two words or phrases. / I copied them from Text B. / Both are to do with travel.

rl-transport-2/q10 (Text C, L1, open, 2 marks)

Give two things the writer of Text C does not like about the scheme.

Answer: Any two of: the dock was full at the station; having to cycle around to find a space; nearly missing the train; bikes with wonky brakes.

Why: I gave two different things. / Both come from the third paragraph.

rl-transport-2/q11 (Text C, L1, choice, 1 marks)

Which sentence best sums up the writer's view?

A. The scheme is a waste of money.

B. The scheme is great, but it has a few problems.

C. The scheme is only for students.

D. The bikes are too expensive.

Answer: B. The scheme is great, but it has a few problems.

Why: The writer says they "love" the bikes, then lists problems with full docks and faulty brakes.

rl-transport-2/q12 (Text C, L1, open, 3 marks)

Using Text C, give three pieces of advice for people using the bikes.

Answer: Any three of: check the app before you set off; test the brakes; take the bike back within 30 minutes.

Why: I gave three different pieces of advice. / All three come from the list in Text C.

rl-transport-2/q13 (Text C, L1, open, 2 marks)

Give two examples of informal language from Text C.

Answer: Any two of: "Hey everyone!"; "honestly"; "brilliant"; "totally full"; "for ages"; "wonky"; "scary".

Why: I copied two words or phrases exactly. / They are chatty, everyday words, not formal ones.

rl-transport-2/q14 (Text C, L1, open, 2 marks)

Who is Text C written for? Give one clue from the text that tells you.

Answer: Other people in Fennbridge, such as people thinking of using the bikes (1). Clue, for example: it starts "Hey everyone!" or asks "Has anyone else had trouble?" (1).

Why: I said who the text is for. / I gave a clue from the text.

rl-transport-2/q15 (Text B,C, L1, open, 3 marks)

Compare what Text B and Text C say about the docking station at the railway station.

Answer: Text B says the railway station dock is often full in the evening, so cyclists have to ride to another station, and recommends adding a second dock there (1). Text C describes arriving at about 6 pm to a totally full dock and nearly missing a train (1). Both texts agree it is a problem, but Text B suggests a solution and Text C gives a personal experience (1).

Why: I said what Text B says about the railway station dock. / I said what Text C says about it. / I said how the two are the same or different.

READING: Leaving the car behind (rl2-transport, L2, topic: Public transport)

Text A: Leaving the car at home (Web page, Vale Active Travel) [paragraphs numbered]

[1] Most of us know that driving everywhere is expensive, but few of us realise by how much. Between fuel, insurance, parking and repairs, running a car can cost thousands of pounds a year, and sitting in traffic can eat up hours of your week. Switching even a few journeys to the bus or train could make a real difference to both your wallet and your wellbeing.

[2] Start by working out what is available. Look at timetables for buses and trains on your usual route, and compare the journey time with driving. You may discover that a quick check saves a lot of faff, and that a stop you had never noticed is only a short walk from your door.

[3] Next, add up the true cost of each option. A weekly or monthly ticket is usually much cheaper than paying for single journeys, and railcards can reduce fares by a third for those who qualify. Remember to include parking charges when you compare the figures.

[4] Make the journey as easy as possible. Download a timetable app, keep your ticket on your phone and pack a book or some music. Time on the bus is time you get back, whereas time behind the wheel is time you can never use for anything else.

[5] Start small. Try leaving the car at home one day a week and see how you get on. Most people find that the first week is the hardest, and that the habit is easier to keep than they feared.

[6] Finally, keep going. If a service is late or full, do not give up; try a different route or a different time. With a little patience and planning, you will soon find the best way to get around, and you may never look back.

Text B: Why are we still driving? (Magazine article, Transport Weekly)

Every weekday morning, millions of people sit alone in their cars, crawling towards offices, schools and shops. A study of 3,000 commuters by the Fenland Travel Panel found that 68 per cent of those who drive to work live within five miles of a bus or train route, yet fewer than one in five had ever tried it.

So what is stopping them? Many point to unreliable services. If a bus is late twice in a week, most passengers lose faith, and a car offers "door to door" convenience that no timetable can match. Others complain that fares rise every year, and that evening and weekend services are too limited to be useful.

The result is what experts call "a vicious circle". Poor services lead to fewer passengers, fewer passengers lead to less money, and less money leads to even poorer services. Breaking the cycle will take investment, but the rewards could be large: less congestion, cleaner air and quieter streets.

Safety also matters. Passengers who wait for buses in the dark, at stops without shelter or lighting, often feel vulnerable, and some, particularly young people and the elderly, simply choose to stay at home instead. Cost, too, remains a barrier for students and part-time workers, who may spend a large share of their wages on fares.

Advice from the Passenger Users' Alliance: Try your journey once at the weekend, when there is no pressure. Ask your employer about season ticket loans. Report broken lighting and missing shelters to the council. And tell the operator when things go well, as well as when they go wrong.

There are signs of progress. Several towns have introduced simple, capped fares, and one operator has fitted every bus with free Wi-Fi and charging points. Passenger numbers on these routes have risen by almost a fifth.

In my view, public transport is the only sensible way to travel into a busy town centre, and councils that ignore it are storing up problems for the future. If you are thinking about changing the way you travel, now is the moment.

Text C: Speech to a public meeting (Transcript of a speech, Vale of Fenn community meeting)

Good evening, everyone, and thank you for turning out on such a wet night. I have driven the number 14 for twenty-two years, and I want to tell you why I still believe that public transport is worth fighting for.

I used to be sceptical myself. When I first joined the company, I thought buses were slow, noisy and old-fashioned. Then I started talking to my passengers. There was a nurse who could not afford a car, a student who read two novels a month on the way to college, and an old gentleman who told me that my bus was the only reason he saw another person all week.

So what makes a good service? First, it must be reliable, because nobody will wait for a bus that never comes. Second, it must be affordable, because nobody should have to choose between a ticket and a meal. Third, it must be safe, because everyone deserves to feel comfortable at a stop, whatever the hour.

Will it cost money to get this right? Of course it will. But what is the cost of doing nothing? Empty streets, full car parks and a town centre that nobody can breathe in. I have heard people call a good bus service a luxury. I call it a lifeline for the lonely, a lifeline for the young and a lifeline for the whole town.

Last year, my route carried more than 400,000 passengers, and 90 per cent of those surveyed said they would recommend it to a friend. Those are not my figures. They are yours.

I also know about the problems. Buses run late when roadworks block the high street, and shelters are often broken or missing. But when we built a new shelter at the hospital stop, passenger numbers went up within a month. That tells me something simple: people will use a good service if we give them one.

My advice is this. Try it for a week. Leave the car at home, take a book and see how you feel. You might be surprised at how much more relaxed you arrive, and how much money is left in your pocket at the end of the month.

I promise you the journey will be worth it. It will be cheaper, greener and, I suspect, a good deal more interesting than another morning in traffic. Thank you, and please, come aboard.

Questions

rl2-transport/q1 (Text A, L2, open, 2 marks)

Your friend wants to cut the cost of travelling to work. Using Text A, identify two ways to do this.

> Answer: Any two of: buy a weekly or monthly ticket (1); use a railcard (1); include parking charges when comparing costs (1); leave the car at home some days (1).
>
> Why: I gave two different ways. / Both come from Text A. / Each one would reduce the cost.

rl2-transport/q2 (Text A, L2, choice, 1 marks)

Which word best describes the tone of Text A?

A. Hostile

B. Supportive

C. Gloomy

D. Humorous

Answer: B. Supportive

Why: The writer offers helpful tips and reassurance ("do not give up", "keep going"). That is supportive.

rl2-transport/q3 (Text A, L2, multi, 2 marks)

Which TWO of these quotations from Text A are examples of formal language?

A. "Between fuel, insurance, parking and repairs, running a car can cost thousands of pounds a year"

B. "saves a lot of faff"

C. "see how you get on"

D. "Remember to include parking charges when you compare the figures"

E. "you may never look back"

Answer: A. "Between fuel, insurance, parking and repairs, running a car can cost thousands of pounds a year"; D. "Remember to include parking charges when you compare the figures"

Why: Formal language is careful and serious. "A lot of faff", "see how you get on" and "you may never look back" are casual, everyday expressions, so they are informal.

rl2-transport/q4 (Text A, L2, match, 2 marks)

You have been asked to add subheadings to each paragraph in Text A. Choose the paragraph number that best matches each subheading. Three have been done for you.

Subheadings: Keep going; Count the cost; Why change?; Start small; Make it easy; Know your options (paragraphs 1 to 6)

Answer: Keep going → paragraph 6 (given); Count the cost → paragraph 3; Why change? → paragraph 1 (given); Start small → paragraph 5; Make it easy → paragraph 4 (given); Know your options → paragraph 2

Why: Each subheading sums up one paragraph: paragraph 2 is about checking your options, paragraph 3 about costs and paragraph 5 about starting small.

rl2-transport/q5 (Text B, L2, open, 2 marks)

What does each of these quotations from Text B suggest about public transport? "door to door" and "a vicious circle"

Answer: "Door to door" suggests that a car takes you directly from your home to where you are going, which is very convenient (1). "A vicious circle" suggests a cycle in which each problem makes the next one worse (1).

Why: I explained the first quotation in my own words. / I explained the second quotation in my own words. / I did not just copy the quotations.

rl2-transport/q6 (Text B, L2, choice, 1 marks)

Text B includes both facts and opinions. Which one of these statements is an opinion?

A. Public transport is the only sensible way to travel into a busy town centre.

B. 68 per cent of commuters who drive live within five miles of a bus or train route.

C. Several towns have introduced capped fares.

D. The Passenger Users' Alliance gives advice to travellers.

Answer: A. Public transport is the only sensible way to travel into a busy town centre.

Why: The other statements can be checked. "The only sensible way" is the writer's personal view, so it is an opinion.

rl2-transport/q7a (Text B, L2, open, 1 marks)

Who provides advice for travellers in Text B?

Answer: The Passenger Users' Alliance.

Why: I named the organisation. / It comes from the box in Text B.

rl2-transport/q7b (Text B, L2, choice, 1 marks)

Which organisational feature is used to present this advice?

A. A speech bubble

B. A table

C. A text box

D. A numbered list

Answer: C. A text box

Why: The advice is set in a box, so it stands out from the article.

rl2-transport/q8a (Text B, L2, open, 2 marks)

Using Text B, identify two problems that stop people from using public transport.

Answer: Any two of: services are unreliable or late (1); fares rise every year (1); evening and weekend services are limited (1); waiting in the dark at stops without shelter or lighting feels unsafe (1); fares are costly for students and part-time workers (1).

Why: I gave two different problems. / Both come from Text B.

rl2-transport/q8b (Text B, L2, open, 2 marks)

Using Text B, identify two suggestions to help people start using public transport.

Answer: Any two of: try the journey at the weekend (1); ask your employer about season ticket loans (1); report broken lighting and missing shelters to the council (1); tell the operator when things go well (1).

Why: I gave two different suggestions. / Both come from Text B.

rl2-transport/q9 (Text C, L2, open, 2 marks)

Using Text C, give two quotations that suggest public transport benefits people's lives beyond simply getting from place to place.

Answer: Any two of: "a student who read two novels a month on the way to college" (1); "my bus was the only reason he saw another person all week" (1); "a lifeline for the lonely" (1); "a lifeline for the young" (1).

Why: I copied two quotations. / Each one shows a benefit beyond travel. / I did not just paraphrase.

rl2-transport/q10 (Text C, L2, open, 4 marks)

Using Text C, identify two language features used to persuade the audience to support public transport. Give an example to support each answer.

Answer: Any two features, each with a linked example: direct address (1), e.g. "thank you for turning out" or "Try it for a week" (1); personal experience or first person (1), e.g. "I have driven the number 14 for twenty-two years" (1); rule of three (1), e.g. "reliable... affordable... safe" or "a lifeline for the lonely, a lifeline for the young..." (1); rhetorical question (1), e.g. "Will it cost money to get this right?" (1); statistics (1), e.g. "more than 400,000 passengers" (1); repetition (1), e.g. "a lifeline... a lifeline..." (1); emotive language (1), e.g. "lifeline" (1).

Why: I named one language feature. / I gave an example that matches it. / I named a second, different feature. / I gave an example that matches the second one.

rl2-transport/q11 (Text C, L2, choice, 1 marks)

Which one of these quotations from Text C shows that the speaker has a positive view of public transport?

A. "Buses run late when roadworks block the high street"

B. "shelters are often broken or missing"

C. "I still believe that public transport is worth fighting for"

D. "I used to be sceptical myself"

Answer: C. "I still believe that public transport is worth fighting for"

Why: The other quotations describe problems or an earlier doubt. "Worth fighting for" shows a positive view.

rl2-transport/q12a (Text A,C, L2, open, 1 marks)

You may use a dictionary. Text A says: "your wallet and your wellbeing". Give one word or phrase to replace "wellbeing" that keeps the meaning the same.

Answer: Health, happiness, welfare, comfort, quality of life.

Why: My word means about the same as "wellbeing". / It still makes sense in the sentence.

rl2-transport/q12b (Text A,C, L2, open, 1 marks)

Text C says: "I used to be sceptical myself". Give one word or phrase to replace "sceptical" that keeps the meaning the same.

Answer: Doubtful, unconvinced, suspicious, cynical, not sure it worked.

Why: My word or phrase means about the same as "sceptical". / It still makes sense in the sentence.

rl2-transport/q13 (Text A,C, L2, open, 6 marks)

Compare similar ideas from Text A and Text C about how people can start using public transport. In your answer you should: give two similarities from these texts; give one quotation from Text A and one quotation from Text C to support each similarity.

Answer: Any two similarities, each with a supporting quotation from each text. Try it for a short time first (1): A "Try leaving the car at home one day a week" (1), C "Try it for a week" (1). Use the journey to read or relax (1): A "pack a book or some music" (1), C "take a book" (1). Save money (1): A "A weekly or monthly ticket is usually much cheaper" (1), C "It will be cheaper, greener" (1).

Why: I gave a first similarity. / I gave a quotation from Text A for it. / I gave a quotation from Text C for it. / I gave a second, different similarity. / I gave a quotation from Text A for it. / I gave a quotation from Text C for it.

rl2-transport/q14 (Text A,B, L2, choice, 1 marks)

Which one of these statements about the language used in Text A and Text B is correct?

A. Both use statistics to support their points.

B. Both use humour to appeal to the reader.

C. Both include personal experience from the writer.

D. Both speak directly to the reader.

Answer: D. Both speak directly to the reader.

Why: Both talk to the reader as "you" ("you may never look back", "If you are thinking about changing the way you travel"). Only Text B has statistics, and neither is humorous or tells a personal story.

rl2-transport/q15 (Text A,B,C, L2, open, 3 marks)

Your friend wants to know about the benefits of using public transport. Identify one benefit from each of the three texts.

Answer: Text A: saves money, gives time to read or listen to music, or is good for your wellbeing (1). Text B: less congestion, cleaner air or quieter streets (1). Text C: helps lonely people, is cheaper and greener, or lets you arrive more relaxed (1).

Why: I gave one benefit from Text A. / I gave one benefit from Text B. / I gave one benefit from Text C.

READING: New homes in the village (rl-geography, L1, topic: UK geography)

Text A: Have your say on new homes in Ashby Green (Notice, Ashby Green Parish Council)

Ashby Green Parish Council is holding a meeting about plans to build 40 new homes in the village. Everyone is welcome.

There are three ways to have your say:

1. Come to the meeting at the village hall on Thursday at 7:30 pm.

2. Write to the Parish Clerk at the village hall.

3. Fill in the short form on the council website.

Please tell us what you think before the end of the month.

Text B: New homes for Ashby Green: the facts (Information leaflet, Ashby Green Parish Council)

Ashby Green Parish Council has been asked to approve plans for 40 new homes on a field beside Church Lane. About 1,200 people live in the village today. This leaflet sets out the main facts so that residents can decide what they think.

Why build here?

There are two main reasons for the plan: the village school has empty places, and the village shop is struggling to stay open. The council hopes that new families will help to keep both going. Over the last ten years, the number of children at the school has fallen and two other shops have closed. Councillor Ruth Barnes says, "The new homes will bring the village back to life."

What kind of homes?

Twenty-four of the homes will be for sale on the open market, with between two and four bedrooms. Sixteen will be affordable homes, which cost less to buy or rent than most houses in the area. These will be offered first to people who already live or work in the village. All of the new homes will have gardens and parking spaces, and they will be built to use less energy than older houses.

What are the worries?

Not everyone is in favour. Some residents are worried about extra traffic on the narrow lanes. One resident, Tom Hendry, says, "The lanes simply cannot cope with more traffic." Others do not want to lose the field, which is used by dog walkers and for the summer fair. The developer says it will pay for a new bus shelter and a safer crossing on Church Lane.

What happens next?

The parish council will meet on Thursday to hear residents' views. The plans must then be approved by the district council, which will decide whether to grant planning permission. A decision is expected within six months.

Text C: Letter about the Church Lane homes (Letter, Letter to Ashby Green Parish Council)

Dear Councillors,

I am writing to say that I support the plan to build new homes on Church Lane. I am 19 and I have lived in Ashby Green all my life, but I doubt that I will be able to stay here. Even a small flat in the village costs far more than I can afford on my wage from the garden centre.

Several of my friends have already moved to Brayminster, where there are more homes to rent and the bus runs every fifteen minutes. If the village does not build homes for young people, it will soon have no young people left. I know that some neighbours are worried about traffic, and I understand why. However, I believe a few more cars are a small price to pay for a village that stays alive.

I would therefore ask the council to:

- make sure the affordable homes go to local people first
- keep a footpath through the field so that walkers can still use it
- ask the bus company to run buses more often, as more people will need them

I would be grateful if you would consider my views at Thursday's meeting.

Yours faithfully,

A resident of Ashby Green

Questions

rl-geography/q1a (Text A, L1, open, 1 marks)

Using Text A, give one way to have your say about the new homes.

Answer: Any one of: come to the meeting at the village hall; write to the Parish Clerk; fill in the short form on the council website.

Why: I gave one way. / It comes from the list in Text A.

rl-geography/q1b (Text A, L1, choice, 1 marks)

Which feature of Text A helped you find this information?

A. A numbered list

B. A speech bubble

C. A menu

D. A text box

Answer: A. A numbered list

Why: The three ways to have your say are set out as a numbered list: 1, 2 and 3.

rl-geography/q2a (Text A, L1, open, 1 marks)

Text A says: "plans to build 40 new homes". Give one word or phrase to replace "plans" that keeps the meaning the same.

Answer: Proposals, ideas, proposed project.

Why: My word means about the same as "plans". / It still makes sense in the sentence.

rl-geography/q2b (Text A, L1, open, 1 marks)

Text A says: "Everyone is welcome." Give one word or phrase to replace "welcome" that keeps the meaning the same.

Answer: Invited, wanted, encouraged to come.

Why: My word or phrase means about the same as "welcome". / It still makes sense in the sentence.

rl-geography/q3 (Text A, L1, choice, 1 marks)

What is the main purpose of Text A?

A. To advertise homes for sale

B. To invite people to give their views

C. To explain why the school is closing

D. To complain about the council

Answer: B. To invite people to give their views

Why: The notice announces a meeting and gives three ways to say what you think, so it invites people to give their views.

rl-geography/q4 (Text B, L1, open, 3 marks)

Using Text B, give three details about the new homes.

Answer: Any three of: there will be 40 homes; they will be on a field beside Church Lane; 24 will be for sale; 16 will be affordable homes; they will have between two and four bedrooms.

Why: I gave three different details. / All three come from Text B. / Each one is a fact about the homes.

rl-geography/q5 (Text B, L1, open, 2 marks)

Give two reasons why the parish council wants new homes in the village.

Answer: The village school has empty places (1), and the village shop is struggling to stay open (1).

Why: I gave two different reasons. / Both come from the section "Why build here?".

rl-geography/q6 (Text B, L1, choice, 1 marks)

Look at the sentence: "There are two main reasons for the plan: the village school has empty places, and the village shop is struggling." What does the colon (:) do?

A. It introduces the reasons

B. It shows someone is speaking

C. It shows a question

D. It ends the sentence

Answer: A. It introduces the reasons

Why: A colon often comes before an explanation or list. Here it introduces the two reasons for the plan.

rl-geography/q7 (Text B, L1, open, 2 marks)

Why are some residents against the plan?

Answer: They are worried about extra traffic on the narrow lanes (1). Others do not want to lose the field, which is used by dog walkers and for the summer fair (1).

Why: I gave one reason about traffic. / I gave one reason about the field.

rl-geography/q8 (Text B, L1, multi, 2 marks)

Which TWO of these statements are facts?

A. The new homes will bring the village back to life.

B. About 1,200 people live in Ashby Green.

C. Sixteen of the new homes will be affordable homes.

D. The lanes simply cannot cope with more traffic.

Answer: B. About 1,200 people live in Ashby Green.; C. Sixteen of the new homes will be affordable homes.

Why: Facts can be checked, such as the number of people and the number of affordable homes. "Bring the village back to life" and "cannot cope" are views, so they are opinions.

rl-geography/q9 (Text B, L1, open, 2 marks)

Give two specialist words or phrases from Text B that are connected to housing.

Answer: Any two of: affordable homes; open market; planning permission; residents; bedrooms; parish council.

Why: I gave two words or phrases. / I copied them from Text B. / Both are to do with housing.

rl-geography/q10 (Text C, L1, open, 2 marks)

Give two reasons why the writer of Text C supports the plan.

Answer: Any two of: even a small flat in the village costs more than the writer can afford; friends have already moved away; without homes for young people the village will have none left.

Why: I gave two different reasons. / Both come from the first two paragraphs.

rl-geography/q11 (Text C, L1, choice, 1 marks)

Which sentence best sums up the writer's view?

A. The plan should be stopped.

B. The plan is a good idea, but the council should make some changes.

C. The plan is not important.

D. The village should stay exactly as it is.

Answer: B. The plan is a good idea, but the council should make some changes.

Why: The writer supports the plan, but asks the council to do three things as well.

rl-geography/q12 (Text C, L1, open, 3 marks)

Using Text C, give three things the writer asks the council to do.

Answer: Any three of: make sure affordable homes go to local people first; keep a footpath through the field; ask the bus company to run buses more often.

Why: I gave three different requests. / All three come from the list in Text C.

rl-geography/q13 (Text C, L1, open, 2 marks)

Give two examples of formal language from Text C.

Answer: Any two of: "Dear Councillors", "I am writing to say that", "I would therefore ask", "I would be grateful if", "Yours faithfully".

Why: I copied two words or phrases exactly. / They sound polite and serious, not chatty.

rl-geography/q14 (Text C, L1, open, 2 marks)

Who is Text C written for? Give one clue from the text that tells you.

Answer: The parish councillors (1). Clue, for example: it starts "Dear Councillors" or it says "consider my views at Thursday's meeting" (1).

Why: I said who the text is for. / I gave a clue from the text.

rl-geography/q15 (Text B,C, L1, open, 3 marks)

Compare what Text B and Text C say about the affordable homes.

Answer: Text B says that 16 of the 40 homes will be affordable homes, which cost less to buy or rent, and that they will be offered first to people who live or work in the village (1). Text C says that the writer cannot afford even a small flat in the village, and asks the council to make sure the affordable homes go to local people first (1). Both texts say local people should come first, but Text B is giving the plan and Text C shows why it matters (1).

Why: I said what Text B says about affordable homes. / I said what Text C says about them. / I said how the two are the same or different.

READING: Moving to the coast (rl-geography-2, L1, topic: UK geography)

Text A: Welcome to Marram Bay (Web page, Marram Bay Town Council website)

Marram Bay is a friendly seaside town with a busy harbour and a lively market.

Population: about 9,000

Distance to Northcaster: 40 miles

Trains to Northcaster: every hour

Schools: two primary schools and one secondary school

We hope you will visit us soon, and perhaps even stay.

Our long, sandy beach is open all year, and there is a weekly market on Saturdays. Many families live here because homes cost less than in the city, and the countryside is close by.

Text B: Should you move to the coast? (Magazine article, Home & Away magazine)

Every year, thousands of people leave the cities for life by the sea. Some want cheaper homes, some want fresh air, and some simply want a change. But is the seaside really the dream it seems?

The good points

Property prices in small seaside towns are usually lower than in big cities, so your money often goes further. Estate agent Karen Webb says, "You get more for your money by the sea." There is plenty to do, too, with cafés, shops, boat trips and a market in many towns. Life can also feel calmer, and the beach is often only a short walk from home. Many people also say that the air feels cleaner and that their children have more space to play outdoors.

The not-so-good points

Many seaside towns have far more visitors in summer than in winter, so a lot of the jobs are seasonal. A café or hotel may employ extra staff from May to September, but then lay them off when the weather turns cold. People who work in cities often have to commute by train, which can be expensive. Some small towns have fewer services too, such as hospitals and large shops, and buses to nearby towns can be infrequent, particularly in the evenings.

What should you check first?

Before you move, visit the town in the middle of winter, not just on a sunny weekend in August. Check how often the trains run, how far away the nearest hospital is, and whether there are good schools nearby. Talk to people who already live there, because they will give you an honest view.

Living by the sea is a wonderful experience, and nothing beats waking up to the sound of the waves. With careful planning, it could be the best decision you ever make.

Text C: One year since we left the city (Blog post, Our Seaside Life blog)

A year ago, we swapped a tiny flat in Northcaster for a little house in Marram Bay. Everyone said we were mad, but we've never looked back and we have never been happier.

The house cost far less than our flat would have sold for, and we now have a garden! The beach is five minutes away, and I swim most mornings, even in the cold. I'd never have done that in the city. The winters are wild but beautiful, and we have met more neighbours in a year than in five years in Northcaster.

But it hasn't all been easy. I work at a café on the harbour, and in January there were hardly any customers, so I only had two shifts a week. My partner commutes to Northcaster by train, which costs a fortune, and the last train home is far too early.

My advice if you're thinking of moving:

Visit in winter, not just in summer.

Work out the cost of the train before you buy a house.

Be ready to find a second job for the quiet months.

Would we move back? No way! But we're a lot wiser than we were.

Questions

rl-geography-2/q1a (Text A, L1, open, 1 marks)

Using Text A, give one fact about Marram Bay.

Answer: Any one of: about 9,000 people live there; it is 40 miles from Northcaster; there are trains to Northcaster every hour; it has two primary schools and one secondary school; it has a harbour and a market.

Why: I gave one fact. / It comes from Text A.

rl-geography-2/q1b (Text A, L1, choice, 1 marks)

Which feature of Text A helped you find these facts?

A. A speech bubble

B. A numbered list

C. Bold words

D. A menu

Answer: C. Bold words

Why: The labels, such as "Population:", are in bold, so each fact is easy to spot.

rl-geography-2/q2a (Text A, L1, open, 1 marks)

Text A says: "a friendly seaside town". Give one word or phrase to replace "friendly" that keeps the meaning the same.

Answer: Welcoming, kind, pleasant, warm.

Why: My word means about the same as "friendly". / It still makes sense in the sentence.

rl-geography-2/q2b (Text A, L1, open, 1 marks)

Text A says: "a lively market". Give one word or phrase to replace "lively" that keeps the meaning the same.

Answer: Busy, full of life, bustling, energetic.

Why: My word or phrase means about the same as "lively". / It still makes sense in the sentence.

rl-geography-2/q3 (Text A, L1, choice, 1 marks)

What is the main purpose of Text A?

A. To warn people about the cost of living

B. To explain how the harbour works

C. To welcome people and tell them about the town

D. To compare Marram Bay with Northcaster

Answer: C. To welcome people and tell them about the town

Why: The page welcomes visitors and gives useful facts about the town. It ends by hoping people will visit or stay.

rl-geography-2/q4 (Text B, L1, open, 3 marks)

Using Text B, give three good points about living by the sea.

Answer: Any three of: property prices are usually lower; your money goes further; there is plenty to do; life feels calmer; the beach is a short walk from home; fresh air.

Why: I gave three different points. / All three come from Text B. / Each one is something good about living by the sea.

rl-geography-2/q5 (Text B, L1, open, 2 marks)

Explain why many seaside jobs are seasonal.

Answer: Seaside towns have far more visitors in summer than in winter (1), so businesses need extra staff in summer but not in winter (1).

Why: I said that there are more visitors in summer. / I said what this means for jobs.

rl-geography-2/q6 (Text B, L1, choice, 1 marks)

The writer says: "with cafés, shops, boat trips and a market in many towns." What do the commas do?

A. They separate the items in a list

B. They show someone is speaking

C. They show a question

D. They show something is missing

Answer: A. They separate the items in a list

Why: Commas separate the items in a list. The last two items are joined with "and" instead.

rl-geography-2/q7 (Text B, L1, open, 2 marks)

Give two problems that Text B says people may face when living in a small seaside town.

Answer: Any two of: jobs are seasonal; commuting by train can be expensive; fewer services, such as hospitals and large shops; buses to nearby towns can be infrequent, particularly in the evenings.

Why: I gave two different problems. / Both come from "The not-so-good points".

rl-geography-2/q8 (Text B, L1, multi, 2 marks)

Which TWO of these statements are facts?

A. Living by the sea is a wonderful experience.

B. Property prices in small seaside towns are usually lower than in big cities.

C. Nothing beats waking up to the sound of the waves.

D. Many seaside towns have more visitors in summer than in winter.

Answer: B. Property prices in small seaside towns are usually lower than in big cities.; D. Many seaside towns have more visitors in summer than in winter.

Why: Facts can be checked. Property prices and visitor numbers are facts. "A wonderful experience" and "nothing beats" are views, so they are opinions.

rl-geography-2/q9 (Text B, L1, open, 2 marks)

Give two specialist words or phrases from Text B that are connected to housing or work.

Answer: Any two of: property prices; estate agent; seasonal; commute; services; staff; employ.

Why: I gave two words or phrases. / I copied them from Text B. / Both are to do with housing or work.

rl-geography-2/q10 (Text C, L1, open, 2 marks)

Give two good things about life in Marram Bay, according to the writer of Text C.

Answer: Any two of: the house cost less than their flat would have sold for; they have a garden; the beach is five minutes away; the writer swims most mornings.

Why: I gave two different things. / Both come from the second paragraph.

rl-geography-2/q11 (Text C, L1, choice, 1 marks)

Which sentence best sums up the writer's view?

A. Moving was a mistake.

B. Moving was worth it, but it has not been easy.

C. Moving was too expensive.

D. Everyone should move to the coast.

Answer: B. Moving was worth it, but it has not been easy.

Why: The writer says "No way!" to moving back, but describes quiet winter work and expensive trains.

rl-geography-2/q12 (Text C, L1, open, 3 marks)

Using Text C, give three pieces of advice for people thinking of moving.

Answer: Any three of: visit in winter; work out the cost of the train; be ready to find a second job for the quiet months.

Why: I gave three different pieces of advice. / All three come from the list in Text C.

rl-geography-2/q13 (Text C, L1, open, 2 marks)

Give two examples of informal language from Text C.

Answer: Any two of: "we swapped"; "mad"; "we've never looked back"; "costs a fortune"; "No way!"; "a lot wiser".

Why: I copied two words or phrases exactly. / They are chatty, everyday words, not formal ones.

rl-geography-2/q14 (Text C, L1, open, 2 marks)

Who is Text C written for? Give one clue from the text that tells you.

Answer: People who are thinking of moving to the coast (1). Clue, for example: "My advice if you're thinking of moving:" (1).

Why: I said who the text is for. / I gave a clue from the text.

rl-geography-2/q15 (Text B,C, L1, open, 3 marks)

Compare what Text B and Text C say about work in seaside towns.

Answer: Text B says many seaside jobs are seasonal, because there are more visitors in summer than in winter (1). Text C describes this in real life: the writer works at a café and had only two shifts a week in January (1). Both texts agree that winter work can be hard to find, and Text C advises being ready to find a second job (1).

Why: I said what Text B says about work. / I said what Text C says about it. / I said how the two are the same or different.

READING: The future of the village (rl2-geography, L2, topic: UK geography)

Text A: Moving to a village: what to consider (Web page, Fenland Rural Housing Advice) [paragraphs numbered]

[1] Many people dream of swapping the city for a village, with its open views, quiet lanes and friendly faces. Village life can be wonderful, but it works best for those who have thought carefully about what they are choosing. A little research now will help you avoid disappointment later.

[2] Think first about getting around. Many villages have only a few buses each day, and some have none at all in the evening, so a car is often essential. If you do not drive, check the timetable before you commit, because a short journey can turn into a bit of a trek.

[3] Next, look at local services. A village shop with a post office, a primary school and a doctor's surgery can make daily life much easier, but each of these is hard to keep open when the population is small. Find out which facilities are within walking distance and which are a drive away.

[4] Housing is the next big question. Homes in villages are often older, with larger gardens, and they can cost more than similar properties in towns because so few come up for sale. Rented homes are scarce, so you may have to wait. Ask the parish council whether any new houses are planned.

[5] Community matters too. Villages thrive when people take part, whether by helping at the summer fair, joining the church committee or simply popping into the pub. Why not go along to an event before you move? You will soon get a feel for the place.

[6] Finally, visit at different times of year. A village in June is a picture postcard, but in January it can feel very different. Spend a weekend there in winter if you can, and make sure you are happy with what you find. If you are, you're all set.

Text B: Why are young people leaving our villages? (Magazine article, Rural Review magazine)

Walk through almost any English village on a weekday afternoon and you will notice who is missing. A survey of 2,500 people aged 18 to 30 by the Rural Futures Group found that 57 per cent of those raised in villages had moved away by the age of 25, and only one in eight of them expected to return.

The reasons are not mysterious. House prices in villages are often far higher than local wages can support, and homes to rent are rare. For many young people, a village home is not so much the first rung of the ladder as "a ladder with the bottom rungs missing". Others leave for work, since jobs in the countryside tend to be scarce, seasonal or poorly paid.

Transport is another barrier. Without a car, a young person who lives in a village may depend on a bus that runs twice a day, which makes college, evening jobs and friendships difficult to sustain. Some say the situation leaves them feeling cut off, and no wonder.

The effect on the villages themselves can be severe. As young families leave, schools lose pupils and shops lose customers. Eventually, the village risks "a hollowing out": the buildings remain, but the life drains away. Rural pubs, post offices and clubs are closing at a worrying rate.

Advice from the Rural Communities Forum: Parish councils should survey local young people about what they need. Landowners should consider selling small plots for affordable homes. Bus operators should trial evening and weekend routes. And villagers should welcome newcomers, whatever their age.

There are encouraging examples. In one village, a community land trust has built eight low-cost homes, all reserved for local people, and the primary school has since gained a dozen pupils. Residents say that the change has brought new energy to the place.

In my view, a village without young people is a village without a future, and it is the duty of everyone who lives there to do something about it. Waiting for someone else to act is not an option.

Text C: Speech to a parish council meeting (Transcript of a speech, Parish council meeting)

Good evening, everyone, and thank you for coming to what I know is a difficult discussion. I have lived in this village for forty years, I have served on this council for twelve, and I am asking you tonight to say yes to the new homes on Mill Field.

Let me begin with a story. Last spring, a young woman I know, born and raised in this parish, told me she was leaving. She had a job at the surgery, a family nearby and a love for this place, but she could not find a home she could afford. When she left, we did not just lose a neighbour. We lost a future.

So what do we need? First, we need homes that local people can afford. Second, we need young families, because without them the school will close. Third, we need to keep our shop, our hall and our pub alive, and they can only survive if people live here all year round.

Will there be disruption? Of course there will. Will some of you miss the view across the field? I will, too. But what is the alternative? A village of empty houses, shuttered windows and a bus stop that nobody uses. I refuse to let that happen on my watch.

The figures speak for themselves. Eighteen of the twenty-four new homes will be reserved for people with a local connection, and the developer has promised to pay for a new footpath, a play area and a bus shelter. Since our school roll fell by a third in five years, we cannot afford to hesitate.

I have heard the worry about traffic. It is a fair worry, and I share it. That is why I have asked for a speed limit on the lane and a crossing by the school. We can protect our village and still make room for the next generation.

Think of the Saturday fair in ten years' time. I picture young families with pushchairs, children running between the stalls and every volunteer wearing a smile. That is the village I want to leave behind, and I believe it is the village you want, too.

It will be difficult, but it will be worth it. Please vote with your hearts, and vote for the future. Thank you.

Questions

rl2-geography/q1 (Text A, L2, open, 2 marks)

Your friend wants to find out more about a village before moving. Using Text A, identify two things to check.

> Answer: Any two of: bus or transport timetables (1); local services such as a shop, school or doctor's surgery (1); whether new houses are planned (1); what the village is like in winter (1); what community events are held (1).
>
> Why: I gave two different things. / Both come from Text A.

rl2-geography/q2 (Text A, L2, choice, 1 marks)

Which word best describes the tone of Text A?

A. Cautionary

B. Boastful

C. Mocking

D. Nostalgic

> Answer: A. Cautionary
>
> Why: The writer praises village life but warns the reader to choose "carefully" and tells them how to "avoid disappointment". That is cautionary.

rl2-geography/q3 (Text A, L2, multi, 2 marks)

Which TWO of these quotations from Text A are examples of informal language?

A. "a short journey can turn into a bit of a trek"

B. "Rented homes are scarce"

C. "Ask the parish council whether any new houses are planned"

D. "simply popping into the pub"

E. "Homes in villages are often older"

> Answer: A. "a short journey can turn into a bit of a trek"; D. "simply popping into the pub"

Why: Informal language is casual and conversational. "A bit of a trek" and "popping into the pub" are everyday expressions. The other quotations sound more factual and formal.

rl2-geography/q4 (Text A, L2, match, 2 marks)

You have been asked to add subheadings to each paragraph in Text A. Choose the paragraph number that best matches each subheading. Three have been done for you.

Subheadings: Check the seasons; Local services; Why a village?; Community life; Getting around; Housing (paragraphs 1 to 6)

Answer: Check the seasons → paragraph 6 (given); Local services → paragraph 3; Why a village? → paragraph 1 (given); Community life → paragraph 5; Getting around → paragraph 2 (given); Housing → paragraph 4

Why: Each subheading sums up one paragraph: paragraph 3 is about shops, schools and surgeries, paragraph 4 about housing and paragraph 5 about community life.

rl2-geography/q5 (Text B, L2, open, 2 marks)

What does each of these quotations from Text B suggest about young people in villages? "a ladder with the bottom rungs missing" and "a hollowing out"

Answer: "A ladder with the bottom rungs missing" suggests that young people cannot take the first steps to owning a home because the cheapest options do not exist (1). "A hollowing out" suggests that the village looks the same on the outside but loses its life and activity inside (1).

Why: I explained the first quotation in my own words. / I explained the second quotation in my own words. / I did not just copy the quotations.

rl2-geography/q6 (Text B, L2, choice, 1 marks)

Text B includes both facts and opinions. Which one of these statements is an opinion?

A. 57 per cent of those raised in villages had moved away by the age of 25.

B. A community land trust has built eight low-cost homes.

C. A village without young people is a village without a future.

D. Some villages have a bus that runs twice a day.

Answer: C. A village without young people is a village without a future.

Why: The other statements report things that can be checked. "A village without young people is a village without a future" is a personal view, so it is an opinion.

rl2-geography/q7a (Text B, L2, open, 1 marks)

Who provides advice about helping young people in Text B?

Answer: The Rural Communities Forum.

Why: I named the organisation. / It comes from the box in Text B.

rl2-geography/q7b (Text B, L2, choice, 1 marks)

Which organisational feature is used to present this advice?

A. Subheadings

B. A text box

C. A speech bubble

D. A bulleted list

Answer: B. A text box

Why: The advice is shown in a box, which separates it from the rest of the article.

rl2-geography/q8a (Text B, L2, open, 2 marks)

Using Text B, identify two problems that young people in villages face.

Answer: Any two of: house prices are higher than local wages can support (1); homes to rent are rare (1); jobs are scarce, seasonal or poorly paid (1); public transport is poor (1); they can feel cut off (1).

Why: I gave two different problems. / Both come from Text B.

rl2-geography/q8b (Text B, L2, open, 2 marks)

Using Text B, identify two suggestions to help young people stay in villages.

Answer: Any two of: parish councils should survey local young people (1); landowners should sell small plots for affordable homes (1); bus operators should trial evening and weekend routes (1); villagers should welcome newcomers (1); build low-cost homes through a community land trust (1).

Why: I gave two different suggestions. / Both come from Text B.

rl2-geography/q9 (Text C, L2, open, 2 marks)

Using Text C, give two quotations that suggest the speaker is worried about the future of the village.

Answer: Any two of: "we did not just lose a neighbour. We lost a future" (1); "without them the school will close" (1); "A village of empty houses, shuttered windows and a bus stop that nobody uses" (1); "I refuse to let that happen on my watch" (1); "we cannot afford to hesitate" (1).

Why: I copied two quotations. / Each one shows worry about the future. / I did not just paraphrase.

rl2-geography/q10 (Text C, L2, open, 4 marks)

Using Text C, identify two language features used to persuade the audience to support the new homes. Give an example to support each answer.

Answer: Any two features, each with a linked example: direct address (1), e.g. "thank you for coming" or "Please vote with your hearts" (1); personal experience or first person (1), e.g. "I have lived in this village for forty years" (1); rule of three (1), e.g. "empty houses, shuttered windows and a bus stop..." or "First... Second... Third..." (1); rhetorical question (1), e.g. "Will there be disruption?" (1); statistics (1), e.g. "Eighteen of the twenty-four new homes" or "fell by a third in five years" (1); anecdote or story (1), e.g. "Let me begin with a story" (1); emotive language (1), e.g. "We lost a future" (1).

Why: I named one language feature. / I gave an example that matches it. / I named a second, different feature. / I gave an example that matches the second one.

rl2-geography/q11 (Text C, L2, choice, 1 marks)

Which one of these quotations from Text C shows that the speaker has a positive view of the village's future with the new homes?

A. "Will some of you miss the view across the field?"

B. "I have heard the worry about traffic"

C. "We can protect our village and still make room for the next generation"

D. "a difficult discussion"

Answer: C. "We can protect our village and still make room for the next generation"

Why: The other quotations mention worries or difficulty. "Make room for the next generation" shows the speaker is hopeful.

rl2-geography/q12a (Text A,C, L2, open, 1 marks)

You may use a dictionary. Text A says: "Rented homes are scarce". Give one word or phrase to replace "scarce" that keeps the meaning the same.

Answer: Rare, hard to find, in short supply, uncommon, limited.

Why: My word means about the same as "scarce". / It still makes sense in the sentence.

rl2-geography/q12b (Text A,C, L2, open, 1 marks)

Text C says: "we cannot afford to hesitate". Give one word or phrase to replace "hesitate" that keeps the meaning the same.

Answer: Delay, wait, pause, put it off, be unsure.

Why: My word or phrase means about the same as "hesitate". / It still makes sense in the sentence.

rl2-geography/q13 (Text A,C, L2, open, 6 marks)

Compare similar ideas from Text A and Text C about what keeps a village alive. In your answer you should: give two similarities from these texts; give one quotation from Text A and one quotation from Text C to support each similarity.

Answer: Any two similarities, each with a supporting quotation from each text. Local services matter (1): A "A village shop with a post office, a primary school and a doctor's surgery" (1), C "keep our shop, our hall and our pub alive" (1). People taking part in community life (1): A "Villages thrive when people take part" (1), C "Think of the Saturday fair in ten years' time" (1). The need for suitable homes (1): A "Ask the parish council whether any new houses are planned" (1), C "homes that local people can afford" (1).

Why: I gave a first similarity. / I gave a quotation from Text A for it. / I gave a quotation from Text C for it. / I gave a second, different similarity. / I gave a quotation from Text A for it. / I gave a quotation from Text C for it.

rl2-geography/q14 (Text A,B, L2, choice, 1 marks)

Which one of these statements about the language used in Text A and Text B is correct?

A. Both use rhetorical questions to challenge the reader.

B. Both include statistics to support their points.

C. Both speak directly to the reader.

D. Both use humour to appeal to the reader.

Answer: C. Both speak directly to the reader.

Why: Both talk to the reader as "you" ("You will soon get a feel for the place" and "you will notice who is missing"). Only Text B has statistics, only Text A asks a question, and neither is humorous.

rl2-geography/q15 (Text A,B,C, L2, open, 3 marks)

Your friend wants to know about the services a village needs. Identify one service from each of the three texts.

Answer: Text A: a shop, post office, primary school, doctor's surgery or bus service (1). Text B: school, shops, pubs, post offices, clubs or bus services (1). Text C: the school, shop, village hall, pub, footpath or bus shelter (1).

Why: I gave one service from Text A. / I gave one service from Text B. / I gave one service from Text C.

TOOLKIT: practice questions

Writing format: Email (email, both)

email/1 You are emailing someone you have never met. Which opening is best?

A. Hiya! Hope ur well :)

B. Dear Mr Patel, I am writing to ask about volunteering at Panda Week.

C. To whoever reads this, I want to volunteer.

D. Hey Sam, quick question.

Answer: B. Dear Mr Patel, I am writing to ask about volunteering at Panda Week.

Why: It uses a formal greeting and says straight away why you are writing. The others are too casual for someone you don't know.

email/2 What should the subject line of an email do?

A. Repeat the whole email

B. Give your home address

C. Stay blank so the reader opens it

D. Say in a few words what the email is about

Answer: D. Say in a few words what the email is about

Why: A good subject line tells the reader at a glance why you are writing, for example "Volunteer application for Panda Week".

email/3 Which sentence is best for explaining why you are writing?

A. I am writing to apply for the weekend job advertised on your website.

B. So, yeah, I saw something.

C. Writing to you now.

D. This email is an email about a job.

Answer: A. I am writing to apply for the weekend job advertised on your website.

Why: It says clearly who you are writing about and why, in a polite, formal way.

email/4 Which closing and sign-off suits an email to someone you have never met?

A. See ya!

B. Love from

C. Kind regards, followed by your name

D. Cheers mate

Answer: C. Kind regards, followed by your name

Why: "Kind regards" is polite without being stiff. The others are too casual or too personal for a stranger.

email/5 Which request is the politest?

A. Tell me the price.

B. Price?

C. You need to tell me how much it is.

D. Could you please let me know the cost of a group ticket?

Answer: D. Could you please let me know the cost of a group ticket?

Why: "Could you please" is polite and clear. The others sound abrupt or bossy.

email/6 What should each paragraph of an email usually do?

A. Cover every point in one big block

B. Cover one main point

C. Be a single short sentence

D. Start with the sign-off

Answer: B. Cover one main point

Why: One main point per paragraph makes an email easy to follow.

email/7 What should you do before you press send?

A. Read it through and check spelling and punctuation

B. Add lots of emojis

C. Delete the greeting to save time

D. Write it all in capital letters

Answer: A. Read it through and check spelling and punctuation

Why: Proof-reading catches mistakes and makes a better impression.

email/8 Which sentence is the best way to ask for a reply?

A. Reply when you feel like it.

B. Reply or else.

C. I would be grateful for a reply by Friday 12 June.

D. That is all, bye.

Answer: C. I would be grateful for a reply by Friday 12 June.

Why: It is polite and gives a clear date.

email/9 Which greeting suits a friendly email to a friend?

A. Dear Sir or Madam,

B. To whom it may concern,

C. Dear Customer Service Manager,

D. Hi Maya,

Answer: D. Hi Maya,

Why: A friend can be greeted by first name. The other greetings are formal.

email/10 Which is the best order for an email of application?

A. Greeting, reason for writing, details, polite close, sign-off

B. Sign-off, details, greeting, reason for writing

C. Details, greeting, sign-off, reason for writing

D. Reason for writing, sign-off, greeting, details

Answer: A. Greeting, reason for writing, details, polite close, sign-off

Why: A reader expects to be greeted first, told why you are writing, given the details, and then thanked.

Writing format: Formal letter (letter, both)

letter/1 You started your letter with "Dear Sir or Madam". How should you sign off?

A. Yours sincerely

B. Love from

C. Cheers

D. Yours faithfully

Answer: D. Yours faithfully

Why: When you don't know the person's name, you use "Yours faithfully". "Yours sincerely" goes with a named person, such as "Dear Ms Khan".

letter/2 You know the person's name and start with "Dear Ms Khan". How should you sign off?

A. Yours sincerely

B. Yours faithfully

C. Love from

D. Cheers

Answer: A. Yours sincerely

Why: When you use a name, you sign off with "Yours sincerely". "Yours faithfully" goes with "Dear Sir or Madam".

letter/3 Where does your own address go in a formal letter?

A. At the bottom of the page

B. After the sign-off

C. In the top right-hand corner

D. In the greeting

Answer: C. In the top right-hand corner

Why: The sender's address goes at the top right, with the date underneath.

letter/4 Where does the date go?

A. On the last line

B. Next to your signature

C. In the first paragraph

D. Under your address

Answer: D. Under your address

Why: The date goes under the sender's address near the top.

letter/5 Which first sentence suits a letter of complaint?

A. Your company is terrible.

B. I am writing to complain about the coach trip that was cancelled on 14 May.

C. Hello, it's me again.

D. I was really annoyed!!!

Answer: B. I am writing to complain about the coach trip that was cancelled on 14 May.

Why: It states the purpose clearly and politely, with a date.

letter/6 Which sentence keeps a complaint polite but firm?

A. I would be grateful if you could refund my fare in full.

B. Give me my money back now.

C. I demand a refund immediately, or else.

D. You had better sort this out.

Answer: A. I would be grateful if you could refund my fare in full.

Why: It makes a clear request without being rude.

letter/7 What should the last paragraph of a formal letter usually do?

A. Repeat your address

B. Add a brand new complaint

C. Say what you want to happen and thank the reader

D. Apologise for writing

Answer: C. Say what you want to happen and thank the reader

Why: Ending with a clear request and a thank-you leaves the reader knowing what to do next.

letter/8 Which greeting is correct if you do not know the person's name?

A. Hi there,

B. Dear you,

C. To the boss,

D. Dear Sir or Madam,

Answer: D. Dear Sir or Madam,

Why: "Dear Sir or Madam" is the standard formal greeting when you do not have a name.

letter/9 Which phrase is too informal for a formal letter?

A. I was totally gutted about it.

B. I was extremely disappointed.

C. I would like to explain what happened.

D. Thank you for your time.

Answer: A. I was totally gutted about it.

Why: "Totally gutted" is slang. A formal letter uses a more measured phrase such as "extremely disappointed".

letter/10 Which sentence uses a formal register?

A. Write back soon, yeah?

B. I should be grateful for a reply within fourteen days.

C. Get back to me quick.

D. Just reply whenever.

Answer: B. I should be grateful for a reply within fourteen days.

Why: It is polite, precise and fully formal.

Writing format: Article (article, both)

article/1 Which is the best headline for a college newsletter article encouraging students to use buses?

A. Get On Board: Why the Bus Beats the School Run

B. Buses

C. This article is about buses and why you should use them more often than you do now

D. bus

Answer: A. Get On Board: Why the Bus Beats the School Run

Why: It is short, catches attention and hints at the article's point. The others are too plain or too long.

article/2 What is the job of the opening paragraph of an article?

A. Give the writer's address

B. List every fact in the article

C. Hook the reader and show what the article is about

D. Finish the argument

Answer: C. Hook the reader and show what the article is about

Why: A good opening grabs attention and tells readers what to expect.

article/3 Which opening is best for an article about healthy eating?

A. Food.

B. This article is about food.

C. I will now write about food and stuff.

D. Have you ever wondered why a packed lunch can beat a canteen meal?

Answer: D. Have you ever wondered why a packed lunch can beat a canteen meal?

Why: A question speaks to the reader and makes them want to read on.

article/4 Why do articles often use subheadings?

A. They replace paragraphs

B. They break up the text and help readers find sections

C. They must always be full sentences

D. They show the writer's name

Answer: B. They break up the text and help readers find sections

Why: Subheadings make an article easier to scan and follow.

article/5 Which ending suits a persuasive article?

A. So next Monday, leave the car at home and give the bus a try.

B. That's it.

C. I have run out of things to say.

D. Thank you for reading my homework.

Answer: A. So next Monday, leave the car at home and give the bus a try.

Why: A call to action leaves the reader with something to do.

article/6 Which sentence uses direct address?

A. People may be surprised how much money could be saved.

B. Money can be saved by some.

C. You may be surprised how much money you could save.

D. Savings were found.

Answer: C. You may be surprised how much money you could save.

Why: Direct address speaks straight to the reader with "you".

article/7 Which of these is a rhetorical question?

A. What time does the bus leave?

B. Where is the nearest station?

C. How much is a day ticket?

D. Who wants to sit in traffic for an hour every morning?

Answer: D. Who wants to sit in traffic for an hour every morning?

Why: A rhetorical question is asked for effect, and the writer expects the answer to be "nobody".

article/8 Which tone suits an article for students?

A. Lively and friendly, in full sentences

B. Slang and text-speak

C. Very formal legal language

D. Rude and sarcastic

Answer: A. Lively and friendly, in full sentences

Why: A lively, friendly tone keeps readers interested, while full sentences keep it correct.

article/9 What is the best way to support a point in an article?

A. Repeat the point more loudly

B. Give a reason and an example or fact

C. Add three exclamation marks

D. Say that everyone knows it

Answer: B. Give a reason and an example or fact

Why: Reasons and evidence make a point convincing.

article/10 Which set of features belongs in an article for a college newsletter?

A. A postal address and the date

B. A subject line and "Dear..."

C. A sign-off of "Yours faithfully"

D. A headline, paragraphs and a clear ending

Answer: D. A headline, paragraphs and a clear ending

Why: A headline, paragraphs and an ending are the basic features of an article.

Writing format: Review (review, both)

review/1 Which sentence would work best in a review?

A. It was good.

B. I went there.

C. The feeding talk was the highlight, because the keeper answered every question from the children.

D. Everything was bad and nobody should go.

Answer: C. The feeding talk was the highlight, because the keeper answered every question from the children.

Why: It gives an opinion and a reason with a specific example, which helps the reader decide.

review/2 What should the first paragraph of a review do?

A. List every price

B. Say goodbye to the reader

C. Repeat the leaflet

D. Say what you are reviewing and give a first impression

Answer: D. Say what you are reviewing and give a first impression

Why: Readers need to know what is being reviewed and what you thought, straight away.

review/3 Which comment is balanced?

A. The café was perfect in every way.

B. The café was friendly, although the prices were high.

C. The café was awful.

D. The café was a café.

Answer: B. The café was friendly, although the prices were high.

Why: It gives a good point and a not-so-good point.

review/4 What should a good recommendation include?

A. Who it would suit and why

B. The writer's address

C. A question for the reader's teacher

D. An apology

Answer: A. Who it would suit and why

Why: Telling readers who would enjoy it helps them decide.

review/5 Which sentence gives a reason?

A. I enjoyed it.

B. It was fun.

C. I enjoyed it because the guide made every dish easy to understand.

D. Good.

Answer: C. I enjoyed it because the guide made every dish easy to understand.

Why: "Because" shows the reason behind the opinion.

review/6 Which comment is the most helpful to someone deciding whether to go?

A. It was fine.

B. Loved it!!

C. Not great.

D. Tickets cost £12, but the queue at lunchtime lasted forty minutes.

Answer: D. Tickets cost £12, but the queue at lunchtime lasted forty minutes.

Why: It gives specific facts a reader can act on.

review/7 Which critical comment is fair and helpful?

A. The seats were uncomfortable, so I would bring a cushion.

B. The seats were rubbish.

C. The seats existed.

D. I hated the seats.

Answer: A. The seats were uncomfortable, so I would bring a cushion.

Why: It gives the problem and a useful tip.

review/8 Which tone is best for a review?

A. Angry and rude

B. Honest and friendly, with reasons

C. Bored and brief

D. Copied from the leaflet

Answer: B. Honest and friendly, with reasons

Why: Readers trust honest opinions that come with reasons.

review/9 Which is the best final sentence for a review?

A. The end.

B. Bye.

C. I rest my case.

D. Overall, I would recommend it for families, but go early to avoid queues.

Answer: D. Overall, I would recommend it for families, but go early to avoid queues.

Why: It sums up the view, says who it suits and gives a tip.

review/10 Which group of words shows the writer's opinion?

A. Delicious, disappointing, brilliant

B. Tuesday, bus, seventeen

C. And, but, so

D. Ticket, shelf, door

Answer: A. Delicious, disappointing, brilliant

Why: Opinion words describe how good or bad something was.

Writing format: Report (report, both)

report/1 Which subheading suits a formal report?

A. Stuff that's rubbish

B. OMG the buses!!

C. so yeah

D. Transport

Answer: D. Transport

Why: Report subheadings should be short and plain, so the reader can find each section quickly.

report/2 What does the introduction of a report do?

A. Gives the final recommendations

B. Explains the purpose of the report

C. Tells a joke

D. Repeats the title

Answer: B. Explains the purpose of the report

Why: A report starts by saying why it was written.

report/3 Which sentence is suited to a formal report?

A. It was found that most students travel to college by bus.

B. Loads of students go by bus lol.

C. Basically everyone is on the bus.

D. Guess what, buses rule.

Answer: A. It was found that most students travel to college by bus.

Why: A report uses a formal, factual tone.

report/4 Where do recommendations usually go in a report?

A. Before the title

B. In the middle of the introduction

C. In a final section, often as numbered points

D. Nowhere, reports never have them

Answer: C. In a final section, often as numbered points

Why: Recommendations come last, after the findings.

report/5 Which is a clear recommendation?

A. Bikes are bad.

B. Maybe stuff could happen.

C. I think it's whatever.

D. The council should install a covered cycle store by the main entrance.

Answer: D. The council should install a covered cycle store by the main entrance.

Why: It says who should do what, and where.

report/6 The survey found that 18 out of 40 students use the bus. Which sentence reports this best?

A. Nearly half of the students (18 out of 40) travel by bus.

B. Bus 18.

C. 18 students, bus, 40.

D. Bus is 18 of 40 so yeah.

Answer: A. Nearly half of the students (18 out of 40) travel by bus.

Why: A good report turns figures into a clear sentence.

report/7 Which should be avoided in a formal report?

A. Subheadings

B. Slang and personal chat

C. Facts and figures

D. Clear paragraphs

Answer: B. Slang and personal chat

Why: Slang and chat do not suit a formal report.

report/8 Which opening line suits a report for a head teacher?

A. Hiya, here's what I think.

B. Dear Diary,

C. Read this now.

D. This report describes how Panda Day went and suggests improvements for next year.

Answer: D. This report describes how Panda Day went and suggests improvements for next year.

Why: It states the purpose formally and clearly.

report/9 Which heading fits a section about what went wrong?

A. Problems

B. Yay!

C. Stuff

D. My feelings about lunch

Answer: A. Problems

Why: Headings should be short, plain and informative.

report/10 What are the "To", "From" and "Date" lines at the top of a report for?

A. To make the page look full

B. To show the price

C. To show who it is for, who wrote it and when

D. To list the page numbers

Answer: C. To show who it is for, who wrote it and when

Why: They tell the reader the basic facts about the report.

Writing format: Blog post (blog, both)

blog/1 Which is the best final sentence for a blog post?

A. The end.

B. So that's why I'd pick a village every time. Would you? Tell me in the comments.

C. Bye.

D. That's all I have to say about towns and villages and stuff.

Answer: B. So that's why I'd pick a village every time. Would you? Tell me in the comments.

Why: It sums up the writer's view and invites the reader to respond, which suits a blog.

blog/2 Which title would catch a reader's attention?

A. I Moved from a Village to a Town: Here's What Surprised Me

B. Blog

C. A text about moving

D. Thoughts

Answer: A. I Moved from a Village to a Town: Here's What Surprised Me

Why: A good title is specific and makes you want to read on.

blog/3 Why does a blog post use short paragraphs?

A. They use less ink

B. They are required by law

C. They are easier to read on a screen

D. They hide spelling mistakes

Answer: C. They are easier to read on a screen

Why: Short paragraphs stop the page looking like a solid block of text.

blog/4 Which opening is personal and clear?

A. Moving is a thing that people do.

B. In this blog post the following will be explained.

C. Dear Sir or Madam,

D. Last month I swapped fields for pavements, and I have a lot to say about it.

Answer: D. Last month I swapped fields for pavements, and I have a lot to say about it.

Why: It sounds like a real person and tells you what is coming.

blog/5 Which tone is right for a blog?

A. Friendly and honest, in full sentences

B. Slang and emojis only

C. Cold and legal

D. Shouting in capital letters

Answer: A. Friendly and honest, in full sentences

Why: A blog can be personal, but it should still be clear and correct.

blog/6 Which sentence gives a reason for a view?

A. I prefer the town.

B. I prefer the town because I can reach my friends on foot.

C. Town is good.

D. It is town.

Answer: B. I prefer the town because I can reach my friends on foot.

Why: "Because" introduces a reason.

blog/7 Which closing invites readers to join in?

A. Do not reply.

B. Bye forever.

C. That is my last word and nobody can change it.

D. What do you think? Tell me in the comments.

Answer: D. What do you think? Tell me in the comments.

Why: Ending with a question encourages readers to respond.

blog/8 Which is a good way to add interest to a blog post?

A. A short story about something that happened to you

B. A list of random words

C. A copy of a leaflet

D. Your first sentence repeated

Answer: A. A short story about something that happened to you

Why: Personal stories bring a blog to life.

blog/9 Which should you avoid in a blog post?

A. Full stops

B. Paragraphs

C. Text-speak such as "cuz" and "ur"

D. A title

Answer: C. Text-speak such as "cuz" and "ur"

Why: Text-speak looks careless, even in a friendly post.

blog/10 Which ending is balanced and honest?

A. Everything is perfect.

B. Everything is terrible.

C. I have nothing to say.

D. I miss the quiet, but I would not go back.

Answer: D. I miss the quiet, but I would not go back.

Why: It admits something good about the old place while being clear about the choice.

Writing format: Web forum post (forum, both)

forum/1 Which is the best first sentence for a forum post giving your view on later school start times?

A. Hi everyone, I think school should start later, and I have three reasons.

B. school start times r bad lol

C. Dear Sir or Madam, I am writing to complain.

D. School.

Answer: A. Hi everyone, I think school should start later, and I have three reasons.

Why: It says what the writer thinks straight away, sounds friendly and uses full words. The others are too casual, too formal for a forum, or say nothing.

forum/2 Where in a forum post should your view appear?

A. In the very last line only

B. Nowhere, keep it secret

C. In the first sentence or two

D. In the sign-off

Answer: C. In the first sentence or two

Why: Readers should know your view straight away.

forum/3 Which reply to a question is the most helpful?

A. No.

B. Whatever.

C. Why are you asking?

D. I'd say yes, because the guided tour answers questions you would otherwise miss.

Answer: D. I'd say yes, because the guided tour answers questions you would otherwise miss.

Why: It gives a view and a reason.

forum/4 How can you disagree politely?

A. I see your point, but I think evening buses matter more.

B. You are wrong and silly.

C. That is the dumbest idea.

D. Nobody agrees with you.

Answer: A. I see your point, but I think evening buses matter more.

Why: It acknowledges the other view before giving yours.

forum/5 A good forum post usually ends with...

A. Your full address

B. A question or an invitation to reply

C. Yours faithfully

D. A long list of rules

Answer: B. A question or an invitation to reply

Why: Inviting a reply keeps the discussion going.

forum/6 Which tone suits a web forum?

A. Cold and legal

B. Rude and angry

C. Silent

D. Friendly and chatty, but still clear

Answer: D. Friendly and chatty, but still clear

Why: A forum is informal, but readers still need to understand you.

forum/7 Which sentence includes an example?

A. For example, last winter my bus was cancelled three times in a week.

B. Buses are sometimes late.

C. I do not like buses.

D. Buses exist.

Answer: A. For example, last winter my bus was cancelled three times in a week.

Why: A specific example makes a point real.

forum/8 Why are short paragraphs useful in a forum post?

A. They are quicker to type backwards

B. They are required by the website

C. They are easier to read on a screen

D. They hide spelling mistakes

Answer: C. They are easier to read on a screen

Why: Short paragraphs keep a post readable.

forum/9 Which is NOT suitable in a forum post?

A. A polite greeting

B. A reason for your view

C. A question at the end

D. ALL CAPITALS to show anger

Answer: D. ALL CAPITALS to show anger

Why: Capital letters look like shouting and make a post harder to read.

forum/10 Which opening shows you are replying to another member?

A. Dear Sir,

B. Hi Dani, I agree with your point about late buses.

C. To whom it may concern,

D. Yours sincerely,

Answer: B. Hi Dani, I agree with your point about late buses.

Why: It names the person and links to what they said.

Writing format: Online form (form, both)

form/1 A box asks "What did you like most?" Which answer is best?

A. It was good.

B. IDK, everything

C. The guide was friendly and explained each dish, which made the tour more interesting.

D. I did not like it at all.

Answer: C. The guide was friendly and explained each dish, which made the tour more interesting.

Why: It answers the question and gives a reason. "It was good" gives the reader nothing to use.

form/2 What should you do first when you reach a box on an online form?

A. Start typing at once

B. Skip to the next box

C. Delete the label

D. Read the label on the box

Answer: D. Read the label on the box

Why: The label tells you what to write.

form/3 Which answer is best for the box "What could be improved?"

A. The group was large, so a smaller group would make it easier to hear the guide.

B. Nothing.

C. Everything.

D. idk

Answer: A. The group was large, so a smaller group would make it easier to hear the guide.

Why: It gives a clear point, a reason and a suggestion.

form/4 Why should you write in full sentences on a form?

A. They use up more space

B. They make your meaning clear to the reader

C. They are required by law

D. They hide mistakes

Answer: B. They make your meaning clear to the reader

Why: A reader who is not in front of you needs clear sentences.

form/5 Which is a polite way to complain on a form?

A. Your tour was a joke.

B. Terrible. Do better.

C. Sort it out.

D. I was disappointed that the tour started late, and I would appreciate a smaller group next time.

Answer: D. I was disappointed that the tour started late, and I would appreciate a smaller group next time.

Why: It is honest, polite and constructive.

form/6 A box asks "Would you recommend this?" Which answer is best?

A. Yes, I would, especially for families, because the guide was friendly and the food was excellent.

B. Yes.

C. yeah why not

D. Maybe if I feel like it.

Answer: A. Yes, I would, especially for families, because the guide was friendly and the food was excellent.

Why: It gives an answer, a reason and who it suits.

form/7 What should you do before pressing submit?

A. Add more boxes

B. Write in capitals

C. Check your spelling and punctuation

D. Delete your answer

Answer: C. Check your spelling and punctuation

Why: Proof-reading avoids mistakes.

form/8 The box is small and you have a lot to say. What should you do?

A. Write very tiny so everything fits

B. Leave it blank

C. Copy the label

D. Choose the most important points and write them clearly

Answer: D. Choose the most important points and write them clearly

Why: Clear, short answers are better than cramming.

form/9 Which line suits the end of a feedback form?

A. Done.

B. Thank you for asking for my views.

C. Bye.

D. Whatever you say.

Answer: B. Thank you for asking for my views.

Why: A polite thank-you is a good finish.

form/10 Which sentence gives a reason for a view?

A. I enjoyed the tasting stops because I tried foods I had never eaten before.

B. I enjoyed it.

C. It was good.

D. Nice.

Answer: A. I enjoyed the tasting stops because I tried foods I had never eaten before.

Why: "Because" shows the reason.

Writing format: Information or advice sheet (advice, both)

advice/1 Which is the best subheading for an advice sheet about first train journeys?

A. Trains

B. Things

C. Why trains are great and I love them so much

D. Buy your ticket before you board

Answer: D. Buy your ticket before you board

Why: It tells the reader exactly what to do. The others are too vague or too long, or are about the writer rather than the reader.

advice/2 Which title shows who an advice sheet is for?

A. Your First Train Journey: Tips for Travelling Alone

B. Train

C. Things to know

D. Advice

Answer: A. Your First Train Journey: Tips for Travelling Alone

Why: A good title says who the advice is for and what it covers.

advice/3 Which tip explains what to do and why?

A. Charge your phone.

B. Charge your phone the night before, so you can show your ticket on the screen.

C. Phones are useful.

D. Phone.

Answer: B. Charge your phone the night before, so you can show your ticket on the screen.

Why: A tip with a reason is more helpful and more convincing.

advice/4 Which sentence uses direct, simple language?

A. It might be advisable that early arrival be considered in the context of platform location.

B. Maybe get there at some time.

C. Arriving early is a thing.

D. Arrive ten minutes early so that you can find the right platform.

Answer: D. Arrive ten minutes early so that you can find the right platform.

Why: Advice should be clear and direct.

advice/5 When are numbered tips the best choice?

A. When the order of the steps matters

B. When you want to hide the order

C. When there is only one tip

D. When the tips are jokes

Answer: A. When the order of the steps matters

Why: Numbers show a sequence.

advice/6 Which is a good opening line for an advice sheet?

A. I am a person who walks.

B. Walking.

C. If you are walking in the desert for the first time, these tips will keep you safe and comfortable.

D. This is a document.

Answer: C. If you are walking in the desert for the first time, these tips will keep you safe and comfortable.

Why: It says who the advice is for and why it helps.

advice/7 Which closing line reassures the reader?

A. Good luck, you will need it.

B. That is all.

C. Do not blame us.

D. Follow these steps and you will be fine, and staff are always happy to help.

Answer: D. Follow these steps and you will be fine, and staff are always happy to help.

Why: A reassuring ending leaves the reader feeling confident.

advice/8 Which sentence is written as an instruction?

A. The timetable could have been checked.

B. Check the timetable before you leave.

C. Checking is something people do.

D. You will have checked.

Answer: B. Check the timetable before you leave.

Why: Instructions use the base form of the verb and speak to the reader.

advice/9 Which heading is the clearest?

A. What to bring

B. Stuff

C. Bag things?

D. Misc

Answer: A. What to bring

Why: A clear heading tells the reader what is in the section.

advice/10 Which sentence is too vague to be good advice?

A. Carry at least two litres of water.

B. Wear a hat and sun cream.

C. Be careful and do things properly.

D. Keep with the group.

Answer: C. Be careful and do things properly.

Why: Good advice is specific, so the reader knows exactly what to do.

Writing format: Diary entry (diary, both)

diary/1 Which sentence belongs in a diary entry?

A. I felt nervous when the bus was late, but it all worked out in the end.

B. Visitors should arrive before 9 am.

C. Yours faithfully,

D. Terms and conditions apply.

Answer: A. I felt nervous when the bus was late, but it all worked out in the end.

Why: A diary says what happened and how the writer felt. The other lines belong in a notice, a formal letter or small print.

diary/2 How should a diary entry usually start?

A. With "Yours faithfully"

B. With the day and the date

C. With a subject line

D. With a list of prices

Answer: B. With the day and the date

Why: The date shows when the events happened.

diary/3 Which sentence shows feelings?

A. The gate opened.

B. The keeper opened the gate at nine.

C. There was a gate.

D. I was nervous when the keeper opened the gate, but I soon relaxed.

Answer: D. I was nervous when the keeper opened the gate, but I soon relaxed.

Why: A diary says how the writer felt, not only what happened.

diary/4 Which sentence keeps events in the order they happened?

A. First we fed the animals, then we cleaned the garden, and after lunch we watched a talk.

B. After lunch we watched a talk, first we fed the animals, then we cleaned the garden.

C. We cleaned, talk, fed, lunch.

D. The garden talk fed lunch.

Answer: A. First we fed the animals, then we cleaned the garden, and after lunch we watched a talk.

Why: A diary usually follows time order.

diary/5 Which person is a diary written in?

A. Second person (you)

B. Third person (he or she)

C. First person (I)

D. Passive only

Answer: C. First person (I)

Why: A diary is a personal record, so it uses "I".

diary/6 Which is a good descriptive detail?

A. It smelled.

B. There was bamboo.

C. Bamboo exists.

D. The bamboo smelled like fresh-cut grass.

Answer: D. The bamboo smelled like fresh-cut grass.

Why: Specific detail makes writing vivid.

diary/7 Which ending looks ahead?

A. That was Tuesday.

B. Tomorrow I am helping the keepers with the afternoon feed, and I can't wait.

C. The end.

D. I wrote this.

Answer: B. Tomorrow I am helping the keepers with the afternoon feed, and I can't wait.

Why: Looking ahead is a natural way to finish a diary.

diary/8 Which tone suits a diary entry?

A. Personal and chatty, in full sentences

B. Formal and legal

C. Rude to the reader

D. A list of numbers

Answer: A. Personal and chatty, in full sentences

Why: A diary sounds like the writer, but should still be written in correct sentences.

diary/9 Which of these does NOT belong in a diary entry?

A. Today I felt...

B. I can't wait for tomorrow

C. Yours faithfully

D. I was surprised by...

Answer: C. Yours faithfully

Why: "Yours faithfully" is the ending of a formal letter.

diary/10 Which sentence uses the past tense correctly?

A. We arrive at eight and the keepers was already working.

B. We arrives at eight and the keepers were already working.

C. We arriving at eight and the keepers is already working.

D. We arrived at eight and the keepers were already working.

Answer: D. We arrived at eight and the keepers were already working.

Why: A diary about today usually uses the past tense, with correct verbs.

Writing format: Newsletter (newsletter, both)

newsletter/1 Which is the best heading for a village newsletter item about a summer fair?

A. Fair

B. Summer Fair: Come and Join Us on 12 July!

C. An event that is going to happen in the future in the village hall

D. The thing

Answer: B. Summer Fair: Come and Join Us on 12 July!

Why: It says what the item is about, gives the date and invites people. The others are too short, too long or too vague.

newsletter/2 What goes at the top of a newsletter?

A. A sign-off

B. The price list

C. The writer's address

D. The name of the newsletter and the date

Answer: D. The name of the newsletter and the date

Why: Readers want to know what it is and when it is from.

newsletter/3 Which welcome works best?

A. Welcome to this month's newsletter. Read on for news about the summer fair and our new bus service.

B. Hello.

C. Newsletter.

D. Read.

Answer: A. Welcome to this month's newsletter. Read on for news about the summer fair and our new bus service.

Why: It welcomes readers and tells them what is inside.

newsletter/4 Why use a heading for each item?

A. It makes the newsletter longer

B. It hides the text

C. Readers can scan and find what interests them

D. It is required by law

Answer: C. Readers can scan and find what interests them

Why: Headings make a newsletter easy to scan.

newsletter/5 Which tone suits a newsletter?

A. Cold and formal

B. Rude and sarcastic

C. Silent

D. Friendly and positive, speaking to "you" and "we"

Answer: D. Friendly and positive, speaking to "you" and "we"

Why: A newsletter builds a sense of community.

newsletter/6 Which closing line works well?

A. That is all.

B. Come along on 12 July and bring a friend.

C. Do not come.

D. Bye.

Answer: B. Come along on 12 July and bring a friend.

Why: It gives a date and invites people to join in.

newsletter/7 Which is best for event details?

A. The date, time and place in a short list

B. Hidden in a long paragraph

C. Left out

D. Written as a riddle

Answer: A. The date, time and place in a short list

Why: Event details should be easy to find.

newsletter/8 Which heading is best for news of a bus timetable change?

A. Bus

B. News

C. New Evening Bus from 1 September

D. A thing about buses

Answer: C. New Evening Bus from 1 September

Why: It is specific and tells the reader what and when.

newsletter/9 Which sentence invites people to get involved?

A. Do not help.

B. The fair is held.

C. Fairs exist.

D. If you would like to help at the fair, please speak to Maya at the village hall.

Answer: D. If you would like to help at the fair, please speak to Maya at the village hall.

Why: It says what to do and who to ask.

newsletter/10 Which does NOT belong in a newsletter item?

A. Rude comments about neighbours

B. Dates of events

C. A thank-you

D. Contact details

Answer: A. Rude comments about neighbours

Why: A newsletter should be friendly and respectful.

SPaG: Full stops and capital letters (full-stops, L1/L2)

full-stops/1 Which is punctuated correctly?

A. we went to tel aviv in may.

B. We went to tel aviv in may.

C. We went to Tel Aviv in may

D. We went to Tel Aviv in May.

Answer: D. We went to Tel Aviv in May.

Why: The sentence starts with a capital, "Tel Aviv" and "May" are names so they need capitals, and it ends with a full stop.

full-stops/2 Which pair of sentences is punctuated correctly?

A. The bus was late. We missed the start.

B. The bus was late, we missed the start.

C. The bus was late we missed the start.

D. the bus was late. We missed the start.

Answer: A. The bus was late. We missed the start.

Why: Two complete sentences need a full stop between them, and each starts with a capital letter. A comma is not strong enough.

full-stops/3 Which sentence has the right capital letters?

A. On friday we visit the zoo.

B. On Friday we visit The zoo.

C. On Friday we visit the zoo.

D. on Friday we visit the zoo.

Answer: C. On Friday we visit the zoo.

Why: Days of the week need capitals, and so does the first word of a sentence, but not "the" in the middle.

full-stops/4 Which sentence uses "I" correctly?

A. Yesterday i went to the market.

B. yesterday I went to the market.

C. Yesterday, i went to the market.

D. Yesterday I went to the market.

Answer: D. Yesterday I went to the market.

Why: "I" is always a capital letter.

full-stops/5 Which sentence uses capital letters correctly for names?

A. maya lives in brayminster, near northcaster.

B. Maya lives in Brayminster, near Northcaster.

C. Maya lives in brayminster, near Northcaster.

D. Maya Lives In Brayminster, Near Northcaster.

Answer: B. Maya lives in Brayminster, near Northcaster.

Why: Names of people and places start with capitals. Other words in the sentence do not.

full-stops/6 Which is correct?

A. I love pandas. They eat bamboo all day.

B. I love pandas, they eat bamboo all day.

C. I love pandas they eat bamboo all day.

D. I love pandas. they eat bamboo all day.

Answer: A. I love pandas. They eat bamboo all day.

Why: Each sentence starts with a capital letter and ends with a full stop.

full-stops/7 Which sentence ends correctly?

A. The tour starts at nine?

B. The tour starts at nine,

C. The tour starts at nine.

D. The tour starts at nine

Answer: C. The tour starts at nine.

Why: A statement ends with a full stop.

full-stops/8 Which fixes the run-on sentence "The train was late the platform was empty"?

A. The train was late the platform. Was empty.

B. The train. Was late the platform was empty.

C. the train was late. the platform was empty.

D. The train was late. The platform was empty.

Answer: D. The train was late. The platform was empty.

Why: There are two complete ideas, so they need a full stop between them and a capital letter on the second.

full-stops/9 Which sentence has the right capitals for days and months?

A. My birthday is on Tuesday 5 March.

B. My birthday is on tuesday 5 march.

C. My Birthday Is On Tuesday 5 March.

D. my birthday is on Tuesday 5 march.

Answer: A. My birthday is on Tuesday 5 March.

Why: Days and months start with capital letters.

full-stops/10 Which line punctuates a list and two sentences correctly?

A. We saw lions, tigers and bears then. We had lunch.

B. We saw lions, tigers and bears. Then we had lunch.

C. We saw lions, tigers and bears. then we had lunch.

D. We saw lions tigers and bears. Then we had lunch.

Answer: B. We saw lions, tigers and bears. Then we had lunch.

Why: The list has commas, the first sentence ends with a full stop, and the next one starts with a capital letter.

SPaG: Question marks (question-marks, L1/L2)

question-marks/1 Which sentence needs a question mark at the end?

A. Is lunch included in the price

B. I would like to book two tickets

C. The bus leaves at ten

D. Please send me a timetable

Answer: A. Is lunch included in the price

Why: "Is lunch included in the price" is asking something, so it ends with a question mark.

question-marks/2 Which sentence is punctuated correctly?

A. Could you tell me where the station is.

B. Could you tell me where the station is!

C. Could you tell me where the station is?

D. Could you tell me where the station is,

Answer: C. Could you tell me where the station is?

Why: It is a direct question, so it ends with a question mark.

question-marks/3 Which of these should NOT end with a question mark?

A. When does the tour start

B. Is the café open

C. Can we bring our own lunch

D. I wonder when the tour starts

Answer: D. I wonder when the tour starts

Why: "I wonder when the tour starts" is a statement about a question, not a direct question, so it ends with a full stop.

question-marks/4 Which is correct?

A. Why are the buses always late.

B. Why are the buses always late?

C. Why. Are the buses always late?

D. Why are the buses always late,

Answer: B. Why are the buses always late?

Why: A direct question ends with a question mark.

question-marks/5 Which request is the politest and punctuated correctly?

A. Would you mind telling me what time the tour starts?

B. Tell me what time the tour starts?

C. What time the tour starts?

D. Would you mind telling me what time the tour starts.

Answer: A. Would you mind telling me what time the tour starts?

Why: A polite request that asks a direct question ends with a question mark.

question-marks/6 Which question is written correctly for an email asking for information?

A. Children under five is free?

B. Are children under five free.

C. Are children under five free?

D. Are children under five free,

Answer: C. Are children under five free?

Why: It is a proper question with the verb first, and it ends with a question mark.

question-marks/7 Which tag question is punctuated correctly?

A. It's a long walk, isn't it.

B. It's a long walk isn't it?

C. It's a long walk? isn't it.

D. It's a long walk, isn't it?

Answer: D. It's a long walk, isn't it?

Why: A tag question has a comma before it and a question mark at the end.

question-marks/8 Which pair is punctuated correctly?

A. Where do you live? How do you travel to college?

B. Where do you live? How do you travel to college.

C. Where do you live. How do you travel to college?

D. Where do you live? how do you travel to college?

Answer: A. Where do you live? How do you travel to college?

Why: Each question ends with a question mark and the next one starts with a capital letter.

question-marks/9 Which of these is a question?

A. Floating in the Dead Sea is easy

B. Have you ever floated in the Dead Sea

C. I have floated in the Dead Sea

D. Float in the Dead Sea

Answer: B. Have you ever floated in the Dead Sea

Why: Only the first asks something, so it needs a question mark.

question-marks/10 Which sentence should end with a full stop, not a question mark?

A. Is the bus running

B. Will the bus be late

C. Does the bus run on Sundays

D. She asked whether the bus was running

Answer: D. She asked whether the bus was running

Why: It reports a question rather than asking one directly.

SPaG: Exclamation marks (exclamation-marks, L1/L2)

exclamation-marks/1 Which sentence uses an exclamation mark best?

A. Dear Sir or Madam!

B. I am writing to ask about tickets!

C. Try the bus for one week and see the difference!

D. Yours faithfully!

Answer: C. Try the bus for one week and see the difference!

Why: This is a call to action in a persuasive piece, so an exclamation mark adds energy. The others are formal phrases that should not have one.

exclamation-marks/2 Which sentence suits an exclamation mark?

A. The train leaves at six

B. Please send me a timetable

C. My name is Dani

D. What a brilliant view

Answer: D. What a brilliant view

Why: Exclamation marks show strong feeling, such as delight or surprise.

exclamation-marks/3 Which line uses exclamation marks sensibly?

A. It was amazing!!!!!

B. It was amazing!

C. It was amazing!?!

D. It was amazing!!!

Answer: B. It was amazing!

Why: One exclamation mark is enough.

exclamation-marks/4 What should a formal letter of complaint usually do about exclamation marks?

A. Avoid them

B. End every sentence with one

C. Use three in a row

D. Put one after the greeting

Answer: A. Avoid them

Why: A formal letter stays calm and measured.

exclamation-marks/5 Which command suits an exclamation mark?

A. The shop is closed

B. I shall be late

C. Watch out

D. It was a long journey

Answer: C. Watch out

Why: A sudden warning or command is often followed by an exclamation mark.

exclamation-marks/6 How many exclamation marks should you normally use at one time?

A. Three

B. As many as you like

C. Five

D. One

Answer: D. One

Why: A single exclamation mark makes the point. More looks careless.

exclamation-marks/7 Which blog line uses an exclamation mark well?

A. We made it to the top, and the view was incredible!

B. Dear Mr Patel!

C. Thank you for your letter of 3 May!

D. The meeting is at 3 pm!

Answer: A. We made it to the top, and the view was incredible!

Why: It shows genuine excitement. The others are formal or neutral lines.

exclamation-marks/8 Which sentence shows strong surprise?

A. I found a table.

B. I can't believe we found a free table!

C. A table was found.

D. The table is free.

Answer: B. I can't believe we found a free table!

Why: The words and the exclamation mark together show surprise.

exclamation-marks/9 Which is punctuated correctly?

A. What a long queue?

B. What a long queue.!

C. What a long queue!?!

D. What a long queue!

Answer: D. What a long queue!

Why: It is an exclamation, so it ends with a single exclamation mark.

exclamation-marks/10 In an article for students, which is the strongest call to action?

A. Give the bus a try this week!

B. The bus is a form of transport.

C. Buses have wheels.

D. Some people take buses.

Answer: A. Give the bus a try this week!

Why: It tells the reader what to do, with energy.

SPaG: Commas (commas, L1/L2)

commas/1 Which is punctuated correctly?

A. After lunch we, walked to the beach.

B. After, lunch we walked to the beach.

C. After lunch we walked, to the beach.

D. After lunch, we walked to the beach.

Answer: D. After lunch, we walked to the beach.

Why: "After lunch" is an opening phrase, so the comma goes straight after it.

commas/2 Which sentence has the commas in the right place for a list?

A. We bought bread olives, cheese and, fruit.

B. We bought bread, olives, cheese and fruit.

C. We bought, bread olives cheese and fruit.

D. We bought bread, olives cheese, and fruit

Answer: B. We bought bread, olives, cheese and fruit.

Why: Commas separate the items in a list, and "and" joins the last two.

commas/3 Which sentence uses a comma correctly after an opening word?

A. However, the bus was late.

B. However the bus, was late.

C. However the bus was, late.

D. However the bus was late,

Answer: A. However, the bus was late.

Why: A comma follows an opening word such as "However".

commas/4 Which sentence has the comma in the right place?

A. When the bus arrived we, got on.

B. When, the bus arrived we got on.

C. When the bus arrived, we got on.

D. When the bus, arrived we got on.

Answer: C. When the bus arrived, we got on.

Why: A comma follows the opening clause.

commas/5 Which sentence uses a comma incorrectly to join two sentences?

A. The bus was late, so we missed the start.

B. The bus was late, and we missed the start.

C. Because the bus was late, we missed the start.

D. The bus was late, we missed the start.

Answer: D. The bus was late, we missed the start.

Why: A comma alone cannot join two complete sentences. You need a full stop or a joining word such as "so" or "and".

commas/6 Which sentence puts commas round extra information correctly?

A. Maya, who lives nearby, walks to college.

B. Maya who lives nearby, walks to college.

C. Maya, who lives nearby walks to college.

D. Maya who, lives nearby walks to college.

Answer: A. Maya, who lives nearby, walks to college.

Why: Extra information in the middle goes between a pair of commas.

commas/7 Which sentence punctuates the person being spoken to correctly?

A. Thank you Mr, Patel for your reply.

B. Thank you, Mr Patel, for your reply.

C. Thank, you Mr Patel for your reply.

D. Thank you Mr Patel, for, your reply.

Answer: B. Thank you, Mr Patel, for your reply.

Why: The name of the person you are addressing goes between commas.

commas/8 Which sentence has commas round "in my opinion"?

A. The bus in my opinion is, better value.

B. The, bus in my opinion, is better value.

C. The bus in, my opinion is better value.

D. The bus, in my opinion, is better value.

Answer: D. The bus, in my opinion, is better value.

Why: A phrase such as "in my opinion" in the middle of a sentence is set off by commas.

commas/9 Which sentence punctuates a list of describing words correctly?

A. It was a long, hot, tiring walk.

B. It was a long hot, tiring, walk.

C. It was a, long hot tiring walk.

D. It was a long, hot tiring, walk.

Answer: A. It was a long, hot, tiring walk.

Why: Describing words in a list are separated by commas.

commas/10 Which sentence has a comma after "Firstly"?

A. Firstly I would, like to ask about prices.

B. Firstly I would like, to ask about prices.

C. Firstly, I would like to ask about prices.

D. Firstly I would like to ask, about prices.

Answer: C. Firstly, I would like to ask about prices.

Why: A comma follows an opening word like "Firstly".

SPaG: Apostrophes for belonging (apostrophes-possession, L1/L2)

apostrophes-possession/1 Which is correct?

A. The bus's were all late.

B. The driver's seat was broken.

C. The drivers seat was broken.

D. The drivers' seat's was broken.

Answer: B. The driver's seat was broken.

Why: The seat belongs to one driver, so it is "driver's". "Buses" is just a plural, so it never needs an apostrophe.

apostrophes-possession/2 Which sentence is correct if one girl owns the bag?

A. The girl's bag was heavy.

B. The girls bag was heavy.

C. The girl's bag's was heavy.

D. The girls' bag was heavy.

Answer: A. The girl's bag was heavy.

Why: For one owner, the apostrophe goes before the s.

apostrophes-possession/3 Which sentence is correct if several girls own the bags?

A. The girl's bags were heavy.

B. The girls bags were heavy.

C. The girls' bags were heavy.

D. The girls's bags were heavy.

Answer: C. The girls' bags were heavy.

Why: For a plural ending in s, the apostrophe goes after the s.

apostrophes-possession/4 Which sentence has no apostrophe error?

A. Two bus's arrived at the stop.

B. Two buses' arrived at the stop.

C. Two buse's arrived at the stop.

D. Two buses arrived at the stop.

Answer: D. Two buses arrived at the stop.

Why: "Buses" is just a plural. Nothing belongs to the buses, so no apostrophe is needed.

apostrophes-possession/5 Which is correct for the ears of several pandas?

A. The pandas' ears

B. The panda's ears

C. The pandas ears

D. The pandas's ears

Answer: A. The pandas' ears

Why: Several pandas, so the apostrophe goes after the s.

apostrophes-possession/6 Which shows that the games belong to the children?

A. The childrens games

B. The children's games

C. The childrens' games

D. The children games

Answer: B. The children's games

Why: "Children" is already plural without an s, so the apostrophe goes before an added s.

apostrophes-possession/7 Which sentence shows that the letter belongs to Mr Patel?

A. Mr Patels letter arrived today.

B. Mr Patel letter's arrived today.

C. Mr Patels' letter arrived today.

D. Mr Patel's letter arrived today.

Answer: D. Mr Patel's letter arrived today.

Why: The letter belongs to Mr Patel, so add 's.

apostrophes-possession/8 Which is correct for the library that belongs to one college?

A. The college's library is open late.

B. The colleges library is open late.

C. The college library's is open late.

D. The colleges' library is open late.

Answer: A. The college's library is open late.

Why: One college owns the library, so the apostrophe goes before the s.

apostrophes-possession/9 Which sentence has an apostrophe error?

A. The tickets were expensive.

B. The ticket's price was high.

C. The tickets' were expensive.

D. The tickets' prices were high.

Answer: C. The tickets' were expensive.

Why: "Tickets" is a plural, but nothing belongs to the tickets in this sentence.

apostrophes-possession/10 Which is the correct way to write the work of one day?

A. A days work

B. A days' work

C. A day work's

D. A day's work

Answer: D. A day's work

Why: The work belongs to one day, so the apostrophe goes before the s.

SPaG: Apostrophes for missing letters (apostrophes-omission, L2)

apostrophes-omission/1 Which is correct?

A. It's going to rain later.

B. The council changed it's mind.

C. Its going to rain later.

D. The village has it's own shop.

Answer: A. It's going to rain later.

Why: "It's going to rain" means "it is going to rain", so it needs the apostrophe. In the other sentences, "its" means "belonging to it" and should have no apostrophe.

apostrophes-omission/2 Which sentence is correct?

A. Their waiting at the station.

B. There waiting at the station.

C. They're waiting at the station.

D. Theyre waiting at the station.

Answer: C. They're waiting at the station.

Why: "They're" is short for "they are".

apostrophes-omission/3 Which is the correct short form of "do not"?

A. dont'

B. do'nt

C. d'ont

D. don't

Answer: D. don't

Why: The apostrophe goes where the "o" has been left out.

apostrophes-omission/4 Which word completes the sentence correctly? "The bus changed ___ route."

A. its

B. it's

C. its'

D. it is'

Answer: A. its

Why: "Its" without an apostrophe means "belonging to it".

apostrophes-omission/5 Which sentence uses the short forms of "we are" and "did not" correctly?

A. Were late because the train didnt arrive.

B. We're late because the train didn't arrive.

C. We're late because the train did'nt arrive.

D. We'er late because the train didn't arrive.

Answer: B. We're late because the train didn't arrive.

Why: "We're" is "we are" and "didn't" is "did not", with the apostrophe where the letter is missing.

apostrophes-omission/6 Which sentence asks who something belongs to, correctly?

A. Who's bag is this?

B. Whos bag is this?

C. Whose' bag is this?

D. Whose bag is this?

Answer: D. Whose bag is this?

Why: "Whose" asks who something belongs to. "Who's" means "who is".

apostrophes-omission/7 Which is most suitable for a formal letter?

A. I do not agree with the proposal.

B. I don't agree with the proposal.

C. I dont agree with the proposal.

D. I do'nt agree with the proposal.

Answer: A. I do not agree with the proposal.

Why: Formal writing usually avoids short forms.

apostrophes-omission/8 Which sentence uses the short form of "I would" correctly?

A. Id like a refund.

B. I'ld like a refund.

C. I'd like a refund.

D. I'd'like a refund.

Answer: C. I'd like a refund.

Why: "I'd" is short for "I would".

apostrophes-omission/9 Which sentence uses "you're" correctly?

A. Your going to love the food.

B. Youre going to love the food.

C. You'r going to love the food.

D. You're going to love the food.

Answer: D. You're going to love the food.

Why: "You're" means "you are".

apostrophes-omission/10 Which sentence is punctuated correctly?

A. Thats the café where weve eaten before.

B. That's the café where we've eaten before.

C. That's the café where we'ave eaten before.

D. Thats' the café where we've eaten before.

Answer: B. That's the café where we've eaten before.

Why: "That's" is "that is" and "we've" is "we have".

SPaG: Inverted commas (speech marks) (inverted-commas, L2)

inverted-commas/1 Which is punctuated correctly?

A. My friend said "the train is quicker".

B. My friend said, The train is "quicker."

C. My friend said, "The train is quicker."

D. "My friend said", the train is quicker.

Answer: C. My friend said, "The train is quicker."

Why: There is a comma before the speech, the spoken words start with a capital letter, and the full stop goes inside the inverted commas.

inverted-commas/2 Which sentence is punctuated correctly?

A. The keeper said "Please keep your voice low".

B. The keeper said, "please keep your voice low."

C. The keeper said, Please keep your voice low.

D. The keeper said, "Please keep your voice low."

Answer: D. The keeper said, "Please keep your voice low."

Why: There is a comma before the speech, the spoken sentence starts with a capital, and the full stop is inside the inverted commas.

inverted-commas/3 Which sentence uses inverted commas correctly for a short quotation?

A. The council calls the new route "a better service".

B. The council calls the new route a better service".

C. The council calls the "new route a better service.

D. The council "calls" the new route a better service.

Answer: A. The council calls the new route "a better service".

Why: The inverted commas go round exactly the words quoted.

inverted-commas/4 Which sentence is correct for a spoken question?

A. She asked, "Where is the nearest stop"?

B. She asked, "Where is the nearest stop?"

C. She asked "Where is the nearest stop?".

D. She asked, Where is the "nearest stop?"

Answer: B. She asked, "Where is the nearest stop?"

Why: The question mark belongs to the spoken question, so it goes inside the inverted commas.

inverted-commas/5 Which sentence has split speech punctuated correctly?

A. "I would, said Dani, like a window seat."

B. "I would" said Dani "like a window seat."

C. "I would, said Dani", "like a window seat."

D. "I would," said Dani, "like a window seat."

Answer: D. "I would," said Dani, "like a window seat."

Why: Each part of the speech has its own inverted commas, and commas separate the speech from "said Dani".

inverted-commas/6 Which sentence gives the speaker's exact words and so needs inverted commas?

A. Priya said, "Pandas are happiest when there is plenty to climb."

B. Priya said that pandas are happiest when there is plenty to climb.

C. Priya said pandas are happiest when there is plenty to climb.

D. Priya told us about pandas.

Answer: A. Priya said, "Pandas are happiest when there is plenty to climb."

Why: Inverted commas show the exact words spoken. The others report them indirectly.

inverted-commas/7 Which sentence has the punctuation in the right place?

A. He said, "The bus is late".

B. He said "The bus is late."

C. He said, "The bus is late."

D. He said, "the bus is late."

Answer: C. He said, "The bus is late."

Why: The full stop belongs to the spoken sentence, so it goes inside.

inverted-commas/8 When a new person starts speaking, what should you do?

A. Stay on the same line

B. Write the words in capitals

C. Use brackets

D. Start a new line

Answer: D. Start a new line

Why: A new speaker gets a new line, which makes dialogue easy to follow.

inverted-commas/9 Which sentence quotes the text correctly?

A. The writer says that buses are slow, noisy and old-fashioned".

B. The writer says that buses are "slow, noisy and old-fashioned".

C. The writer says that "buses are slow, noisy and old-fashioned.

D. The writer says that buses are "slow, noisy and old-fashioned.

Answer: B. The writer says that buses are "slow, noisy and old-fashioned".

Why: Both opening and closing inverted commas are needed, round exactly the words quoted.

inverted-commas/10 Which sentence punctuates speech followed by "said Maya" correctly?

A. "We should go now," said Maya.

B. "We should go now", said Maya.

C. "We should go now." said Maya.

D. We should go now, "said Maya."

Answer: A. "We should go now," said Maya.

Why: A comma, not a full stop, goes inside the closing inverted commas before "said Maya".

SPaG: Words that sound the same (spelling, L1/L2)

spelling/1 Which is correct?

A. Your going to love the food.

B. Youre going to love the food.

C. Your' going to love the food.

D. You're going to love the food.

Answer: D. You're going to love the food.

Why: "You're" is short for "you are": "You are going to love the food."

spelling/2 Which word completes the sentence? "___ going to arrive at six."

A. They're

B. Their

C. There

D. Thair

Answer: A. They're

Why: "They're" means "they are".

spelling/3 Which word completes the sentence? "It was ___ hot to walk."

A. to

B. too

C. two

D. tu

Answer: B. too

Why: "Too" means "very" or "more than is wanted".

spelling/4 Which word completes the sentence? "The weather will ___ our plans."

A. effect

B. afect

C. effekt

D. affect

Answer: D. affect

Why: "Affect" is the verb meaning "to change or influence".

spelling/5 Which is the correct spelling of the word meaning "for certain"?

A. definitely

B. definately

C. definitly

D. defanitely

Answer: A. definitely

Why: Remember "finite" in the middle: de-finite-ly.

spelling/6 Which is the correct spelling of the word meaning "apart"?

A. seperate

B. separete

C. separate

D. seprate

Answer: C. separate

Why: There is "a rat" in sep-a-rate.

spelling/7 Which is the correct way to write the phrase meaning "many"?

A. alot

B. a'lot

C. allott

D. a lot

Answer: D. a lot

Why: "A lot" is two words.

spelling/8 Which is the correct spelling of the word meaning "to get"?

A. recieve

B. receive

C. receeve

D. receve

Answer: B. receive

Why: "I before E, except after C."

spelling/9 Which sentence uses "whether" and "weather" correctly?

A. I wonder whether the weather will be good.

B. I wonder weather the whether will be good.

C. I wonder whether the whether will be good.

D. I wonder weather the weather will be good.

Answer: A. I wonder whether the weather will be good.

Why: "Whether" means "if". "Weather" is about rain and sunshine.

spelling/10 Which is the correct spelling of the word meaning "a place to stay"?

A. accomodation

B. acommodation

C. accommodation

D. accommodasion

Answer: C. accommodation

Why: It has a double c and a double m.

SPaG: Grammar: was or were, and staying in one tense (grammar, L1/L2)

grammar/1 Which is correct?

A. They were waiting at the stop.

B. The buses was all full.

C. We should of left earlier.

D. Yesterday we go to the park.

Answer: A. They were waiting at the stop.

Why: "They" goes with "were". The others mix up was and were, use "should of" instead of "should have", or use the wrong tense for yesterday.

grammar/2 Which sentence uses the right tense for yesterday?

A. Yesterday we visit the market and bought some olives.

B. Yesterday we visited the market and bought some olives.

C. Yesterday we visited the market and buy some olives.

D. Yesterday we visiting the market and bought olives.

Answer: B. Yesterday we visited the market and bought some olives.

Why: Both verbs are in the past tense.

grammar/3 Which sentence uses "doesn't" correctly?

A. She don't like crowded buses.

B. She not like crowded buses.

C. She doesn't likes crowded buses.

D. She doesn't like crowded buses.

Answer: D. She doesn't like crowded buses.

Why: "She" goes with "doesn't", and the main verb stays in its base form.

grammar/4 Which uses "a" and "an" correctly?

A. An apple and a banana

B. A apple and an banana

C. An apple and an banana

D. A apple and a banana

Answer: A. An apple and a banana

Why: "An" goes before a vowel sound and "a" before a consonant sound.

grammar/5 Which sentence uses "should have" correctly?

A. We should of left earlier.

B. We should has left earlier.

C. We should have left earlier.

D. We should had left earlier.

Answer: C. We should have left earlier.

Why: It is always "should have", never "should of".

grammar/6 Which word completes the sentence? "The bus and the train ___ both late."

A. was

B. is

C. be

D. were

Answer: D. were

Why: Two things joined by "and" take the plural verb "were".

grammar/7 Which sentence keeps the same tense all the way through?

A. I opened the door, look outside and saw the bus.

B. I opened the door, looked outside and saw the bus.

C. I open the door, looked outside and saw the bus.

D. I opened the door, looked outside and see the bus.

Answer: B. I opened the door, looked outside and saw the bus.

Why: All three verbs are in the past tense.

grammar/8 Which sentence uses "fewer" correctly?

A. There are fewer buses on Sundays.

B. There are less buses on Sundays.

C. There is fewer buses on Sundays.

D. There are lesser buses on Sundays.

Answer: A. There are fewer buses on Sundays.

Why: Use "fewer" for things you can count, such as buses.

grammar/9 Which sentence is correct when two people went to the zoo?

A. Me and my friend went to the zoo.

B. My friend and me went to the zoo.

C. My friend and I went to the zoo.

D. I and my friend goes to the zoo.

Answer: C. My friend and I went to the zoo.

Why: Try it with "I" alone: "I went to the zoo." So "My friend and I" is right.

grammar/10 Which sentence uses "good" and "well" correctly?

A. She writes good and has well ideas.

B. She writes good and has good ideas.

C. She writes well and has well ideas.

D. She writes well and has good ideas.

Answer: D. She writes well and has good ideas.

Why: "Well" describes how she writes (an adverb), and "good" describes the ideas (an adjective).

WRITING TASKS

w-pandas-1 (Task 1, email, topic Pandas): Volunteer for Panda Week

Hollins Park Wildlife Centre is looking for young volunteers to help visitors during its Panda Week. Volunteers will hand out maps, help at the craft table and answer simple questions on the Bamboo Walk.

Audience: Sam Patel, the volunteer coordinator. You have never met Sam.. Purpose: To apply for a place as a Panda Week volunteer.. Write an email to Sam Patel applying to be a volunteer.

- why you would like to volunteer at Panda Week
- the skills or experience you would bring
- when you are available, and any questions you have

Indicative content: Reasons: love of animals, interest in pandas and bamboo, wanting experience for a future job or course, wanting to help visitors enjoy the week. / Skills: friendly with people, reliable, helped at school events, good at explaining things, customer-service or first-aid experience, works well in a team. / Availability: days and times (weekends, school holidays); questions about training, uniform or lunch breaks; a polite ending.

w-pandas-2 (Task 2, review, topic Pandas): Review a day with the animals

A wildlife website is collecting reviews from visitors. You recently visited a zoo, wildlife park or farm park. It can be a real place or one you make up.

Audience: People reading the website who are deciding whether to visit.. Purpose: To review your day out and help others decide.. Write a review for the website.

- where you went, what you saw and what was good about the visit
- what could be better, and whether you would recommend it

Indicative content: Where and what: a zoo, wildlife park or farm park (real or invented), the animals seen, what the day was like. Good points: close views, keeper talks, friendly staff, clean paths, the café, value for money. / Improvements: queues, crowds, prices, long walks, not enough seats. Recommendation: who it would suit and how to get the most from a visit.

w-israel-1 (Task 1, email, topic Israel): Ask about a desert trip

Sunpath Small-Group Tours runs a five-day trip in Israel. It visits Tel Aviv on the coast, the Negev desert and the Dead Sea. You are planning to go with family or friends next year, but you need more information first.

Audience: The bookings team at Sunpath Small-Group Tours.. Purpose: To ask for information before booking.. Write an email to the bookings team.

- who would be travelling and when you would like to go
- what you would like to know about the trip, such as food, travel or activities
- any special needs your group has, and how you would like them to reply

Indicative content: Who and when: family or friends, how many, a month or season, how long. / Questions: what the price includes, whether flights are extra, food choices, how much walking, what the guesthouses are like, the weather. / Special needs: dietary needs, mobility, children. Ask for a reply by email, and end politely.

w-israel-2 (Task 2, article, topic Israel): Food from another country

A travel website for young people is running a series called "Taste the World". Each article introduces food from one country. You have been asked to write about food in Israel.

Audience: Young people who read the travel website.. Purpose: To inform readers and make them want to try the food.. Write an article for the website. You can use the information above.

- one or two dishes and what they are like
- why trying local food is a good way to get to know a place, with a tip for young travellers trying new food

Indicative content: Dishes: falafel (chickpea balls, often in pitta), hummus (chickpeas, tahini, lemon, garlic), shakshuka (eggs in a spicy tomato sauce). What they look and taste like, and when they are eaten. / Why local food helps: it shows how people live, markets and stallholders start conversations. Tips: start small, ask what is in a dish, taste before you buy, tell people about allergies, try one new thing a day.

w-transport-1 (Task 1, email, topic Public transport): Have your say on the 14 bus

Vale of Fenn Council has changed the route of the number 14 bus. It no longer goes along Mill Lane, and it now stops at the new health centre. The council is asking passengers for feedback.

Audience: The transport team at Vale of Fenn Council.. Purpose: To give your views on the new route and suggest improvements.. Write an email to the council's transport team.

- how you use the bus and how the change affects you
- what is good and what is not so good about the new route
- what you think the council should do next

Indicative content: How you use the bus: which stops, how often, school, college or work. How the change affects you: a longer walk, a shorter journey, easier trips to the health centre. / Good: the health centre stop, the earlier first bus. Not so good: the Mill Lane stops have gone, Sunday buses only every two hours. Use details from the leaflet-style facts. / Suggestions: keep a Mill Lane stop, more Sunday buses, tell residents who are not online. Ask for a reply and end politely.

w-transport-2 (Task 2, article, topic Public transport): Get on board

Your college newsletter is running a "Green Travel Week". The editor wants an article that encourages students to use buses and trains more.

Audience: Students at your college.. Purpose: To persuade students to try public transport.. Write an article for the college newsletter.

- the benefits of using buses and trains
- worries students might have, and practical tips (such as tickets, timetables or apps) that could help

Indicative content: Benefits: cheaper than a car, no parking worries, time to read or relax, better for the environment, a chance to travel with friends. / Worries: delays, crowded buses, safety, not knowing the route. Tips: use a timetable app, buy a day ticket or railcard, travel at quieter times, have a back-up plan.

w-geography-1 (Task 1, report, topic UK geography): Young people in villages and towns

Your local youth council wants to know whether young people living in villages have the same chances as young people living in towns. They have asked you to write a short report.

Audience: Members of the youth council.. Purpose: To give information and make recommendations.. Write a report for the youth council.

- what there is for young people in a village and in a town near you (real or imagined)
- the problems young people in villages face, such as transport, jobs or things to do
- your recommendations for making things fairer

Indicative content: What there is: youth clubs, sport, shops, libraries, buses, jobs, in a village and in a town (real or invented). / Problems in villages: few buses, few places to meet, few jobs, slow internet, long journeys to college. How these affect young people. / Recommendations: later buses, a youth hub in the village hall, a lift-share scheme, better broadband. Make them realistic and say why they would help.

w-geography-2 (Task 2, blog, topic UK geography): Town or village?

A website for young people is asking readers to write blog posts on the question: "Town or village: where would you rather live?"

Audience: Young people who read the website.. Purpose: To share and explain your opinion.. Write a blog post giving your view.

- where you would rather live, what it would be like, and your reasons
- what you would miss about the other kind of place

Indicative content: Your view: village or town, and what a normal day would be like. Reasons: transport, friends, quiet, space, shops, nature. / What you would miss: what the other place offers, such as shops and buses, or peace and fields. A balanced ending is good.

w-pandas-3 (Task 1, letter, topic Pandas): Ask the zoo about a school visit

Your class is planning a day trip to Ferndale Zoo, where two giant pandas live. Your teacher has asked you to write to the zoo to find out more.

Audience: The education officer at Ferndale Zoo.. Purpose: To ask for information about a school visit.. Write a formal letter to the education officer.

- why your class would like to visit the pandas
- what you would like to know about the visit, such as tickets, talks and lunch
- what help your group needs, and when you would like a reply

Indicative content: Reasons: a project on giant pandas and bamboo, seeing how the pandas live, a science or geography link, a reward for hard work. / Questions: group ticket prices, a keeper talk, where the class can eat lunch, how long the visit takes, how many adults are needed. / Needs: step-free access, a place to keep bags, a reply within two weeks. Use a formal start and end, such as Dear Sir or Madam and Yours faithfully.

w-pandas-4 (Task 2, forum, topic Pandas): Is a day at the zoo worth it?

A wildlife website has a forum thread called "Is a day at the zoo worth it?". Readers are sharing their views.

Audience: Other readers of the forum.. Purpose: To give and explain your view.. Write a post for the forum.

- your view on whether a day at the zoo is worth it
- reasons and examples to support your view

Indicative content: View: worth it, not worth it, or it depends. Say it in the first sentence. / Reasons with examples: ticket prices, seeing animals you cannot see elsewhere, learning from keepers, crowds at feeding time, a short story from a real or imagined visit. End by inviting replies.

w-pandas-5 (Task 1, report, topic Pandas): Panda Day: a report for the school council

Your school council held a Panda Day last month to raise money for a panda adoption. The head teacher has asked for a short report on how it went.

Audience: The head teacher and the school council.. Purpose: To report on the event and recommend improvements.. Write a report.

- what happened on Panda Day and how much was raised
- what went well and what did not go so well
- your recommendations for next year

Indicative content: What happened: a cake sale, a panda quiz and a bamboo obstacle course, about 150 pupils, £312 raised. Say who did what. / Went well: busy cake sale, lots of pupils joined in. Not so well: rain ended the obstacle course early, the quiz started late. / Recommendations: a wet-weather plan, a clear timetable, more helpers, advertise it earlier. Use headings and a formal tone.

w-pandas-6 (Task 2, diary, topic Pandas): A day with the panda keepers

You spent a day on work experience helping the keepers at a wildlife park that has two giant pandas. Your tutor has asked you to keep a diary of the day.

Audience: You, and your tutor, who may read it.. Purpose: To describe the day and how you felt.. Write a diary entry for the day.

- what you did during the day
- how you felt and what you learned

Indicative content: What you did: arrived early, helped prepare the bamboo, cleaned the garden, hid treats for enrichment, watched a feeding talk. Keep it in time order. / Feelings and learning: nerves at the start, surprise at how much pandas eat, what you learned about keepers' jobs. End with a look ahead.

w-israel-3 (Task 1, report, topic Israel): A desert walking trip: a report for the club

Your travel club has just come back from a week-long walking holiday in the Negev desert in Israel. The club leader wants a report to help plan next year's trip.

Audience: The club leader and the committee.. Purpose: To report on the trip and make recommendations.. Write a report.

- what the group did and saw
- what worked well and what could be better
- your recommendations for next year

Indicative content: What happened: walks in the desert, stargazing, the crater viewpoint, a visit to the Dead Sea, bus transfers between places. / Worked well: small group, friendly guide, good food. Could be better: the heat at midday, not enough shade on one walk, long bus journey on day four. / Recommendations: start walks earlier, carry more water, add a rest day, check the weather. Use headings and a formal tone.

w-israel-4 (Task 2, form, topic Israel): Feedback on a food tour

You joined a half-day food tour at a market in Tel Aviv run by Taste Tours. The company's website has an online feedback form with a box headed "Tell us about your tour".

Audience: The Taste Tours customer team.. Purpose: To give feedback on the tour.. Write your answer for the feedback box.

- what you enjoyed most about the tour
- what could be improved, and whether you would recommend it

Indicative content: Enjoyed: the guide, the tasting stops (falafel, hummus, pastries), learning about spices, the friendly stallholders. Give a reason for each. / Improve: group size, heat, water breaks, more vegetarian choices. Recommend or not, and to whom. Thank them at the end.

w-israel-5 (Task 1, letter, topic Israel): A coach trip that never arrived

You booked a coach trip from Jerusalem to the Dead Sea with Sunpath Small-Group Tours, but on the day the coach never came. You want to complain and ask for a solution.

Audience: The customer service manager at Sunpath Small-Group Tours.. Purpose: To complain and ask for a fair solution.. Write a formal letter of complaint.

- what went wrong on the day
- how it affected you
- what you would like the company to do

Indicative content: What happened: the booking, the meeting time and place, how long you waited, whether anyone phoned or explained. / Effect: wasted the day, missed other plans, cost of taxis or food, felt disappointed. Stay polite. / What you want: a refund, or a new date, and a reply within a set time. Formal ending (Yours sincerely or Yours faithfully).

w-israel-6 (Task 2, advice, topic Israel): Staying safe on a desert walk

Sunpath Small-Group Tours is writing an advice sheet for travellers joining its desert walks in Israel.

Audience: Travellers joining a desert walk.. Purpose: To give clear, helpful advice.. Write the advice sheet.

- how to prepare before the walk, such as clothes, shoes and water
- how to stay safe and comfortable during the walk

Indicative content: Before: wear a hat and sun cream, comfortable walking shoes, light layers, bring more water than you think you need, check the weather. / During: drink regularly, rest in the shade, keep with the group, follow the guide, tell someone if you feel unwell. Use short tips with reasons.

w-transport-3 (Task 1, letter, topic Public transport): A bus stop with no shelter

The bus stop outside your college has no shelter, and many students wait in the rain. Vale of Fenn Council has asked for suggestions to improve local bus stops.

Audience: The transport team at Vale of Fenn Council.. Purpose: To describe a problem and ask for an improvement.. Write a formal letter to the council.

- the problem at the bus stop and who it affects
- how a shelter or other improvements would help
- what you would like the council to do, and by when

Indicative content: Problem: no shelter or seat, students waiting in rain and wind, dark evenings, older passengers too. Give numbers or times. / How it would help: dry and safer waiting, a seat, lighting, a timetable board, more people choosing the bus. / Request: build a shelter this term, add a seat and a light, reply by a date. Formal tone and ending.

w-transport-4 (Task 2, forum, topic Public transport): Should buses be free for under-18s?

A local news website has a forum thread called "Should buses be free for under-18s?". Readers are giving their views.

Audience: Other readers of the forum.. Purpose: To give and explain your view.. Write a post for the forum.

- your view on whether buses should be free for under-18s
- reasons and examples to support your view

Indicative content: View: yes, no, or only for some journeys (for example, to school and college). / Reasons with examples: cost for families, getting to college or work, fewer cars, who would pay, what services might be cut. End with a question to readers.

w-transport-5 (Task 1, report, topic Public transport): How do students travel to college?

You asked 40 students how they travel to college. Your tutor has asked you to write a short report on the results.

Audience: Your tutor and the student council.. Purpose: To report on the survey and make recommendations.. Write a report.

- how students travel to college, using the survey results
- problems students mentioned
- your recommendations to make travel easier

Indicative content: Results: bus is the most common (18 of 40, nearly half), then walking (9), lift in a car (7), bike (3), train (3). Turn the numbers into sentences. / Problems: buses late or full, nowhere safe to lock bikes, long walks in the dark. / Recommendations: a safe bike store, a bus pass discount, a message system for late buses. Use headings and a formal tone.

w-transport-6 (Task 2, advice, topic Public transport): Your first train journey

Fennline Trains is making an advice sheet for people who are travelling alone by train for the first time.

Audience: People travelling alone by train for the first time.. Purpose: To give clear, helpful advice.. Write the advice sheet.

- what to do before the journey, such as tickets and timetables
- what to do on the day, at the station and on the train

Indicative content: Before: check the timetable and platform on an app, buy a ticket in advance, leave plenty of time, charge your phone. / On the day: find the right platform, check the screen, keep your ticket handy, stand behind the yellow line, ask staff if you are unsure. Short tips with reasons.

w-geography-3 (Task 1, report, topic UK geography): Is the high street changing?

Your geography class has studied the high street in a market town. You have been asked to write a report for the town council.

Audience: The town council.. Purpose: To describe a change and make recommendations.. Write a report.

- what the high street is like now
- why some shops have closed or changed
- your recommendations to keep the high street busy

Indicative content: Now: six empty shops out of thirty, five charity shops, two new coffee shops, a busy Saturday market. Describe in sentences. / Why: more online shopping, higher rents, supermarkets, fewer people visiting on weekdays. / Recommendations: a weekday market, lower rents for new businesses, events, better parking or buses. Headings and a formal tone.

w-geography-4 (Task 2, newsletter, topic UK geography): Welcome to our village

Your village newsletter is asking residents to write about what makes the village a good place to live, for new neighbours.

Audience: Villagers and new residents.. Purpose: To inform and encourage readers.. Write an item for the newsletter.

- what there is to do in the village and who it is good for
- what could make the village even better

Indicative content: What there is: the village shop, the hall, the green, walking routes, a summer fair, clubs. Say who each is good for. / Improvements: a regular bus, a youth club, better broadband, more events. Be positive and friendly, and say how readers can get involved.

w-geography-5 (Task 1, letter, topic UK geography): No youth club, and the last bus is at six

Young people in your village have no youth club, and the last bus home leaves at 6 pm. Your local paper, the Fenland Courier, invites readers to send in letters.

Audience: The editor of the Fenland Courier.. Purpose: To describe a problem and suggest what should be done.. Write a formal letter to the editor.

- the problems for young people living in your village
- how these problems affect them
- what you think should be done

Indicative content: Problems: no youth club, no evening bus, long walks, nowhere to meet. Use examples. / Effects: young people feel isolated, cannot take part in clubs or work late shifts, depend on lifts. Stay polite and serious. / What should be done: a youth night in the village hall, a later bus, council funding, volunteers. Formal start and end.

w-geography-6 (Task 2, blog, topic UK geography): My first week somewhere new

You have moved from a village to a town, or from a town to a village. A website for young people wants blog posts about moving to a new area.

Audience: Young people who read the website.. Purpose: To describe your experience and share your views.. Write a blog post.

- what is different about your new area
- what you like and what you miss

Indicative content: Differences: transport, shops, noise, space, how well people know each other, how far things are. / Likes and misses: friends and places left behind, new things to try. A friendly, honest tone and a closing line that invites readers to comment.

LEARN: sample answers and our marks

Check that each mark is fair against the published band descriptions, and that the quoted feedback is accurate.

A forum post about the zoo (mark-forum-zoo, L1, task w-pandas-4)

mark-forum-zoo/a2: we gave composition 5, SPaG 4

Hi everyone,

I think a day at the zoo is worth the money, although it depends on what you like. Last summer my family went to a wildlife park and I had a brilliant time.

The main reason I would go again is the animals. You cant see giant pandas very often, and watching one eat bamboo for ten minutes was amazing. The keeper talk was good as well because she answered all our questions and told us things we didnt know.

On the other hand it was expensive. Tickets cost £14 each and we paid another £20 for lunch, which was too much. There was also a long queue for the cafe so we spent half an hour waiting.

Overall I think its worth it if you go early and take your own lunch. Has anyone else been?

> Why (composition): A clear view in the first sentence and two developed reasons with examples, in paragraphs, with a friendly forum tone and a closing question. The language is mostly simple, with limited variety, so it sits in the middle of the band.
>
> Why (SPaG): Full stops and capital letters are secure and most spelling is accurate. Apostrophes are missing from short forms and there are a few missing commas, so it is reasonably accurate.

mark-forum-zoo/a1: we gave composition 3, SPaG 2

i think a day at the zoo is worth it. it is good because you can see animals. my favrite is the pandas they are cute and they eat bamboo all day.

the tickets was alot of money but i still liked it. we went on saturday and there was loads of people so we had to wait. The cafe was expensive to.

so i think you should go to the zoo it is fun

> Why (composition): There is a clear view and one or two relevant ideas, but little detail or explanation, no greeting or closing question, and the ending is abrupt. The sentences are short and simple.
>
> Why (SPaG): There are many errors with capital letters and full stops, several spelling mistakes and some grammar slips. The meaning can still be followed, which keeps it in the lowest band rather than below it.

mark-forum-zoo/a3: we gave composition 8, SPaG 5

Hi everyone,

My view is that a day at the zoo is well worth the money, as long as you plan it properly. I visited a wildlife park last summer with my family, and it turned out to be one of the best days we have had together.

The biggest reason is the chance to see animals you would never otherwise meet. Watching a giant panda chew bamboo for ten minutes, just a few metres away, was far more memorable then any documentary. The keeper talk added to this, because she answered every question patiently and told us facts that I had never heard before.

Of course the day is not perfect. Tickets cost £14 each, and we spent another £20 on lunch, which felt too much. The café also had a queue of nearly half an hour at midday.

However, these problems are easy to avoid: arrive early, bring a packed lunch and check the feeding times online. Done like that, a day at the zoo is great value.

Has anyone found other ways to save money?

> Why (composition): The view is clear and developed with convincing reasons, examples and a fair counter-point. Paragraphs are well organised, the tone suits a forum, and sentences are varied, including some complex ones. Vocabulary is well chosen.
>
> Why (SPaG): Punctuation is varied and mostly accurate, including a colon and commas for extra information. Spelling and grammar are very secure. There are only one or two small lapses.

An advice sheet for first-time train travellers (mark-advice-train, L1, task w-transport-6)

mark-advice-train/b3: we gave composition 8, SPaG 6

Your First Train Journey: Tips for Travelling Alone

Travelling by train on your own for the first time can feel daunting, but a little preparation will make the day far more relaxing. These tips will help you to feel confident from the moment you leave home.

Before the journey

Start by checking the timetable on a journey-planner app, so that you know which train to catch and which platform it leaves from. Buy your ticket in advance if you can, because it is usually cheaper and you will not have to queue. Allow plenty of time to reach the station, and charge your phone the night before in case you need to show your ticket on screen.

On the day

When you arrive, look at the departure board to find your platform. Keep your ticket where you can reach it easily, since staff may ask to see it. Stand behind the yellow line, and let passengers get off before you step on. If you are unsure about anything, ask a member of staff: they are there to help.

Finally, remember that everyone was a beginner once. Follow these steps and you will be fine.

> Why (composition): A clear title, introduction and conclusion, with subheadings that match the two bullet points. Each tip says what to do and why, the tone is calm and helpful, and the sentences are varied, including complex ones.
>
> Why (SPaG): Punctuation is accurate and varied (commas, a colon, a hyphen), spelling is secure and grammar is consistently correct. There are no errors worth noting.

mark-advice-train/b1: we gave composition 3, SPaG 2

Your first train journey

Before you go you should buy a ticket. You can get it on the app or at the station. Check the time of the train.

On the day get to the station early. Look at the screen to see what platform. Dont forget your ticket. Stand behind the yellow line. if you are not sure ask someone who works there

Have a good trip

> Why (composition): There are relevant tips for both parts of the task, but they are very brief with little explanation of why, and there is no introduction. The sentences are short and the layout is very basic.

Why (SPaG): Some full stops and capital letters are correct, but several are missing, and there is a missing apostrophe and a sentence with no end punctuation. The meaning is still clear.

mark-advice-train/b2: we gave composition 6, SPaG 3

Your First Train Journey: Tips for Travelling Alone

Travelling by train on your own for the first time can feel scary, but a little planning makes it much easier.

Before the journey

First, check the timetable on an app so you know which train to catch and what platform it leaves from. Buy your ticket in advance if you can, because it is usually cheaper and you wont have to queue. Leave plenty of time to get to the station, and charge your phone so you can show your ticket on the screen.

On the day

When you arrive look at the departure board to find your platform. Keep your ticket handy as staff may ask to see it. Stand behind the yellow line, and let people get off before you get on. If your not sure about anything, ask a member of staff, they are there to help.

Remember, everyone was a beginner once, so try not to worry.

Why (composition): A clear title, introduction and subheadings. Tips are organised well and most include a reason. The tone is helpful. Language is clear but fairly plain, with some repeated sentence patterns.

Why (SPaG): Spelling and full stops are mostly accurate, but there are several slips with apostrophes, commas and one comma used where a full stop is needed. This is reasonably accurate with some lapses.

A blog post about moving to a new area (mark-blog-move, L1, task w-geography-6)

mark-blog-move/c1: we gave composition 3, SPaG 2

my first week in the town

I moved from a village to a town last week. It is very diferent here. There is lots of shops and the bus come every ten minutes. In the village we only had one bus a day.

I like the shops but it is noisey and I miss my freinds. i miss the feilds and its quiet.

I will tell you more next week

Why (composition): There are relevant points about differences, likes and misses, but very little detail or explanation. There is no real opening or closing, and the sentences are short and simple.

Why (SPaG): Several spelling mistakes, missing capital letters, a missing apostrophe and some grammar slips, but the writing can still be understood.

mark-blog-move/c2: we gave composition 5, SPaG 3

My first week somewhere new

Last Saturday I moved from a small village to a big town, and everything feels different.

The first thing I noticed was the noise. In the village I could hear birds in the morning, but here its cars and buses all day and night. There are also lots more people, and nobody says hello to each other like they did at home. On the plus side there are shops and cafes everywhere and a bus every ten minutes, which means I can see my new friends easily.

What I like most is that I dont need a lift from my parents any more. I can just catch the bus into town after college. What I miss, though, is the fields behind our house and walking the dog in the quiet evenings.

I'll write again next week and tell you how I'm getting on. Has anyone else moved recently?

Why (composition): Relevant and organised, with a title, opening, paragraphs and closing question. Differences and feelings are both covered with some detail. Sentences are mostly simple, with some variety.

Why (SPaG): Full stops and most spelling are accurate, but there are repeated slips with apostrophes and several missing commas. A grammar slip makes one sentence awkward.

mark-blog-move/c3: we gave composition 8, SPaG 5

My first week somewhere new

Last Saturday I moved from a small village to a big town, and almost everything feels different.

The first thing I noticed was the noise. In the village I woke to birdsong, but here it is traffic from morning until midnight. There are also far more people, and while the streets are busier, they feel less friendly than the lanes at home. On the plus side, there are shops, cafés and a bus every ten minutes, which means I can see my new friends whenever I like.

What I enjoy most is my independence. I no longer need a lift from my parents, because I can catch the bus into town after college. What I miss, though, are the fields behind our house and the quiet evenings walking the dog. There is also less people to say hello to, which I find strange.

I will write again next week to tell you how I am getting on. Has anyone else made a move like this?

Why (composition): Well organised and well written, with a clear opening, developed paragraphs and a friendly ending. Differences, likes and misses are all covered with convincing detail, and the vocabulary and sentence structures are varied.

Why (SPaG): Punctuation is accurate and varied, and spelling is secure. There is one grammar slip and one awkward agreement, so it sits in the top band with occasional lapses.

Feedback on a food tour (mark-form-tour, L1, task w-israel-4)

mark-form-tour/d2: we gave composition 6, SPaG 4

The part I enjoyed most was the tasting stops. We tried falafel, hummus and sweet pastries, and the guide explained what was in each dish, which made it more interesting. I also liked that the stallholders were friendly and let us taste before we bought anything.

It could be improved by making the groups smaller. There were twenty five people in our group so it was hard to hear the guide, and we only stopped for water once even though it was very hot. A water break every hour would help.

I would recommend the tour to anyone who loves food, but I would suggest booking the morning one to avoid the crowds. Thank you for asking for my views.

Why (composition): Both parts of the task are covered with clear reasons and examples. It is organised in paragraphs, polite and suits an online form. Language is clear with some range, though sentences are quite similar in length.

Why (SPaG): Mostly accurate punctuation and spelling, with a few missing commas and a missing hyphen. Grammar is secure.

mark-form-tour/d1: we gave composition 3, SPaG 2

The tour was good. i liked the food. We tryed falafel and hummus it was nice. the guide was friendly.

It was to hot and there was too many people. I would recomend it

Why (composition): Both parts of the task are touched on, but each point is very short with no real reasons or examples. There is no closing thank-you and the sentences are simple.

Why (SPaG): Several capital letters and full stops are missing, and there are spelling slips and a grammar slip, but the meaning is clear.

mark-form-tour/d3: we gave composition 8, SPaG 6

What I enjoyed most was the tasting stops. We sampled warm falafel, creamy hummus and sticky pastries, and our guide explained the story behind every dish, which turned a simple snack into a lesson in local culture. The stallholders were also generous, letting us taste before we bought.

The tour could be improved by limiting the group size. With twenty-five people, it was difficult to hear the guide over the noise of the market, and since temperatures were high we would have welcomed more than one water break.

Overall, I would happily recommend the tour, particularly to families and anyone who enjoys trying new food. I would suggest booking the morning session, when the crowds are smaller. Thank you for the opportunity to share my views.

Why (composition): Both parts are covered in full, with specific, convincing detail and a polite, formal tone that suits an online form. Paragraphs are well organised, sentences are varied, and the vocabulary is well chosen.

Why (SPaG): Punctuation is accurate and varied, spelling is secure and grammar is consistently correct.

A forum post about free buses for under-18s (mark-forum-buses, L2, task w-transport-4)

mark-forum-buses/e2: we gave composition 6, SPaG 4

Hi everyone,

I think buses should be free for under-18s, at least on journeys to school and college. Many families in our area already struggle with the cost of living and a weekly bus pass can cost more than the weekly food shop for a teenager's lunches.

The main argument for free travel is fairness. Students who live in the countryside often have no choice but to take the bus, whereas those in town can walk. For example, my cousin spends £18 a week to get to college, which is money his family could have spent on other things. Free buses would also mean fewer parents driving children to school, which would reduce traffic and pollution outside the gates.

However, someone has to pay for it. If the council cuts other services to fund free travel, then the benefit might be cancelled out. A fair compromise would be free travel at peak times only.

What do other people think the council should do?

Why (composition): A clear view, with developed reasons, a real example and a counter-argument. Paragraphs are used and the tone suits a forum. Vocabulary and sentences are generally appropriate, though some phrasing is repetitive.

Why (SPaG): Punctuation is generally correct across commas, apostrophes and colons. There are a few small slips with commas and one awkward comparison, so it is generally accurate.

mark-forum-buses/e1: we gave composition 3, SPaG 2

I think that buses should be free for under 18s because its not fair that teenagers have to pay.

Lots of young people dont have much money. They have to pay for the bus to college and its expensive. My friend pays alot every week and she has to ask her mum for money. Also if the buses was free then more people would use them and there would be less cars.

But the council would have to pay for it and that might mean they cut other things. So I think it is a good idea but they need to find the money from somewhere.

what do you think

> Why (composition): There is a clear view and a few reasons, but they are not developed and the example is general. The counter-point is brief. The tone is suitable but sentence structures are simple.
>
> Why (SPaG): Several apostrophes, capital letters and question marks are missing, and there are some spelling and grammar slips. The meaning is mostly clear.

mark-forum-buses/e3: we gave composition 8, SPaG 6

Hi everyone,

In my view, buses should be free for everyone under 18, because the benefits to families and to the town outweigh the cost.

The strongest argument is fairness. A weekly student pass costs £18 in our area, which is a heavy burden for families already managing rising bills. Consequently, some teenagers skip college courses that would require a longer journey, simply because they cannot afford the fares. Free travel would give every young person the same chance to learn, regardless of income.

Moreover, there are wider benefits. If more teenagers used the bus, fewer parents would drive them to school, which would ease congestion and improve the air outside the gates. Where similar schemes have been tried in other cities, more young people have started using public transport.

Admittedly, someone must pay: the council could be forced to cut other services. Nevertheless, a limited scheme covering journeys to school and college would be affordable, and the long-term gains would be worth it.

How would you fund it, if you were in charge?

> Why (composition): A confident, well structured post. The view is clear, the reasons are developed with specific evidence, and a counter-argument is fairly considered and answered. Paragraphs are linked with connectives, the tone suits a forum and the vocabulary is wide.
>
> Why (SPaG): Punctuation is varied and accurate, including colons and commas, spelling is secure and grammar is consistent.

A newsletter item about a village (mark-news-village, L2, task w-geography-4)

mark-news-village/f2: we gave composition 6, SPaG 4

Welcome to our village

Our village is a friendly place to live, and there is plenty to do whatever your age.

The village hall hosts a coffee morning every Thursday, which is a good way for new residents to meet people. For younger people, there is a football pitch on the green and a youth group on Friday evenings. Walkers will enjoy the footpath along the river, which leads to the old mill and takes about an hour. Every July the summer fair raises money for the church roof and the whole village comes along.

However, there are things we could improve. The bus only runs twice a day, so people without cars find it hard to get to the town. Broadband is also slow in some streets. We would like to see a regular bus and faster

internet, and we should ask the parish council about it.

If you would like to help, come to the next meeting in the hall. New ideas are always welcome!

> Why (composition): Both bullet points are covered, with several relevant details and a clear idea of who each activity suits. The tone is friendly and positive, the format is acceptable and paragraphs are used. Language is clear but not varied.
>
> Why (SPaG): Generally correct punctuation and spelling. A few comma slips and one run-on sentence, but errors do not affect the meaning.

mark-news-village/f1: we gave composition 3, SPaG 2

our village is a good place to live. There is a shop and a hall and a park. The hall has events. Its good for old people and the park is good for kids.

The village could be better if the bus came more. and there was more things to do. Come to the meeting if you want to help

> Why (composition): Some relevant ideas are given for both bullets, but they are only listed, with little detail. The format has no heading and the sentences are short and simple.
>
> Why (SPaG): There are several errors with capital letters, full stops and apostrophes, and a grammar slip, but the writing can be understood.

mark-news-village/f3: we gave composition 8, SPaG 6

Welcome to Elmstead: a village for everyone

Whether you have lived here for fifty years or fifty days, Elmstead has something for you.

The village hall is the heart of our community. Every Thursday, the coffee morning brings neighbours together, and the Friday youth club gives teenagers a place to meet, play table tennis and make music. Walkers will love the riverside path, which winds for three miles to the old mill, while families can enjoy the green, where the summer fair raises hundreds of pounds for the church roof each July.

Nevertheless, a good village can always improve. At present, the bus runs only twice a day, which leaves anyone without a car stranded. A regular service would help teenagers to reach college and older residents to attend appointments in town. Faster broadband would also benefit people who work from home.

We would love you to join us. Come along to the parish meeting on the first Monday of each month, or speak to any member of the committee. Together, we can make Elmstead even better.

> Why (composition): Strong and engaging, with an inviting heading and a welcoming tone that fits a newsletter. Both bullets are covered in detail, benefits are explained for particular groups, and the ending makes a clear call to action. Language and sentence structures are varied.
>
> Why (SPaG): Punctuation is consistently correct, including colons and commas, with secure spelling and grammar.

Fix it: Fix the apostrophes (fix-apostrophes)

1. Im going to the library after college. → I'm going to the library after college. (I'm is short for I am. The apostrophe shows the missing letter.)

2. We couldnt find the platform. → We couldn't find the platform. (Couldn't is short for could not.)

3. The dogs lead was too short. → The dog's lead was too short. (One dog owns the lead, so the apostrophe goes before the s.)

4. The teachers meeting starts at four. → The teachers' meeting starts at four. (Several teachers own the meeting, so the apostrophe goes after the s.)

5. Its a lovely day and the sun has got its hat on. → It's a lovely day and the sun has got its hat on. (It's means it is. Its (no apostrophe) shows belonging. Only the first one needed fixing.)

6. Three bus's were late this morning. → Three buses were late this morning. (A plural does not take an apostrophe.)

7. The childrens playground is closed. → The children's playground is closed. (Children is already plural, so add 's.)

8. Theyre not sure whose coming. → They're not sure who's coming. (They're is they are, and who's is who is. Whose shows belonging.)

Fix it: Fix the capital letters and full stops (fix-capitals)

1. on monday i went to london with my sister. → On Monday I went to London with my sister. (Days, places and the word I all start with a capital letter, and so does the first word.)

2. We waited for the train it was late. → We waited for the train. It was late. (Two separate ideas need a full stop between them.)

3. my favourite subject is english, and my teacher is mrs patel. → My favourite subject is English, and my teacher is Mrs Patel. (Names of subjects such as English, titles and names need capital letters.)

4. The cafe was busy. so we sat outside. → The cafe was busy, so we sat outside. (A sentence should not start with so after a full stop. A comma joins the two parts.)

5. Are you coming to the match on saturday → Are you coming to the match on Saturday? (A question ends with a question mark, and days start with a capital letter.)

6. What a brilliant goal → What a brilliant goal! (An exclamation takes an exclamation mark.)

7. In december we visited the Dead Sea in israel. → In December we visited the Dead Sea in Israel. (Months and countries start with a capital letter.)

8. The panda eats bamboo. it can eat for twelve hours a day. → The panda eats bamboo. It can eat for twelve hours a day. (The first word after a full stop needs a capital letter.)

Fix it: Fix the commas (fix-commas)

1. We bought bread milk eggs and cheese. → We bought bread, milk, eggs and cheese. (Commas separate items in a list.)

2. However the train was late. → However, the train was late. (A comma follows an opening word such as however.)

3. When we arrived at the station we bought our tickets. → When we arrived at the station, we bought our tickets. (A comma follows an opening clause.)

4. My brother who lives in Leeds is a nurse. → My brother, who lives in Leeds, is a nurse. (Commas go round extra information.)

5. I wanted to go but it was raining so I stayed in. → I wanted to go, but it was raining, so I stayed in. (A comma goes before but and so when they join two full ideas.)

6. The tour was long, the guide was excellent. → The tour was long. The guide was excellent. (A comma cannot join two complete sentences. Use a full stop (or a joining word).)

7. I am writing to ask about the trip, thank you. → I am writing to ask about the trip. Thank you. (A comma cannot join two separate sentences. Use a full stop.)

8. If you are unsure ask a member of staff. → If you are unsure, ask a member of staff. (A comma follows an opening if clause.)

Fix it: Fix the spelling (fix-spelling)

1. There going to be late. → They're going to be late. (They're means they are. There points to a place.)

2. I would like to here your opinion. → I would like to hear your opinion. (Hear is what you do with your ears. Here is a place.)

3. It was to cold to go outside. → It was too cold to go outside. (Too means more than needed or also.)

4. We went to the park for our brake. → We went to the park for our break. (A break is a rest. A brake stops a bike.)

5. The weather was nice, accept for the wind. → The weather was nice, except for the wind. (Except means apart from. Accept means to take.)

6. I recieved your letter yesterday. → I received your letter yesterday. (I before E, except after C.)

7. The new libary opens on Monday. → The new library opens on Monday. (Say it slowly: lie-brar-y.)

8. This is definately the best answer. → This is definitely the best answer. (Definitely has the word finite in the middle.)

Fix it: Fix the grammar (fix-grammar)

1. There is three buses to the town. → There are three buses to the town. (Three buses is plural, so use are.)

2. Each of the students have a ticket. → Each of the students has a ticket. (Each is singular, so it goes with has.)

3. Yesterday we go to the museum. → Yesterday we went to the museum. (Yesterday means the past, so use the past tense.)

4. She don't like crowds. → She doesn't like crowds. (She goes with doesn't.)

5. I seen the film last week. → I saw the film last week. (Saw is the past tense. Seen needs have.)

6. We was waiting for an hour. → We were waiting for an hour. (We goes with were.)

7. Me and my friend went to the match. → My friend and I went to the match. (Use I when you are doing the action, and put yourself last.)

8. It was more better than I expected. → It was better than I expected. (Better already means more good, so do not add more.)